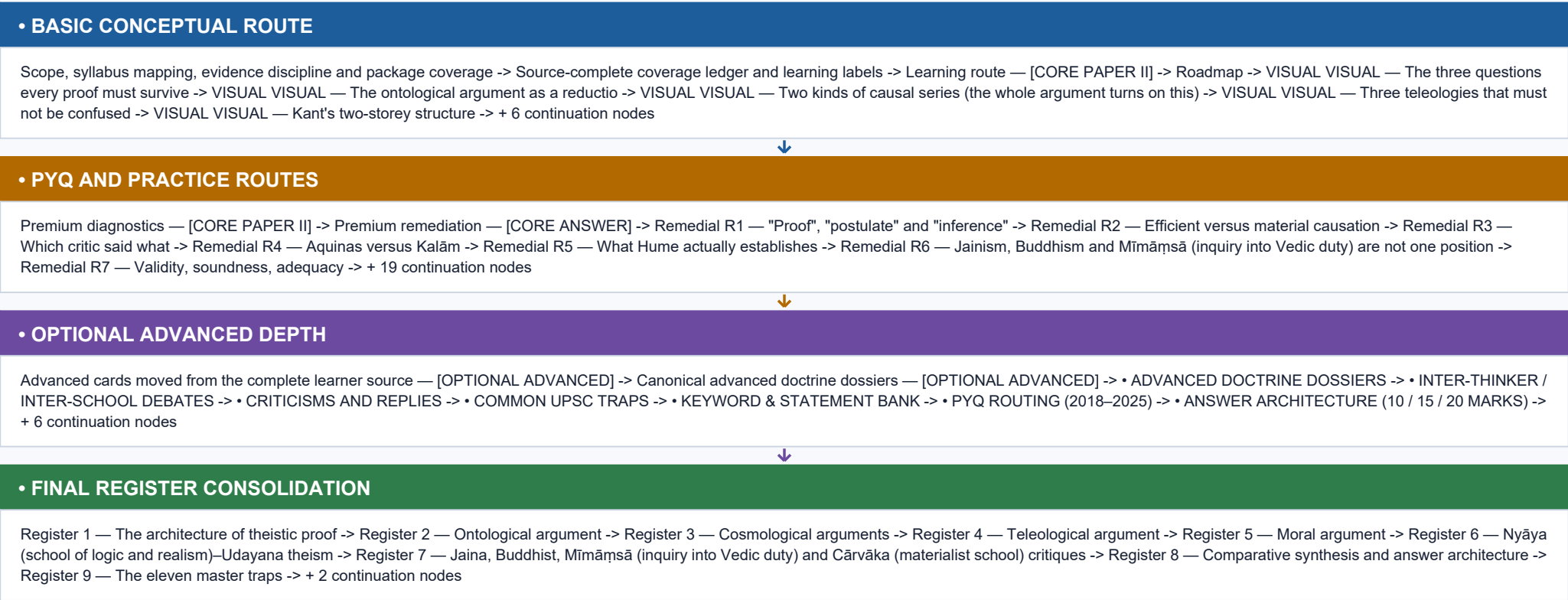


# Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique — Learner-v2 Source-Complete Learning Session

MASTER LEARNING SEQUENCE | definition -> doctrine/argument -> objections/replies -> comparison -> exam conversion -> final register



Every Indic technical term is translated on first use inside each visual card.

# BASIC

Definitions, thinkers, argument structures, objections, replies and comparisons.

## BASIC NODE 1 | Scope, syllabus mapping, evidence discipline and package coverage — continued 1/2

title: Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique

topic\_key: philosophy-paper-ii-philosophy-of-religion-02

Catalogue identity: Philosophy Optional · Philosophy Paper II — Philosophy of Religion · philosophy-paper-ii-philosophy-of-religion-02

Generation: g2, 21 August 2026 · Approval: pending explicit topic approval

Evidence discipline: exact proof attributions and PYQ wording/year/marks are controlled by repository owners.

Model answers are pedagogic, never official UPSC keys.

| Component | Count |

| --- | ---: |



## BASIC NODE 2 | Scope, syllabus mapping, evidence discipline and package coverage — continued 2/2

| Direct verified topic-owned PYQs | 12 |

| Core diagnostic MCQs | 32 |

| Remedial diagnostic MCQs | 8 |

| Total diagnostics | 40 |

| Retained original solved Mains models | 6 (2 × 10, 2 × 15, 2 × 20) |

| Approval | false |



**BASIC NODE 3 | Source-complete coverage ledger and learning labels — continued 1/4**

[FACT] marks retained repository doctrine/question data.

[INFERENCE] marks the learner-facing organisation and graded verdict.

This ledger maps source units to the final location rather than merely asserting reconciliation.

| Source corpus and unit | Final location | Retention decision |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Canonical 0–4: proof map;

Western/Indian proofs; a priori/a posteriori; statement bank | Basic modules 1–5 and comparative synthesis | Full doctrine/terminology retained in visual-first sequence |

| Canonical 5–6: applications, parity bench, PYQ skeletons | Basic answer workshops;



**BASIC NODE 4 | Source-complete coverage ledger and learning labels — continued 2/4**

Practice full models | Preserved once in full premium form rather than duplicated skeleton/model pairs |

| Canonical 8.1–8.8: advanced proof dossiers | Optional Advanced | Full owner block retained after practice |

| Canonical 9–18: debates, critiques, traps, keyword bank, routing and directive/verdict discipline | Basic comparison/answer workshops;

Optional Advanced; final register | Preserved in the section where it performs a distinct learning role |

| Complete session: roadmap, six proof modules, visual maps, objection/reply ladders, comparison grids, revision aids and workshop | Basic Learning Session | Retained in original pedagogic order; only interleaved old MCQs/current anchors and explicitly advanced cards moved |

| Complete session: advanced-refinement cards | Optional Advanced | Moved intact after practice, as learner-v2 requires |



## BASIC NODE 5 | Source-complete coverage ledger and learning labels — continued 3/4

| Premium workbook: 12 verified PYQs, 32 core diagnostics, 8 remediation items, answer protocol and revision matrix | MCQs and Practice | Full verified answers and all diagnostic explanations retained |

| Premium originals | Practice | Six solved models retained because they add non-duplicate coverage; four overlapping prompts omitted |

| Philosophy of Religion dossier Topic 2 | Optional Advanced | Retained in full after core practice |

Visible answer-worthiness labels.

Proof structures, named proponents, school-specific arguments and core critiques are CORE PAPER II.

Premise testing, objection/reply, comparison and directive-specific judgment are CORE ANSWER.

Historical supplements and extra illustrations are SUPPORTING.

Modal, PSR, Bayesian, anthropic and meta-epistemic depth is OPTIONAL ADVANCED.



## BASIC NODE 6 | Source-complete coverage ledger and learning labels — continued 4/4

What to do with the material.

Memorise each proof's shortest premise chain and its named critic.

Understand what the proof does—and does not—establish.

Use one carefully chosen comparison or reply selectively.

Reserve modal, probabilistic and specialist meta-level debates for a high-value 15/20-marker.



## BASIC NODE 7 | Learning route — [CORE PAPER II]

The retained source sequence moves from what counts as a proof, through Western and Indian argument families, to comparison and answer construction.

Notions of God, evil, experience, faith and language appear only as bounded links or targets of a premise; they are not silently absorbed into this topic.

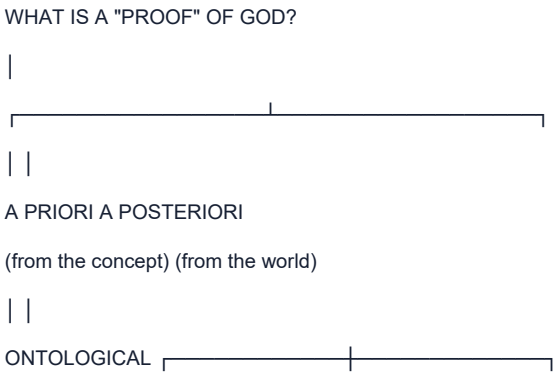
UPSC Philosophy Optional · Paper II · Section B · Philosophy of Religion · Syllabus item 2

Date of session: 10 August 2026 · Progress: 0/8 · Estimated effort: 7–9 sittings

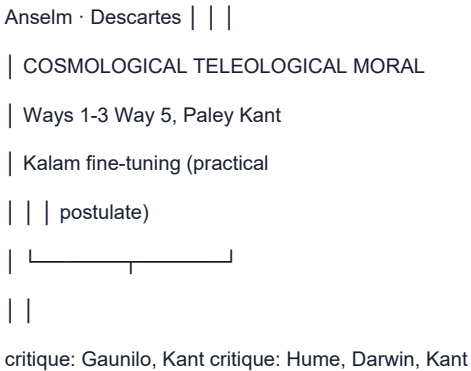
Evidence key used throughout: FACT canonical doctrine directly grounded in the authored knowledge file or a local source text · CAUTION analytical synthesis / inference for exam use · QUESTION contested or textually variable · CURRENT dated contemporary anchor only, never authority.



BASIC NODE 8 | Roadmap — continued 1/7



BASIC NODE 9 | Roadmap — continued 2/7



BASIC NODE 10 | Roadmap — continued 3/7

INDIAN THEISTIC PROOF

Nyaya-Vaisesika (combined logic-realist and category-realist traditions) / Udayana

karyat (from the world's being an effect) · ayojanat (from combination or coordination) · dhrtiyadeh (from support and maintenance) · padat (from meaningful words)/sruteh (from revealed scripture) · karma (morally consequential action)-dispenser

INDIAN ANTI-CREATOR CRITIQUE



BASIC NODE 11 | Roadmap — continued 4/7

Jaina · Bauddha · Mimamsa (inquiry into Vedic duty) · Carvaka (materialist school) · (Advaita (non-dual school)'s levelling)

COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS + ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

| Session | Subtopic | Core focus |

| ---: | --- | --- |

| 1 | Architecture of theistic proof | Demonstration vs probable inference vs postulate; a priori/a posteriori; validity—soundness—adequacy |

| 2 | Ontological argument | Anselm's two forms, Descartes, Gaunilo, Kant, modal repair |

| 3 | Cosmological argument | Aquinas' Ways 1–3, essentially ordered series, Kalām, Hume and Kant |



BASIC NODE 12 | Roadmap — continued 5/7

| 4 | Teleological argument | Way 4 and Way 5, Paley, Hume's five-front critique, Darwin, fine-tuning |

| 5 | Moral argument | Kant's demolition and reinstatement; postulates;  
Newman;  
Euthyphro |

| 6 | Nyāya (school of logic and realism)—Udayana theism | \*Kāryāt (from the world's being an effect), āyojanāt (from combination or coordination), dhṛtyādeḥ (from support and maintenance), padāt (from meaningful words)/śruteḥ (from revealed scripture)\*, karma (morally consequential action)-dispenser, efficient-cause thesis |

| 7 | Indian anti-theistic critique | Jaina proofs and refutation;  
Buddhist anti-creator arguments;  
Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) \*apauruṣeya (not of human authorship)\*;



BASIC NODE 13 | Roadmap — continued 6/7

Cārvāka (materialist school) |

| 8 | Comparative synthesis | India–West matrix, graded verdicts, 10/15/20-mark architecture |

PYQ priority: FACT Very high — 12 topic-owned question-parts across 2018–2025, spanning ontological (2018, 2020, 2024), Aquinas (2018, 2022), Nyāya (2018, 2023, 2025), design–Hume (2025), moral (2021), Jaina (2019), Buddhist (2018) and the a priori/a posteriori distinction (2022).

KEY Master mnemonic — "O-C-T-M + N, then J-B-M": Ontological, Cosmological, Teleological, Moral, plus Nyāya; critiqued by Jaina, Bauddha, Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty).

Progress: 1 / 8 | Stage: Foundation | Subtopic: The Architecture of Theistic Proof

--- PRE-TEACH CHECKLIST -----



BASIC NODE 14 | Roadmap — continued 7/7

BOOK Book context: Authored Markdown paper-2/philosophy-of-religion/Proofs-for-God.md §0, §3, §11 read in full; local OCR-searchable John Hick, \*Philosophy of Religion\*, Chapter 2 ("Arguments for the Existence of God", pp. 15–29 of the print pagination) confirmed searchable and consulted.

CHECK CA Search: "cosmological, teleological and fine-tuning arguments for God's existence — scholarly debate 2025–2026"

CURRENT CA Found: CURRENT A 2026 paper, ""The Rational Defence of God's Existence: Exploring Cosmological..."", and a 2025 review, ""A Discourse On God's Existence: Cosmological And Teleological Proofs"", both continue the cosmology/fine-tuning debate.

Use only as a dated contemporary-debate anchor.

It is not proof, and not canonical authority.



**BASIC NODE 15 | VISUAL VISUAL — The three questions every proof must survive — continued 1/3**

PROOF FOR GOD

|

|

| (1) VALIDITY Does the conclusion follow from the |

| premises as stated? |

|

| (2) SOUNDNESS Are the premises actually true |

| (causal principle, PSR, analogy)? |



**BASIC NODE 16 | VISUAL VISUAL — The three questions every proof must survive — continued 2/3**

|

| (3) ADEQUACY Is the being reached actually GOD |

| — infinite, one, personal, good? |

|

A proof can be VALID, yet UNSOUND;

valid AND sound, yet still INADEQUATE to classical theism.

CAUTION This three-tier grid is the single most examiner-pleasing device in the whole topic.



**BASIC NODE 17 | VISUAL VISUAL — The three questions every proof must survive — continued 3/3**

Almost every UPSC critique question ("critically examine", "along with its criticism") is answered by locating the objection on one of these three tiers instead of shouting a general "the proof fails".





## BASIC NODE 18 | • What counts as a "proof" here?

FACT Three logically different things are all loosely called "proofs" in this syllabus item:

| Type | Claim made | Standard example | If it fails, it fails as... |

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Demonstration | The conclusion follows necessarily; denial is contradictory | Anselm's ontological argument | invalid or question-begging |

| Probable / explanatory inference | God is the best or a required explanation of some feature of the world | Aquinas' Ways, Paley, Nyāya (school of logic and realism) \*kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)\* | weak analogy, available rival explanation |

| Practical postulate | Belief is rationally required by the moral standpoint, not by theoretical proof | Kant's moral argument | a projection, or not binding on the sceptic |

CAUTION Never write "Kant proves God through morality." Kant explicitly \*denies\* theoretical proof; he postulates.

This single sentence has sunk many otherwise good scripts.



## BASIC NODE 19 | • A priori and a posteriori — the 2022 distinction — continued 1/2

| Axis | A priori | A posteriori |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Starting point | FACT The concept of God alone | FACT Some fact of the world (motion, causation, contingency, order, moral experience) |

| Method | Conceptual analysis; denial produces contradiction | Inference from effect to cause; inference to best explanation |

| Standard instance | Ontological (Anselm, Descartes) | Cosmological, teleological, moral, Nyāya (school of logic and realism) \*Īśvara-anumāna (inference to God)\* |

| Modality of conclusion | FACT Necessary being, if it works at all | CAUTION At best a probable, and often finite, cause |

| Independence from science | Total — no empirical premise | CAUTION Exposed to Darwin, Big-Bang cosmology, multiverse models |

| Characteristic defeat | FACT Kant: "existence is not a real predicate" | FACT Hume: analogy is weak; effect underdetermines cause |



## BASIC NODE 20 | • A priori and a posteriori — the 2022 distinction — continued 2/2

| Religious payoff | Reaches necessity but not obviously a personal God | Reaches an agent-like cause but not obviously an infinite one |

KEY Mnemonic — "CONCEPT versus COSMOS": a priori argues from the \*concept\*, a posteriori from the \*cosmos\*.

CAUTION The 2022 examiner asks which should be preferred.

The strongest answer is a graded one: a posteriori arguments are epistemically more respectable because they begin from something granted by the opponent, but they pay for it by reaching only a finite, probable cause; the a priori argument alone promises necessity, but it purchases that necessity by an inference that Kant showed to be illegitimate.

Preference therefore depends on the criterion — evidential contact favours a posteriori, modal strength favours a priori, and religious adequacy is achieved by neither alone.



**BASIC NODE 21 | • The five families in one frame — continued 1/2**

| Family | Premise drawn from | Terminus reached | Chief critic |

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Ontological | FACT Concept of a maximally great being | Necessarily existing being | Gaunilo;

Kant |

| Cosmological | FACT Motion, efficient causation, contingency | Unmoved mover / first cause / necessary being | Hume;

Kant |

| Teleological | FACT Order, adaptation, fine order | Intelligent designer | Hume;

Darwin |



**BASIC NODE 22 | • The five families in one frame — continued 2/2**

| Moral | FACT The moral law and the highest good | God as practical postulate | Naturalist axiology;

Euthyphro |

| Nyāya (school of logic and realism) inference | FACT The world as \*kārya (effect)\* (composite effect) | Omniscient intelligent efficient cause (Īśvara (Lord or personal God)) | Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty);

Buddhism;

Jainism;

Cārvāka (materialist school) |



**BASIC NODE 23 | • Why UPSC cares**

FACT The syllabus phrase is **“Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique (Indian and Western)”**.

The examiner is therefore testing four capacities at once:

RECONSTRUCT → the argument as numbered premises, not as a slogan

EXPOSE → the hidden presupposition that carries the weight

OBJECT/REPLY → the strongest critic, and the proponent’s best answer

GRADE → how far it succeeds, and what kind of God it delivers



## BASIC NODE 24 | UPSC traps

- CAUTION Do not treat "proof" univocally: demonstration, probable inference and practical postulate have different success conditions.
- CAUTION Do not say the ontological argument is a posteriori because Anselm "observes" that people have the idea of God — the \*premise\* is conceptual.
- CAUTION Do not equate "a priori" with "certain" and "a posteriori" with "uncertain"; a priori reasoning can be invalid, and a posteriori reasoning can be strong.
- CAUTION Distinguish validity from soundness from adequacy of the God established.

Most critiques attack the second and third, not the first.

- CAUTION Do not present the Indian material as a decorative appendix;

Nyāya (school of logic and realism) is a fully-formed \*a posteriori\* natural theology and belongs inside the taxonomy.

- CAUTION A proof's failure does not establish atheism; it establishes only that \*that route\* does not compel.



## BASIC NODE 25 | Revision notes — continued 1/2

- Theistic proofs divide into a priori (conceptual) and a posteriori (world-based) routes.
- Ontological is the only classical a priori proof; cosmological, teleological, moral and Nyāya (school of logic and realism) are a posteriori.
- Assess every proof on three tiers: validity, soundness, adequacy of the God reached.
- Demonstration claims necessity; explanatory inference claims probability; postulation claims practical rationality.
- Kant's moral argument is a postulate, never a theoretical demonstration.
- A posteriori proofs begin from conceded facts but reach only a finite, probable cause.
- The a priori proof promises necessity but is charged with the existence-predicate fallacy.
- 2022 asked exactly this distinction plus a reasoned preference — answer with a criterion-based, graded verdict.



## BASIC NODE 26 | Revision notes — continued 2/2

- Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s \*Īśvara-anumāna (inference to God)\* is a cosmological–teleological hybrid, not a separate exotic species.
- No single proof reaches the full God of developed religion; cumulative-case strategies attempt to repair this.



### BASIC NODE 27 | VISUAL VISUAL — The ontological argument as a reductio — continued 1/3

ASSUME (for reductio): God exists in the understanding ALONE

|

| Premise A: God =def "that than which nothing greater  
| can be conceived" (aliquid quo nihil maius cogitari possit)

|

| Premise B: To exist in reality is greater than  
| to exist in the understanding alone

▼



### BASIC NODE 28 | VISUAL VISUAL — The ontological argument as a reductio — continued 2/3

THEN a greater than God can be conceived  
(namely, the same being existing in reality too)

▼

BUT that contradicts Premise A — "the greatest conceivable"  
cannot be exceeded by anything conceivable

▼

therefore THE ASSUMPTION IS FALSE.

God exists in reality.



## BASIC NODE 29 | VISUAL VISUAL — The ontological argument as a reductio — continued 3/3

[Proslogion 2]



SECOND FORM: a being that CANNOT be thought not to exist

is greater than one that can.

therefore God exists NECESSARILY (aseity, self-existence).

[Proslogion 3]

CAUTION The second form is the philosophically serious one.

It shifts the claim from \*existence\* to \*necessary existence\*, and it is the form Anselm uses to answer Gaunilo.



## BASIC NODE 30 | • Anselm's definition — and why its wording matters

FACT Anselm compresses the monotheistic concept of God into the formula "a being than which nothing greater can be conceived." "Greater" here means more perfect, not spatially larger.

FACT Crucial textual point: Anselm deliberately does \*not\* say "the most perfect being that there is".

That description would be trivially satisfied by whatever happens to be the best existing thing, with no guarantee that it is God.

He says "so perfect that no more perfect can even be \*conceived\*".

The argument is built on the second, stronger notion.

FACT Anselm addresses the Psalmist's "fool" who says in his heart, "There is no God." Even the fool, says Anselm, possesses the concept; and when the concept is unpacked, the fool is refuted out of his own understanding.



## BASIC NODE 31 | • The two forms, side by side — continued 1/2

| | First form — Proslogion 2 | Second form — Proslogion 3 |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Conclusion | God exists in reality as well as in the mind | God exists \*necessarily\*;

God's non-existence is inconceivable |

| Key comparative | Existing in reality > existing in the mind alone | Being unable to be thought not to exist > being able to be so thought |

| Core notion | Existence | FACT Necessary being / aseity (self-existence) |

| Vulnerable to | Gaunilo's island parody;

Kant's predicate objection | CAUTION The charge that "necessary existence" is itself an incoherent or unestablished notion |



## BASIC NODE 32 | • The two forms, side by side — continued 2/2

| Modern descendants | — | FACT Malcolm, Hartshorne, Plantinga's modal versions |

FACT Because God as infinitely perfect is not limited in or by time, the two possibilities of God's ever \*coming to be\* or ever \*ceasing to be\* are alike excluded;

God's non-existence is thereby rendered impossible.



## BASIC NODE 33 | • Descartes' reformulation

FACT Descartes (\*Meditations\* V) recasts the argument through his doctrine of clear and distinct ideas: existence belongs to the essence of a supremely perfect being as necessarily as having three angles summing to two right angles belongs to the essence of a triangle, or as a valley belongs to the idea of a mountain.

A supremely perfect being that lacked existence would lack a perfection, which is a contradiction in terms.

CAUTION Distinction to state in the answer: Anselm argues by \*reductio\* from a comparative ("greater than");

Descartes argues from \*essence containment\* ("existence is a perfection").

Both are a priori, but their machinery differs, and Kant's objection strikes Descartes' version most directly.

CAUTION Descartes elsewhere offers a \*different\*, causal proof of God (from the idea of the infinite in a finite mind, \*Meditations\* III).

Do not fuse the two; the causal one is not ontological.



### BASIC NODE 34 | • Objection 1 — Gaunilo's lost island — continued 1/2

FACT Gaunilo, a monk of Marmoutiers and Anselm's contemporary, replied in a tract titled \*In Behalf of the Fool\*.

He argued that Anselm's reasoning would generate absurd conclusions elsewhere, and constructed a parallel argument for the most perfect island: given the idea of such an island, Anselm's principle would force us to conclude that it exists, since otherwise it would not be the most perfect conceivable island.

CAUTION Precision point rarely made in scripts: Gaunilo actually spoke of the most perfect \*of\* islands rather than, as he should have, the most perfect \*conceivable\* island.

Making that correction strengthens the parody, and stating the correction shows the examiner that you have read the debate rather than a summary of it.

FACT Anselm's reply rests on the second form.

The element present in the concept of God and absent from the concept of any island is necessary existence.



### BASIC NODE 35 | • Objection 1 — Gaunilo's lost island — continued 2/2

An island — "a piece of land surrounded by water" — is by definition part of the contingent physical world, a dependent reality that can without contradiction be thought not to exist.

Anselm's principle therefore does not apply to it.

It applies only to a being defined as having eternal and independent existence.

CAUTION Residual pressure: the reply protects the second form but leaves the first form exposed, and it transfers the entire burden to a further question — \*is the idea of a maximally great being coherent at all?\* If "most perfect conceivable island" is incoherent (because island-perfections have no intrinsic maximum), the parody fails; but the theist must then show that maximal greatness \*does\* have an intrinsic maximum.



### BASIC NODE 36 | • Objection 2 — Kant: existence is not a real predicate — continued 1/2

FACT Kant's objection is the decisive one in the tradition: "existence is not a real predicate." A real (determining) predicate adds something to the concept of a subject.

Existence adds nothing to a concept; it \*posits\* the concept's object.

Kant's illustration: a hundred real thalers contain not one coin more than a hundred possible thalers; the concept is identical, only my financial position differs.

FACT Chatterjee and Datta make the same point in the Indian textbook tradition, and put it in an idiom worth borrowing: \*the idea of one hundred rupees in my pocket involves the image or the idea of their existence, but not their real physical existence.\* To think of the existence of something is not to prove its existence.

CAUTION Therefore: you cannot define anything into existence.



### BASIC NODE 37 | • Objection 2 — Kant: existence is not a real predicate — continued 2/2

From an analysis of a concept only conditional propositions follow — \*if\* such a being exists, it exists necessarily — and the antecedent is exactly what was to be proved.



## BASIC NODE 38 | • Objection 3 — the modern logical objection

CAUTION On the standard post-Fregean analysis, "exists" is not a first-order property of individuals but a second-order quantificational notion: to say tigers exist is to say the concept \*tiger\* is instantiated.

If that is right, "existence" cannot appear in the list of perfections at all, and the argument cannot even be stated in its classical form.



## BASIC NODE 39 | • The reply — modal ontological arguments — continued 1/2

CAUTION Twentieth-century defenders (Malcolm, Hartshorne, and in the most discussed form Plantinga) work exclusively with Anselm's second form and with \*necessary\* existence, which they claim is not vulnerable to Kant's objection because it is a modal status rather than a bare existence-predicate.

The skeleton is:

- It is POSSIBLE that a maximally great being exists.
- A maximally great being is one that exists necessarily and is maximally excellent in every possible world.
- If it is possible that such a being exists, then it exists in some possible world.
- Whatever exists necessarily in some possible world



## BASIC NODE 40 | • The reply — modal ontological arguments — continued 2/2

exists in every possible world.

- therefore A maximally great being exists — in the actual world.

CAUTION The burden simply migrates.

The whole weight now rests on premise 1 — the possibility premise.

A parallel "it is possible that no maximally great being exists" yields, by the same modal logic, the opposite conclusion.

So the modal version does not prove God; it converts the dispute into a dispute about whether maximal greatness is genuinely possible, i.e. coherent.

FACT This is precisely the point the authored knowledge file records: **"Possibility premise bears the burden."**





## BASIC NODE 41 | • Does the concept of God entail the existence of God? — the 2018 formulation

FACT 2018, Q6(c), 15 marks: ""Does the concept of God entail the existence of God?

Examine from the perspective of ontological argument.""

CAUTION Model verdict: the concept of God entails existence conceptually — i.e. it is analytic that God, if God exists, exists necessarily and not contingently — but conceptual entailment does not deliver instantiation.

The argument proves at most a conditional: if the concept of a maximally great being is coherent and instantiable, then it is instantiated necessarily.

What it cannot do is establish the antecedent by conceptual means alone.

Hence: entailment within the concept, yes; entailment to reality, no.



## BASIC NODE 42 | • Is there an Indian ontological argument? — continued 1/2

CAUTION There is no exact classical Indian analogue of the ontological argument.

This is itself an examinable observation, and the reason is structural:

| Feature of Indian epistemology | Consequence for an a priori proof |

| --- | --- |

| FACT Nyāya (school of logic and realism) recognises \*pratyakṣa (perception), anumāna (inference), upamāna (comparison as a means of knowledge), śabda (reliable verbal testimony)\* — all of which are contentful, world-involving \*pramāṇas (means of valid knowledge)\* | An argument with no empirical premise has no recognised evidential source |

| FACT Nyāya inference requires \*vyāpti (invariable concomitance)\* (invariable concomitance) established by observed co-presence | Pure conceptual analysis cannot generate \*vyāpti\* |

| FACT Advaita (non-dual school) reaches Brahman (ultimate reality) through \*śruti (revealed scripture)\* plus \*anubhava\*, not through concept-analysis | Brahman is not established by definition but disclosed |

| CAUTION Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) treats the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) as intrinsically valid and authorless | No conceptual route to a divine being is needed or offered |



## BASIC NODE 43 | • Is there an Indian ontological argument? — continued 2/2

CAUTION Safe comparative sentence: ""Indian natural theology is overwhelmingly a posteriori and inferential; the ontological route has no classical Indian counterpart because Indian epistemology grounds existence-claims in pramāṇas (means of valid knowledge) that are world-involving.""



## BASIC NODE 44 | India–West comparison

| | Ontological (West) | Nyāya (school of logic and realism) inference (India) |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Type | FACT A priori, conceptual | FACT A posteriori, inferential |

| Starting point | Concept of maximal greatness | The world as composite effect (\*kārya (effect)\*) |

| Conclusion's modality | Necessary existence | CAUTION Probable existence of an intelligent agent |

| Characteristic objection | Existence is not a real predicate | Weak world–artefact analogy; karma (morally consequential action) may suffice |

| Divine attributes reached | Maximal perfection by definition | Omniscience, eternity, agency — argued for stepwise |



## BASIC NODE 45 | UPSC traps — continued 1/2

- CAUTION Do not present only \*Proslogion\* 2 and omit the second form;

Anselm's reply to Gaunilo \*requires\* the second form.

- CAUTION Gaunilo is not Kant.

Gaunilo offers a parody (the form proves too much);

Kant offers a diagnosis (the form uses "existence" illegitimately).

- CAUTION Do not attribute the island example to Kant, or the thaler example to Gaunilo.
- CAUTION Descartes' ontological proof (\*Meditations\* V) must not be confused with his causal proof from the idea of the infinite (\*Meditations\* III).
- CAUTION The modal version does not defeat Kant "cleanly"; it relocates the problem to the possibility premise.



## BASIC NODE 46 | UPSC traps — continued 2/2

- CAUTION Do not say the ontological argument is "obviously absurd".

It is the argument that has attracted the most sustained modern logical attention of all the proofs.

- CAUTION Do not manufacture an "Indian ontological argument" out of Advaita (non-dual school).

Brahman (ultimate reality) is not established by conceptual analysis.

KEY Mnemonic — "A-D-G-K-M": Anselm defines, Descartes essentialises, Gaunilo parodies, Kant diagnoses, Modal logic repairs (and re-buries the burden).



## BASIC NODE 47 | Revision notes — continued 1/2

- Anselm defines God as that than which nothing greater can be conceived — "greater" means more perfect.
- \*Proslogion\* 2 argues that existing in reality is greater than existing in the mind alone.
- \*Proslogion\* 3 upgrades the conclusion to necessary existence rooted in aseity.
- Descartes makes existence a perfection contained in the essence of a supremely perfect being.
- Gaunilo's \*In Behalf of the Fool\* offers the perfect-island parody.
- Anselm answers that only God is defined as having necessary, non-contingent existence.
- Kant: existence is not a real predicate; a hundred real thalers add no concept to a hundred possible ones.
- Chatterjee–Datta echo this with the hundred-rupees illustration.



## BASIC NODE 48 | Revision notes — continued 2/2

- Frege-style analysis makes existence a second-order quantificational notion, not a perfection.
- Modal versions (Malcolm, Hartshorne, Plantinga) shift the burden onto the possibility premise.
- 2018 asks about concept-to-existence entailment; the correct verdict is conditional entailment without instantiation.
- There is no classical Indian ontological argument, for pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge)-theoretic reasons.



## BASIC NODE 49 | VISUAL VISUAL — Two kinds of causal series (the whole argument turns on this) — continued 1/2

ACCIDENTALLY ORDERED (per accidens) — Aquinas does NOT need to stop this

great-grandfather → grandfather → father → son

Each cause can perish and the effect continues.

An infinite backward series here is not obviously incoherent.

ESSENTIALLY ORDERED (per se) — THIS is what Aquinas terminates

HAND —moves—► STICK —moves—► STONE

Remove the hand and the whole series stops NOW.

Every intermediate member has only DERIVATIVE power.



## BASIC NODE 50 | VISUAL VISUAL — Two kinds of causal series (the whole argument turns on this) — continued 2/2

An infinite series of borrowers with no owner explains nothing.

therefore "FIRST" = EXPLANATORY PRIORITY, not the earliest event in time.

CAUTION This diagram is the single highest-value item in the cosmological answer.

The commonest UPSC error is to reduce all five Ways to "everything had a beginning, so God started it", which is neither Aquinas' argument nor a good argument.



## BASIC NODE 51 | • Aquinas' Five Ways — the map before the detail — continued 1/2

FACT Aquinas offers five ways of proving divine existence (\*Summa Theologiae\* I, q.2, a.3).

Unlike the ontological argument, which focuses on the idea of God and unfolds its inner implications, Aquinas' proofs start from some general feature of the world around us and argue that there could not be a world with this particular characteristic unless there also existed the ultimate reality we call God.

| Way | Starts from | Terminates in |

| ---: | --- | --- |

| 1 | FACT Change / motion | Prime Mover (unmoved mover) |

| 2 | FACT Efficient causation | First Cause |

| 3 | FACT Contingent beings (possibility and necessity) | Necessary Being |

| 4 | FACT Degrees of value and perfection | Absolute Value / maximum |



## BASIC NODE 52 | • Aquinas' Five Ways — the map before the detail — continued 2/2

| 5 | FACT Evidence of purposiveness in nature | Divine Designer |

CAUTION Ways 1–3 constitute the cosmological family;

Way 4 is the henological / degrees argument;

Way 5 is the teleological one, treated in Subtopic 4.

Each concludes with Aquinas' cautious formula, "and this everyone understands to be God" — a phrase that itself concedes that further theological work is needed to identify the terminus with the God of religion.



### BASIC NODE 53 | • Way 1 — from motion — continued 1/2

FACT Reconstruction:

- Some things in the world are in motion (in the broad sense: undergoing change, passing from potentiality to actuality).
- Whatever is moved is moved by another; nothing can be in potentiality and actuality in the same respect at the same time.
- That mover, if itself moved, requires a further mover.
- An essentially ordered series of movers cannot proceed to infinity, for then there would be no first mover and hence no motion now.



### BASIC NODE 54 | • Way 1 — from motion — continued 2/2

- therefore There is a first, unmoved mover — "and this everyone understands to be God."

CAUTION Presupposition: the act–potency analysis of change, and the claim that derivative causal power must be traced to non-derivative power \*here and now\*.

FACT Canonical example (state it in the answer): the stick moves the stone only while the hand moves the stick.

The stick has no power of its own; its causal efficacy is borrowed.

This is what makes the series essentially ordered.



### BASIC NODE 55 | • Way 2 — from efficient causation — continued 1/2

FACT Reconstruction: In the observable world there is an order of efficient causes.

Nothing is the efficient cause of itself, for it would then have to be prior to itself.

In an ordered series of efficient causes, the first is the cause of the intermediate and the intermediate of the last; take away the cause and you take away the effect.

An infinite regress of such causes would remove the first, and hence the intermediate and the last.

Therefore a first efficient cause must be admitted.

CAUTION FACT Hick's assessment, worth reporting: the weakness of the argument as Aquinas states it lies in the difficulty — which Aquinas himself elsewhere acknowledges — of excluding as impossible an endless regress of events requiring no first state.



## BASIC NODE 56 | • Way 2 — from efficient causation — continued 2/2

FACT Neo-Thomists reformulate it by insisting that the excluded series is not a regress of \*events back in time\* but an endless and therefore \*eternally inconclusive\* series of dependent causes existing simultaneously.

CAUTION Do not miss the historical point: Aquinas holds, on philosophical grounds alone, that the universe \*could\* be eternal; that it began is known by faith, not demonstration.

So Way 2 is not, and cannot be, an argument for a temporal beginning.



## BASIC NODE 57 | • Way 3 — from contingency — continued 1/2

FACT Reconstruction:

- We find things that are possible-to-be and possible-not-to-be

(they are generated and corrupted).

- What is possible-not-to-be at some time is not.

- If everything were contingent, then at some time nothing would have existed.

- If nothing existed at some time, nothing would exist now, since what does not exist begins to exist only through something that already exists.

- therefore Not all beings are merely possible; there must be something NECESSARY.



## BASIC NODE 58 | • Way 3 — from contingency — continued 2/2

- Every necessary being either has its necessity from another or from itself;

the series of necessity-from-another cannot regress infinitely.

- therefore There exists a being necessary of itself — "this all men speak of as God."

CAUTION Two vulnerable steps. (i) Step 3 arguably commits a quantifier shift: from "for each thing there is a time at which it does not exist" it does not follow that "there is a time at which no thing exists". (ii) Step 6 needs the distinction — Aquinas himself makes it — between beings necessary \*ab alio\* (angels, on his scheme) and the being necessary \*a se\*.

CAUTION Precision worth writing: Way 3 is not the same as Way 2.

Way 2 concerns causal \*dependence\*;

Way 3 concerns \*modal status\* — contingency versus necessity.

A script that merges them loses the very distinction the 2022 question was testing.



## BASIC NODE 59 | • Way 4 — from degrees of perfection

FACT Reconstruction: Among beings there are some more and some less good, true and noble.

But "more" and "less" are predicated of things according as they resemble in different degrees something which is the maximum.

Therefore there must be something which is truest, best and noblest, and consequently something which is the cause of being, goodness and every perfection in all things — and this we call God.

CAUTION This is the least popular Way and the one most exposed to the objection that comparative judgements do not require an existing maximum (a "hottest possible thing" is not entailed by degrees of heat).

Its defence requires the Platonic-Aristotelian machinery of participation and of a cause containing eminently what it confers.

CAUTION It is nonetheless the Way most useful for showing the examiner that you understand Aquinas' metaphysics of participation rather than only his causal reasoning.



## BASIC NODE 60 | • The Kalām cosmological argument — continued 1/2

FACT The Kalām form, which originates in Islamic philosophical theology and has been revived in modern discussion, is structurally different from Aquinas:

- Whatever BEGINS to exist has a cause of its beginning.
- The universe began to exist.
- therefore The universe has a cause of its beginning.

(+ conceptual analysis: that cause is beginningless, uncaused, changeless, timeless, immaterial, enormously powerful — and personal, since only agency explains a temporal effect from a timeless cause.)

CAUTION Contrast to state explicitly: the Kalām argues \*for\* a temporal beginning and therefore engages Big-Bang cosmology directly;



## BASIC NODE 61 | • The Kalām cosmological argument — continued 2/2

Aquinas' Ways deliberately do not require one.

Collapsing the two is the standard textbook error.



## BASIC NODE 62 | • Leibniz and the Principle of Sufficient Reason

CAUTION Leibniz's version asks not "what started it?" but "why is there something rather than nothing?" Every fact requires a sufficient reason; the totality of contingent facts is itself contingent; therefore its sufficient reason must lie in a necessary being.

This is the version that engages the modern brute-fact debate.



**BASIC NODE 63 | • Objections and replies — continued 1/3**

| Objection | Aimed at | Reply | Residual pressure |

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

| FACT Hume: why not an infinite series, with each member explained by its predecessor? | Ways 1–3 | CAUTION The series concerned is essentially ordered; an infinite set of derivative causes still has no non-derivative actualising power | CAUTION Requires proving the series \*is\* essentially ordered, not merely asserting it |

| FACT Hume: explaining each member explains the whole; the demand for a cause of the collection is illegitimate | Leibnizian version | CAUTION A contingent totality is not made self-explanatory by enlarging the set |

QUESTION Tracks a genuine dispute over the scope of the PSR |



**BASIC NODE 64 | • Objections and replies — continued 2/3**

| FACT Fallacy of composition: because each part has a cause, the whole need not | Cosmological family | CAUTION The argument concerns \*dependence\*, not the transfer of a shared property | CAUTION Must be stated as an essentially ordered series to hold |

| FACT Kant: the cosmological argument covertly relies on the ontological | Ways 2–3 | CAUTION Thomists deny the covert reliance: they identify the necessary being with God through further metaphysical argument, not by definition | CAUTION Even so, the identification is a separate and disputable stage |

| FACT Hume: why must the cause be one, personal, infinite or good? | All | CAUTION Cumulative-case strategies add attributes from several arguments together | FACT \*No single proof reaches classical theism\* |



**BASIC NODE 65 | • Objections and replies — continued 3/3**

| CAUTION Brute fact: the universe may simply be there | Leibnizian version | CAUTION Explanatory demand does not evaporate merely because it is inconvenient | QUESTION Genuinely unresolved |

CAUTION Kant's objection, spelled out because it is frequently mis-stated: the cosmological argument concludes to a \*necessary being\*; but to move from "a necessary being" to "the most real being (\*ens realissimum\*)", i.e. God", one must argue that only the most perfect being can be necessary — and that step is the ontological argument.

Kant's point is therefore an adequacy-tier attack: the cosmological argument's own resources take it only to "something necessary", and it borrows the rest.





## BASIC NODE 66 | • India–West comparison — continued 1/2

| | Aquinas (Ways 1–3) | Nyāya (school of logic and realism) kāryāt (from the world's being an effect) |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Starting fact | FACT Motion, causation, contingency | FACT The world is a composite \*effect\* |

| Reason the world needs a cause | Derivative actuality requires non-derivative act | Composite parts + intermediate magnitude => producedness |

| Nature of the cause | FACT Pure act; creator of \*being\* itself | FACT Intelligent efficient cause who \*orders\* pre-existing eternal atoms |

| Material cause | God creates \*ex nihilo\*; no independent matter | FACT Eternal atoms are the material cause;

God is not |

| Continuing relation | Conservation of being | FACT Creation, maintenance, destruction — hence theism, not deism |



## BASIC NODE 67 | • India–West comparison — continued 2/2

| Chief internal difficulty | Regress-exclusion; identification with God | Analogy from artefact to world; sufficiency of karma (morally consequential action) |

CAUTION The single sharpest comparative sentence available for 2018 Q8(a): **"Both are a posteriori inferences from features of the world to an intelligent ultimate cause; but Aquinas' God confers existence itself, whereas Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s Īśvara (Lord or personal God) confers only order upon eternally existing atoms and souls."**



## BASIC NODE 68 | UPSC traps — continued 1/2

• CAUTION Do not merge the five Ways into one temporal "first cause" argument.

They start from different features and terminate in differently described conclusions.

• CAUTION "First" means explanatory priority, not chronological firstness.

• CAUTION Aquinas does not argue that the universe began in time; he holds that its beginning is known by faith.

• CAUTION The Kalām \*does\* argue for a temporal beginning; it is not Aquinas' argument.

• CAUTION Do not attribute Paley's watch to Aquinas (see Subtopic 4).

• CAUTION Kant's objection is that the cosmological argument \*borrows\* the ontological argument, not that it is invalid on its own terms.

• CAUTION Way 3 is modal (contingency/necessity);



## BASIC NODE 69 | UPSC traps — continued 2/2

Way 2 is causal.

Keep them apart.

- CAUTION Do not say Hume "refuted" the cosmological argument; he attacked the necessity of the regress-stop and the identification of the cause with God.

KEY Mnemonic — "MCC-DP": Motion, Causation, Contingency (the cosmological three); then Degrees and Purpose (Ways 4 and 5).



## BASIC NODE 70 | Revision notes — continued 1/3

- Aquinas' Ways begin from general features of the world, unlike the a priori ontological argument.

- Way 1: motion → prime mover;

Way 2: efficient causation → first cause;

Way 3: contingency → necessary being.

- Way 4: degrees of perfection → maximum;

Way 5: purposiveness → designer.

- The regress excluded is essentially ordered (hand–stick–stone), not accidentally ordered.

- "First" is explanatory, not temporal;



## BASIC NODE 71 | Revision notes — continued 2/3

Aquinas permits an eternal universe philosophically.

- Neo-Thomists reinterpret the excluded series as simultaneous dependence, not backward time.

- Kalām: whatever begins to exist has a cause; the universe began; therefore it has a cause.

- Leibniz's PSR version asks why there is something rather than nothing.

- Hume: infinite regress may be acceptable; explaining parts may explain the whole; the cause need not be God.

- Kant: the move from "necessary being" to "God" imports the ontological argument.

- Fallacy-of-composition charge is met by framing dependence rather than property-transfer.

- Aquinas' God causes being;



## BASIC NODE 72 | Revision notes — continued 3/3

Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s Īśvara (Lord or personal God) causes only order among eternal atoms.



## BASIC NODE 73 | VISUAL VISUAL — Three teleologies that must not be confused — continued 1/3

| (A) AQUINAS, FIFTH WAY — regularity of NON-COGNITIVE nature |  
 | Natural bodies without knowledge act for an end, |  
 | and do so ALWAYS or NEARLY ALWAYS in the same way. |  
 | Whatever lacks knowledge cannot move toward an end unless |  
 | directed by something with knowledge → as the ARROW by the |  
 | ARCHER. therefore an intelligent being directs natural things. |  
 | NOT an analogy with human artefacts. |



## BASIC NODE 74 | VISUAL VISUAL — Three teleologies that must not be confused — continued 2/3

| (B) PALEY (1802) — ANALOGY from ARTEFACT to ORGANISM |  
 | Watch on the heath : watchmaker :: eye, wing, fin : Designer |  
 | Biological means-end ADJUSTMENT is the evidence. |  
 | → Directly vulnerable to Darwin. |  
 | (C) FINE-TUNING (modern) — PROBABILISTIC, not analogical |  
 | Cosmological constants lie in an extremely narrow life-permitting |



## BASIC NODE 75 | VISUAL VISUAL — Three teleologies that must not be confused — continued 3/3

| range → design as inference to the best explanation. |

| Rivals: multiverse, anthropic selection, brute necessity. |

| → NOT touched by Darwin, because it is pre-biological. |

CAUTION Reproducing this three-way distinction is what separates a 60% answer from a 75% answer in 2025 Q6(a).

Most candidates write Paley, get demolished by Darwin, and stop.



## BASIC NODE 76 | • Aquinas' Fifth Way — stated properly

FACT The design argument occurs in philosophical literature from Plato's *\*Timaeus\** onward, and appears again as the last of Aquinas' five Ways.

FACT The Fifth Way is *\*not\** an analogy with human manufacture.

Its premise is that things which lack cognition nevertheless act for an end, and do so with regularity — which cannot be chance.

Hence they are directed by an intelligent being, as the arrow is directed by the archer.

CAUTION Why the difference matters: Darwinian natural selection is a direct competitor to Paley's premise (biological adaptation) but a much less direct competitor to Aquinas' premise (the regular law-like directedness of nature as such), which arguably persists after evolution is granted.



## BASIC NODE 77 | • Paley's watch — continued 1/2

FACT Paley's analogy of the watch conveys the essence of the argument.

Walking in a desert place I see a stone, and may properly attribute its presence to the operation of natural forces — wind, rain, heat, frost, volcanic action.

But if I find a watch, I cannot reasonably account for it in the same way.

A watch consists of a complex arrangement of wheels, cogs, axles, springs and balances, all operating accurately together to give a regular measurement of time.

I am obliged to postulate an intelligent mind responsible for the phenomenon.

FACT Paley's three supplementary points — quote them; they anticipate obvious replies:

- FACT The inference is not weakened if I have never seen a watch made (as we have never seen a world other than this one) and therefore do not know from direct observation that watches are products of intelligence.



## BASIC NODE 78 | • Paley's watch — continued 2/2

• FACT The inference is not invalidated if the mechanism does not always work perfectly — as may appear to be the case with the mechanism of the world.

• FACT The inference is not undermined if there are parts whose function we cannot discover — as there are in nature.

FACT Paley then argues that the natural world is as complex a mechanism, and as manifestly designed, as any watch: the rotation of the planets, the procession of the seasons, the mutual adaptation of the parts of a living organism.

The eye, in particular, is a superb optical instrument with self-adjusting lenses, colour sensitivity and long continuous operation; the bird's wing is suited to the air and the fish's fin to the water.

CAUTION Paley's is a long cumulative argument drawing on virtually all the sciences of his day — not a single inference.

Saying so is worth a mark.



## BASIC NODE 79 | • Hume's critique — the 2025 question's centre of gravity — continued 1/4

FACT The classic critique of the design argument occurs in David Hume's \*Dialogues Concerning Natural Religion\*, published in 1779, twenty-three years before Paley's book — and Paley took no apparent account of it.

That chronological point is a genuine fact worth stating, because it forestalls the naive assumption that Hume was replying to Paley.

Hume's attack proceeds on five fronts:

| # | Front | Hume's argument | Tier attacked |

| ---: | --- | --- | --- |

| 1 | FACT Any universe must look designed | There could not be a universe at all in which the parts were not adapted to one another to a considerable degree — there could not be birds that grew wings but, like fish, could not live in air.

So apparent adaptation is not evidence of design; it is a precondition of any persisting order.



## BASIC NODE 80 | • Hume's critique — the 2025 question's centre of gravity — continued 2/4

He proposes the Epicurean hypothesis: a finite number of particles in random motion will, in unlimited time, pass through every possible combination; one such combination is a stable order — perhaps ours. | Soundness |

| 2 | FACT The analogy is weak | The universe is not particularly like a machine.

One could as plausibly liken it to a great inert animal such as a crustacean, or to a vegetable — in which case the argument fails, since whether crustaceans and vegetables are designed is precisely the question at issue.

Only if the world is strikingly analogous to a human artefact is there a basis for inferring a Designer. | Soundness |

| 3 | FACT Proportioning cause to effect | From a given effect we can infer only a cause sufficient to produce it; therefore from a finite world we can never infer an infinite creator.



### BASIC NODE 81 | • Hume's critique — the 2025 question's centre of gravity — continued 3/4

Hume's illustration: if I see one side of a pair of scales and observe that ten ounces is outweighed by the unseen side, I may infer that the unseen weight exceeds ten ounces — but never that it is infinite. | Adequacy |

| 4 | FACT Plurality and imperfection of designers | Great works are often built by many hands; the world may be the product of many deities, or an inferior deity, or a senile or infant one, or a bungled first attempt abandoned by its maker. | Adequacy |

| 5 | FACT Evil and disorder | The mixed character of the world — waste, suffering, disease, catastrophe — counts against inferring a designer who is both good and powerful. | Adequacy |

CAUTION FACT The trap: Hume does not claim to prove that no designer exists.

His target is the strength of the inference and the attributes of the being inferred.



### BASIC NODE 82 | • Hume's critique — the 2025 question's centre of gravity — continued 4/4

In the \*Dialogues\* Philo himself concedes a remote, undefined analogy between the cause of order in the universe and human intelligence.

Writing "Hume disproved design" is a factual error.



### BASIC NODE 83 | • Darwin — continued 1/2

FACT The Darwinian theory of natural selection gives a more concrete account of the apparently designed character of animal bodies.

Small random variations occur in every generation; species are relatively well adapted because the less well-adapted have perished in the continual competition to survive and have not perpetuated their kind.

The "struggle for survival", as a constant pressure toward better adaptation, lies behind the evolution of life into increasingly complex forms.

FACT Hick's ozone illustration reverses the design intuition beautifully: animal life is not sheltered by the ozone layer because God created the animals and then installed a filter for them; rather the ozone layer was there first, and only those forms of life capable of existing under the precise level of ultraviolet radiation that penetrates it have developed on earth.



### BASIC NODE 84 | • Darwin — continued 2/2

CAUTION Exact scope of Darwin's defeat: natural selection removes biological adaptation as evidence of design — that is, it removes Paley's premise.

It does not touch (i) Aquinas' law-like directedness of non-cognitive nature, (ii) the fine-tuning of the physical constants that make chemistry and biology possible at all, or (iii) the question why there are law-governed regularities in the first place.



**BASIC NODE 85 | • Fine-tuning and the probabilistic turn — continued 1/2**

CAUTION Modern design reasoning is typically Bayesian or explanatory rather than analogical: the life-permitting values of certain cosmological parameters are said to be enormously improbable on chance, and less surprising on theism, so they raise the probability of theism.

| Line of defence | Rival explanation | Assessment |

| --- | --- | --- |

| CAUTION Fine-tuning of constants | Multiverse plus observation-selection effect | QUESTION Neither decisively wins; the dispute is about the legitimacy of the probability assignments |

| CAUTION Intelligibility and law-governedness of nature | Brute necessity; the laws could not have been otherwise | CAUTION Shifts the question rather than closing it |

| CAUTION Cumulative case (Swinburne-style) | Underdetermination — many hypotheses fit | CAUTION Yields a probability claim, never a demonstration |



**BASIC NODE 86 | • Fine-tuning and the probabilistic turn — continued 2/2**

CURRENT As noted, the 2025 review and 2026 paper both foreground exactly this migration — Paley → irreducible complexity → cosmic fine-tuning.

CAUTION Use it as one contemporary sentence and no more.

UPSC rewards Hume and Paley, not physics.



**BASIC NODE 87 | • The Indian analogue — potter and pot — continued 1/2**

FACT Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s inference is the closest Indian analogue: the world is treated as a vastly more complex \*kārya (effect)\* (effect) than a pot, and a pot's ordered parts warrant inference to a potter.

FACT Chatterjee and Datta observe that the Naiyāyika (adherent of the school of logic and realism)'s causal argument strikingly resembles the reasoning of Western thinkers such as Paul Janet, Hermann Lotze and James Martineau, for whom the world of finite objects requires an intelligent cause giving order and co-ordination to its concurrent physical causes;

Janet lays it down that all co-ordination between divergent phenomena implies a final cause or an intelligent agent.

FACT The Naiyāyika view of efficient cause as intelligent agent, they add, "strikingly anticipates Martineau's idea of cause as will directed to the realization of ends."



**BASIC NODE 88 | • The Indian analogue — potter and pot — continued 2/2**

FACT But the decisive difference: Western theists generally believe God is not only the cause of the unity/order of things but also the creative energy that gives existence to the things of Nature.

For the Naiyāyikas (adherents of the school of logic and realism), God is only the cause of the order of Nature, and not of the existence of its ultimate constituents.

CAUTION Hume's second objection — that the world is unlike an artefact — therefore lands on Nyāya (school of logic and realism) with full force, since Nyāya's inference is explicitly artefact-modelled (\*ghaṭavat (like a pot)\*, "like a pot").



### BASIC NODE 89 | • Solved PYQ — 2025, Q6(a), 20 marks — continued 1/3

FACT Exact question: \*\*\*Present an account of Design argument to prove the existence of God along with its criticism by David Hume.\*\*\*

Answer spine (write this shape, not a list):

- CLASSIFY : teleological = a posteriori; distinguish Aquinas' Way 5 (regularity of non-cognitive nature, archer-arrow) from Paley's artefact ANALOGY.
- RECONSTRUCT: Paley's watch on the heath + his three supplementary points (never seen one made; imperfect working; unknown parts) + the eye, wing, fin, seasons; note it is a CUMULATIVE argument.
- CRITICISE : Hume, Dialogues (1779, PRIOR to Paley) on five fronts —



### BASIC NODE 90 | • Solved PYQ — 2025, Q6(a), 20 marks — continued 2/3

(a) any universe must look adapted;

Epicurean hypothesis

(b) the world is as like a vegetable/animal as a machine

(c) proportion cause to effect: finite world => at most finite cause

(the scales illustration)

(d) many/imperfect/infant/absentee designers are equally supported

(e) evil and disorder count against a good designer

- EXTEND : Darwin removes Paley's biological premise (ozone illustration);



### BASIC NODE 91 | • Solved PYQ — 2025, Q6(a), 20 marks — continued 3/3

but fine-tuning relocates the argument to pre-biological constants.

- GRADE : Hume defeats DEMONSTRATION and defeats the inference to the infinite, single, perfectly good God; he does not disprove design.

Design survives only as inference to the best explanation.

- CONCLUDE : teleology retains cumulative and religious force while forfeiting demonstrative status; it points beyond the world without compelling.





## BASIC NODE 92 | India–West comparison

| | Paley / Way 5 | Nyāya (school of logic and realism) āyojanāt (from combination or coordination) |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Evidence | FACT Means–end adjustment in organisms; regular directedness in nature | FACT Purposive combination of inert atoms into an ordered world |

| Model | Watch → watchmaker; arrow → archer | FACT Pot → potter |

| Cause's role | Creates and orders | FACT Orders only; atoms are eternal |

| Cause's knowledge | Intelligence adequate to the design | FACT Omniscience, since only an omniscient being can directly know entities as simple and infinitesimal as atoms |

| Main critic | Hume, Darwin | Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty), Buddhism, Jainism, Cārvāka (materialist school) |



## BASIC NODE 93 | UPSC traps — continued 1/2

• CAUTION Paley's watch is not Aquinas'.

Aquinas' Fifth Way is about the regular goal-directedness of non-cognitive nature.

• CAUTION Hume's \*Dialogues\* (1779) precede Paley's \*Natural Theology\* (1802).

• CAUTION Hume does not disprove a designer; he attacks inference-strength and divine attributes.

• CAUTION Darwin defeats Paley's biological premise, not every form of teleology.

• CAUTION Fine-tuning is probabilistic and pre-biological; it is not "Paley with physics".

• CAUTION "Irreducible complexity" is a modern, contested move — mention, never endorse.

• CAUTION Do not conflate the design argument with the problem of evil; evil enters here only as \*one\* of Hume's five fronts.



## BASIC NODE 94 | UPSC traps — continued 2/2

• CAUTION Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s design-type inference reaches an \*orderer\*, not a creator of matter.

KEY Mnemonic — Hume's five fronts, "A-A-P-P-E": Any universe looks adapted · Analogy is weak · Proportion cause to effect · Plurality/imperfection of designers · Evil.



## BASIC NODE 95 | Revision notes — continued 1/2

- Teleology runs from Plato's \*Timaeus\* through Aquinas' Fifth Way to Paley and modern fine-tuning.
- Aquinas' Fifth Way: unknowing natural bodies act regularly for ends, as the arrow is directed by the archer.
- Paley: the watch on the heath obliges us to postulate an intelligent maker.
- Paley's three riders: never seen one made; imperfect working; unknown parts.
- Paley's evidence is cumulative — eye, wing, fin, planetary motion, seasons.
- Hume front 1: any persisting universe must exhibit adaptation;  
Epicurean hypothesis.
- Hume front 2: the world is as like a vegetable or animal as a machine.



## BASIC NODE 96 | Revision notes — continued 2/2

- Hume front 3: proportion cause to effect — a finite world yields at most a finite cause (scales illustration).
- Hume front 4: many, imperfect, infant or absentee designers fit the evidence equally.
- Hume front 5: evil and disorder tell against a good and powerful designer.
- Darwin supplies a naturalistic mechanism for adaptation; the ozone case reverses the design intuition.
- Fine-tuning relocates design to pre-biological constants; multiverse and anthropic selection are the rivals.
- Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s \*āyojanāt (from combination or coordination)\* is the Indian analogue, modelled on potter and pot, reaching an orderer of eternal atoms.
- Verdict: teleology survives as inference to the best explanation, not as demonstration.



## BASIC NODE 97 | VISUAL VISUAL — Kant's two-storey structure — continued 1/5

===== THEORETICAL REASON (Critique of Pure Reason) =====

Categories apply only within possible EXPERIENCE.

God, freedom, immortality are IDEAS of reason — no intuition

corresponds to them.

↓

ONTOLOGICAL → demolished: existence is not a real predicate

COSMOLOGICAL → demolished: covertly presupposes the ontological

PHYSICO-THEOL. → demolished: reaches at most an architect,

↓

## BASIC NODE 98 | VISUAL VISUAL — Kant's two-storey structure — continued 2/5

(design) then leans on the cosmological, then on the

ontological

↓

VERDICT: SPECULATIVE THEOLOGY IS IMPOSSIBLE.

God is not KNOWN.

||

"I had to deny knowledge

↓

## BASIC NODE 99 | VISUAL VISUAL — Kant's two-storey structure — continued 3/5

to make room for faith."

||

===== PRACTICAL REASON (Critique of Practical Reason) =====

The moral law is a FACT of reason; it commands categorically.

↓

It commands us to promote the HIGHEST GOOD (summum bonum)

= complete virtue + happiness PROPORTIONED to virtue

↓



## BASIC NODE 100 | VISUAL VISUAL — Kant's two-storey structure — continued 4/5

Ought implies can → the highest good must be POSSIBLE

↓

But: complete virtue is unattainable in a finite lifetime → IMMORTALITY

and nature does not proportion happiness to virtue → GOD

(plus FREEDOM, presupposed by obligation itself)

↓

THREE POSTULATES: FREEDOM · IMMORTALITY · GOD

These are objects of RATIONAL FAITH (Vernunftglaube),



## BASIC NODE 101 | VISUAL VISUAL — Kant's two-storey structure — continued 5/5

NOT items of theoretical knowledge.

=====

CAUTION The whole examinable point is in the architecture, not the content.

Kant is the destroyer of the theistic proofs \*and\* the author of a moral argument, and he sees no contradiction because the two operate on different storeys.



## BASIC NODE 102 | • The first form of the moral argument — and why it fails — continued 1/2

FACT Hick distinguishes a first form of the argument that is presented as a logical inference: from objective moral laws to a divine Law Giver; or from the objectivity of moral values to a transcendent Ground of Values; or from the fact of conscience to a God whose "voice" conscience is.

FACT Newman's version (\*A Grammar of Assent\*, 1870): "If, as is the case, we feel responsibility, are ashamed, are frightened, at transgressing the voice of conscience, this implies that there is One to whom we are responsible, before whom we are ashamed, whose claims upon us we fear... If the cause of these emotions does not belong to this visible world, the Object to which the conscientious person's perception is directed must be Supernatural and Divine."



## BASIC NODE 103 | • The first form of the moral argument — and why it fails — continued 2/2

FACT Hick's objection: the basic assumption of all such arguments is that moral values are not capable of naturalistic explanation — in terms of human needs, desires, ideals, self-interest, or the structure of human nature or society.

To make that assumption is to beg the question.

An essential premise of the inference from axiology to God is precisely what is in dispute; from the sceptic's standpoint nothing has been established.



## BASIC NODE 104 | • Kant's second form — the postulates — continued 1/3

FACT The second kind of moral argument "is not open to the same objection, for it is not strictly a proof at all." It claims that anyone seriously committed to respecting moral values as exercising a sovereign claim upon their life must thereby implicitly believe in a transhuman source and basis for those values.

FACT Kant's own structure (\*Critique of Practical Reason\*, Book II, Ch. 2):

- The moral law categorically obligates the will; obligation presupposes FREEDOM.

- The complete object of a morally determined will is the HIGHEST GOOD:

virtue (worthiness to be happy) together with happiness proportioned to it.

- Reason commands us to promote the highest good; "ought implies can",

so the highest good must be really possible.

- Perfect conformity of the will to the moral law (holiness) cannot be



### BASIC NODE 105 | • Kant's second form — the postulates — continued 2/3

achieved by a finite being at any moment of its existence

→ an endless progress is required → POSTULATE OF IMMORTALITY.

• Nature and morality are causally independent; a finite agent cannot ensure

that happiness follows virtue → a cause of the whole of nature,

distinct from nature, possessing intelligence and will, must be postulated

→ POSTULATE OF GOD.

• These are postulates of PRACTICAL reason: theoretically undemonstrable

propositions inseparably attached to an unconditionally valid practical law.



### BASIC NODE 106 | • Kant's second form — the postulates — continued 3/3

CAUTION Three postulates, not one.

Freedom, immortality and God.

Many scripts mention only God and lose the systematic point.



### BASIC NODE 107 | • What a postulate is — and is not — continued 1/2

| A postulate of practical reason is | A postulate is not |

| --- | --- |

| CAUTION A proposition whose acceptance is rationally required if the moral law is to be coherently obeyed | FACT A speculative demonstration |

| CAUTION An object of \*Vernunftglaube\* — rational faith | FACT An empirical hypothesis confirmable by evidence |

| CAUTION Practically necessary, theoretically undecidable | FACT A theoretical extension of knowledge |

| CAUTION Subjectively sufficient, objectively insufficient assent | FACT A dogma imposed on the sceptic |

FACT Hick's verdict, which is also the safest exam verdict: to recognise moral claims as taking precedence over all other interests is implicitly to believe in a reality other than the natural world that is superior to oneself and entitled to one's obedience.

This is "at least a move in the direction of belief in God".



## BASIC NODE 108 | • What a postulate is — and is not — continued 2/2

But it cannot be presented as a proof, because the sovereign authority of moral obligation can itself be questioned; and even if moral values point toward a transcendent ground, they cannot be said to point all the way to the infinite, omnipotent, self-existent, personal creator of biblical faith.



## BASIC NODE 109 | • Objections and replies — continued 1/2

| Objection | Force | Reply | Residual |

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

| FACT It assumes moral values resist naturalistic explanation (Hick, against the first form) | Fatal to Newman-type inference | CAUTION Kant's version does not infer from values to a Lawgiver; it postulates conditions of the highest good | CAUTION But the sceptic may deny the highest good is obligatory |

| CAUTION Wish-fulfilment / projection: the postulate merely dresses up a desire for cosmic fairness | Serious | CAUTION Kant answers that the postulate arises from the \*structure of moral reason\*, not from reward-seeking; acting for reward would be heteronomy and would destroy moral worth | CAUTION The line between "rational hope" and "consoling wish" is thin |

| CAUTION Autonomy tension: if morality is autonomous, why does it need God at all? | Serious and internal | CAUTION Kant does not ground \*obligation\* in God;



## BASIC NODE 110 | • Objections and replies — continued 2/2

God enters only for the \*realisability\* of the highest good | CAUTION Some Kantians (and Kant in places) suggest the highest good could be reconceived so as not to need the postulate |

| FACT Euthyphro dilemma: is the good good because God wills it, or does God will it because it is good? | Fatal to divine-command versions | CAUTION Kant is untouched: for him the moral law is not divine command;

God is the guarantor of proportion, not the source of obligation | FACT Useful to show which versions the dilemma actually hits |

| CAUTION Adequacy: postulation reaches a moral governor, not the God of religion | Standard | CAUTION Kant grants it: he claims practical faith, not theology | FACT Reinforces the "no single proof reaches classical theism" thesis |



## BASIC NODE 111 | • The Indian counterpart — Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s \*karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits)\* — continued 1/2

FACT This is a genuine and underused comparison.

Chatterjee and Datta, expounding the Nyāya argument from \*adr̥ṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\*, write that God "combines happiness with virtue and misery with vice" — and note explicitly: "Or, as Kant would say, it is God who combines happiness with virtue and misery with vice."

| | Kant | Nyāya |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Problem addressed | CAUTION Nature does not proportion happiness to virtue | FACT Unconscious \*adr̥ṣṭa\* cannot allot determinate fruits |

| Role assigned to God | Postulated author of a nature in which the highest good is possible | FACT \*Karmaphaladātā\* — actual dispenser of the fruits of action, the moral governor |

| Epistemic status | CAUTION Practical postulate; theoretically undemonstrable | FACT Conclusion of an \*anumāna (inference)\*, claimed as knowledge |

| Where the proportioning happens | Beyond this life, over an endless progress | FACT Across this and previous lives, through \*adr̥ṣṭa\* |



## BASIC NODE 112 | • The Indian counterpart — Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s \*karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits)\* — continued 2/2

| Chief rival | Naturalistic ethics | FACT Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty): karma (morally consequential action) is self-operating; no dispenser is needed |

CAUTION Sharp exam sentence: "Kant postulates a God who could proportion happiness to virtue;

Nyāya infers a God who actually does.

The Indian argument is therefore epistemically bolder and correspondingly more exposed — it must show that an unconscious principle could not do the job."



## BASIC NODE 113 | • Solved PYQ — 2021, Q7(b), 15 marks — continued 1/3

FACT Exact question: "Give a critical account of moral argument to prove the existence of God."

FRAME : Kant's two storeys — speculative proofs destroyed in CPR;

God re-entered in CPrR as practical postulate.

STATE : Two forms — (i) inference from objective moral law/conscience to a

Lawgiver (Newman); (ii) Kant's postulation from the highest good.

BUILD : moral law → highest good → ought implies can → virtue unattainable

in finite time (immortality) + nature does not proportion happiness

to virtue (God).





### BASIC NODE 114 | • Solved PYQ — 2021, Q7(b), 15 marks — continued 2/3

Three postulates: freedom, immortality, God.

CRITIQUE: (a) first form begs the question against naturalistic axiology;

(b) projection/wish-fulfilment charge; (c) autonomy tension;

(d) Euthyphro hits divine-command, not Kant;

(e) adequacy — reaches a moral governor, not the biblical creator.

COMPARE : Nyaya (school of logic and realism)'s karmaphaladata (dispenser of karmic fruits) — same problem, stronger epistemic claim.

GRADE : as a PROOF it fails and was never offered as one; as an account of

the practical presuppositions of the moral life it retains force.



### BASIC NODE 115 | • Solved PYQ — 2021, Q7(b), 15 marks — continued 3/3

CONCLUDE: the moral argument does not prove God; it shows what a serious

moral agent must hope, which is a different and more defensible claim.



### BASIC NODE 116 | UPSC traps — continued 1/2

- CAUTION Kant does not prove God through morality.

He postulates God for practical reason.

This is the topic's most penalised error.

- CAUTION Three postulates — freedom, immortality, God — not one.

- CAUTION Newman's conscience argument is \*not\* Kant's; keep the two forms separate.

- CAUTION God is not the source of moral obligation for Kant; the moral law is autonomous.

- CAUTION Euthyphro refutes divine-command theories, not Kant's postulate.

- CAUTION "Ought implies can" applies to promoting the highest good, not to achieving it single-handedly.



## BASIC NODE 117 | UPSC traps — continued 2/2

- CAUTION Do not present the postulate as a reward-motive; that would be heteronomy and would destroy moral worth on Kant's own terms.
- CAUTION Do not omit the Indian comparison; \*karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits)\* is the natural Indian counterpart.

KEY Mnemonic — "F-I-G": Freedom, Immortality, God — Kant's three postulates.



## BASIC NODE 118 | Revision notes — continued 1/2

- Kant destroys the ontological, cosmological and physico-theological proofs in the \*Critique of Pure Reason\*.
- He shows the cosmological and design arguments ultimately lean on the ontological.
- In the \*Critique of Practical Reason\* he postulates God, immortality and freedom.
- The moral law is a fact of reason and commands categorically.
- Its complete object is the highest good: virtue plus proportionate happiness.
- Ought implies can, so the highest good must be possible.
- Holiness is unattainable in finite time, hence immortality is postulated.
- Nature does not proportion happiness to virtue, hence God is postulated.



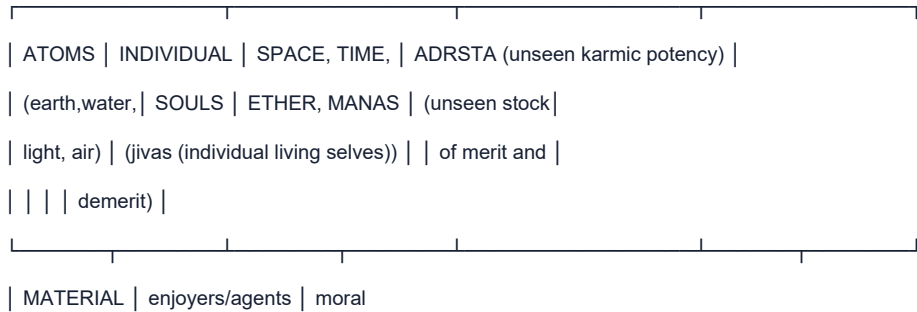
## BASIC NODE 119 | Revision notes — continued 2/2

- A postulate is practically necessary and theoretically undemonstrable — rational faith.
  - Newman's conscience argument is the first form and begs the question against naturalism.
  - Hick: the moral argument moves toward belief in God but cannot reach the infinite personal creator.
  - Euthyphro strikes divine-command theories, not Kant's postulate.
  - Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s \*karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits)\* is the Indian analogue;
- Chatterjee–Datta explicitly invoke Kant.
- Verdict: not a proof, but a defensible account of the practical presuppositions of moral seriousness.



BASIC NODE 120 | VISUAL VISUAL — Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s cosmic division of labour — continued 1/4

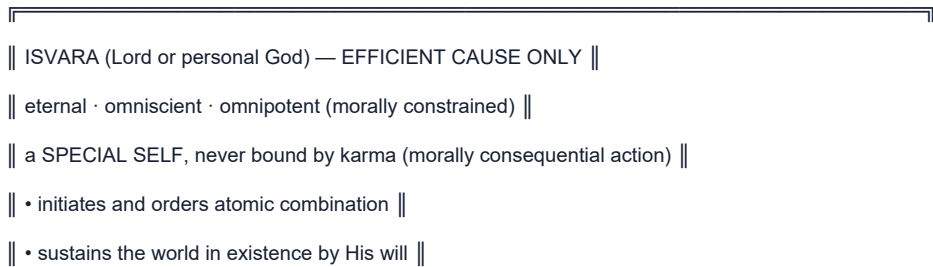
ETERNAL, UNCREATED, CO-PRESENT WITH GOD



BASIC NODE 121 | VISUAL VISUAL — Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s cosmic division of labour — continued 2/4

| CAUSE | | desert

▼ ▼ ▼



### BASIC NODE 122 | VISUAL VISUAL — Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s cosmic division of labour — continued 3/4

|| • destroys when the moral order requires ||

|| • dispenses the fruits of adrsta (karmaphaladata (dispenser of karmic fruits)) ||

|| • is the author (apta (trustworthy competent person)) of the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) ||

=====

=> GOD IS NIMITTA-KARANA (efficient cause), NOT UPADANA-KARANA (material cause)

(material cause).

Atoms are the material cause.

CAUTION Write this distinction in the first two lines of any Nyāya answer.



### BASIC NODE 123 | VISUAL VISUAL — Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s cosmic division of labour — continued 4/4

It is the trap the examiner is checking for, and it is the difference between Nyāya and both Advaita (non-dual school) and Rāmānuja.



### BASIC NODE 124 | • The idea of God in Nyāya (school of logic and realism) — continued 1/3

FACT God is the creator of the world in the sense of being the first efficient cause of the world and not its material cause — "a sort of demiurgus or a builder of the ordered universe".

FACT He is also the preserver, in so far as the world is kept in existence by the will of God, and the destroyer, who lets loose the forces of destruction when the exigencies of the moral world require it.

FACT God is one, infinite and eternal, since the world of space and time, minds and souls does not limit Him but is related to Him as a body to the self residing in it.

FACT He is omnipotent, although guided in His activities by moral considerations of the merit and demerit of human actions; omniscient, possessing right knowledge of all things and events; and possessed of eternal intelligence as a power of direct and steadfast cognition of all objects.



### BASIC NODE 125 | • The idea of God in Nyāya (school of logic and realism) — continued 2/3

FACT A precise doctrinal point worth stating: eternal intelligence is only an inseparable attribute of God, not His very essence, as maintained in Advaita (non-dual school) Vedānta (school based on the philosophical culmination of sacred revelation).

FACT God possesses to the full all the six perfections (ṣaḍ-aiśvarya (six divine excellences)).

FACT Just as God is the efficient cause of the world, so He is the directive cause of the actions of all living beings.

No creature, not even man, is absolutely free; man is relatively free — his actions are done under divine direction and guidance, as a wise and benevolent father directs his son according to his gifts, capacities and previous attainments.

FACT While man is the efficient instrumental cause of his actions, God is their efficient directive cause (prayojaka kartā (directing efficient agent)).

God is thus the moral governor of the world, the impartial dispenser of the fruits of our actions (karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits)), and the supreme arbiter of our joys and sorrows.



### BASIC NODE 126 | • The idea of God in Nyāya (school of logic and realism) — continued 3/3

CAUTION FACT Theism, not deism: according to deism, God creates the world at a point of time and then leaves it to itself, having usually no concern with its affairs — like a clock-maker who intervenes only when the clock goes out of order.

On the Nyāya theory God maintains a continuous relation with the world, being creator, maintainer and destroyer.

This is the essence of theism as distinguished from deism.



### BASIC NODE 127 | • The proofs — the classical enumeration — continued 1/2

FACT Chatterjee and Datta record that "the Nyāya–Vaiśeṣikas (adherents of the combined logic-realist and category-realist traditions) have to their credit an array of proofs which include almost all the arguments given in Western philosophy for God's existence.

There are as many as ten proofs, of which the more important may be considered here." QUESTION Lists therefore vary across summaries and across editions of Udayana's Nyāyakusumāñjali (Book V).

Use only the arguments the question requires, and say that the list is variously enumerated — that is accuracy, not evasion.

The compact Sanskrit mnemonic set, which the authored knowledge file uses and which UPSC answers should carry:

| Term | Literal sense | Argument |

| --- | --- | --- |

| FACT Kāryāt (from the world's being an effect) | "from the effect" | The composite world is an effect and needs an intelligent maker |

| FACT Āyojanāt (from combination or coordination) | "from combination/arrangement" | Inert atoms cannot combine purposively by themselves |



## BASIC NODE 128 | • The proofs — the classical enumeration — continued 2/2

| FACT Dhṛtyādeḥ (from support and maintenance) | "from support/sustenance etc." | The world's being upheld, maintained and destroyed requires governance |

| FACT Padāt (from meaningful words) | "from the word" | Linguistic convention and the meaning-relation of words require an authoritative source |

| FACT Pratyayataḥ (from credibility or justified cognition) / Śruteḥ (from revealed scripture) | "from credibility / from scripture" | The authority of the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) presupposes a trustworthy omniscient author; and śruti (revealed scripture) testifies to God |

| FACT Argument from adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency) | — | Unconscious merit and demerit require an intelligent dispenser |



## BASIC NODE 129 | • Proof 1 — the causal argument (\*kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)\*), reconstructed — continued 1/4

FACT Premises, in Chatterjee–Datta's own sequence:

- All composite objects of the world formed by the combination of atoms

(mountains, seas, sun, moon, stars, planets) must have a cause,

because they are of the nature of EFFECTS — like a pot (ghatavat (like a pot)).

- That they are effects follows (a) from their being made up of parts

(SAVAYAVA (composite or possessing parts)), and (b) from their possessing an intermediate magnitude

(AVANTARA-MAHATTVA (intermediate magnitude)).

- What is NOT an effect is excluded on the same principle:



## BASIC NODE 130 | • Proof 1 — the causal argument (\*kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)\*), reconstructed — continued 2/4

space, time, ether and self are infinite substances not made of parts;

atoms of earth, water, light and air, and manas, are simple, indivisible

and infinitesimal.

- These composite objects are what they are because of the concurrence of a

number of MATERIAL causes; but without the guidance of an INTELLIGENT

cause (karta (intelligent maker)) the material causes cannot attain just that order, direction

and co-ordination which enables them to produce effects.

- This intelligent cause must have (i) direct knowledge of the material



### BASIC NODE 131 | • Proof 1 — the causal argument (\*kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)\*), reconstructed — continued 3/4

causes, i.e. the atoms, as means, (ii) a desire to attain some end, and

(iii) the power of will to realise the end.

• He must be OMNISCIENT (sarvajña), since only an omniscient being can have

direct knowledge of entities so absolutely simple and infinitely small

as atoms.

• therefore That intelligent cause is God and none but God.

CAUTION Notice how much work step 6 does.

The move to \*omniscience\* is not decorative: it is derived from the requirement of knowing atoms, which are imperceptible to ordinary cognition.



### BASIC NODE 132 | • Proof 1 — the causal argument (\*kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)\*), reconstructed — continued 4/4

This is the step that lifts the argument from "an intelligent artisan" to "an omniscient God", and it is Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s answer to Hume's proportioning objection.

FACT Western parallels, from the same text: the argument resembles the causal argument as explained by Paul Janet (Final Causes), Hermann Lotze (Outlines of a Philosophy of Religion) and James Martineau (\*A Study of Religion\*), for whom the world of finite objects requires an intelligent cause giving order and co-ordination to concurrent physical causes.

FACT But the crucial divergence: Western theists generally believe that God is not only the cause of the unity of things but also the creative energy that gives existence to the things of Nature.

For the Naiyāyikas (adherents of the school of logic and realism), God is only the cause of the order of Nature, and not of the existence of its ultimate constituents.



### BASIC NODE 133 | • Proof 2 — the argument from \*adrṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\* — continued 1/3

FACT The problem: how are we to account for the differences in our lot on earth — some happy, some miserable, some wise, some ignorant?

These are events, and every event must have a cause.

FACT Step one: the causes are our own actions in this or some previous life, governed by the moral law of karma (morally consequential action), which requires that every individual reap the fruits of its own actions.

This follows from extending the law of universal causation to the moral world: just as bodily acts produce bodily changes and mental functions produce mental dispositions, so morally good or bad actions lead to good or bad moral consequences.



**BASIC NODE 134 | • Proof 2 — the argument from \*adr̥ṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\* — continued 2/3**

FACT Step two — the time-gap problem: how do moral actions produce consequences separated from them by long intervals? "A sinner in the heyday of youth may be a sufferer in the infirmity of old age." Hence good actions produce an efficiency called merit (puṇya (karmic merit)) and bad actions a deficiency called demerit (pāpa (karmic demerit)) in our souls, persisting long after the actions have ceased.

This stock of merit and demerit is adr̥ṣṭa.

FACT Step three — the decisive move: adr̥ṣṭa is an unintelligent principle which cannot by itself produce just that kind and degree of joy and sorrow which are due to our past actions.

It must therefore be guided by an intelligent agent.



**BASIC NODE 135 | • Proof 2 — the argument from \*adr̥ṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\* — continued 3/3**

Individual selves cannot direct it, for they know nothing about their own \*adr̥ṣṭa\*, and it not infrequently defies the control of their will. therefore The intelligent agent who guides \*adr̥ṣṭa\* through the proper channels is the eternal, omnipotent and omniscient Divine Being, who dispenses all the joys and sorrows of life in strict accordance with it — "as a wise and potent monarch rewards or punishes his subjects according to the merit or guilt attaching to their actions."

FACT Chatterjee and Datta themselves add the Kantian gloss: "Or, as Kant would say, it is God who combines happiness with virtue and misery with vice."



**BASIC NODE 136 | • Proofs 3 and 4 — the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge)'s authority (\*padāt (from meaningful words) / āptaprāmāṇya (authority of a trustworthy speaker)\*) and śruti (revealed scripture)'s testimony — continued 1/4**

FACT Proof 3 — from the authoritativeness of the scriptures.

The authority (\*prāmāṇya (validity or authoritativeness)\*) of the Vedas (sacred bodies of revealed knowledge) has its source in the supreme authority of their author (\*āptaprāmāṇya\*).

Just as the authoritativeness of medical science, or of any science, derives from the scientists who founded it, so the authoritativeness of the Vedas derives from a person who imparted that character to them.

The individual self (\*jīva (individual living self)\*) cannot be the author, since the supramundane realities related in the Vedas cannot be objects of an ordinary individual's knowledge.

Hence the author must be a supreme person with direct knowledge of all objects — past, present and future; finite, infinite and infinitesimal; sensible and supersensible.

That is, the Vedas are revealed by God.





### BASIC NODE 137 | • Proofs 3 and 4 — the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge)'s authority (\*padāt (from meaningful words) / āptaprāmānya (authority of a trustworthy speaker)\*) and śruti (revealed scripture)'s testimony — continued 2/4

CAUTION Note the neat epistemological analogy embedded here: the Veda may be partially verified in its worldly injunctions (following them produces the desired results), and we accept the whole as authoritative just as we accept a whole science as true when only some parts are verifiable.

FACT Proof 4 — the testimony of śruti.

God exists because Vedic scripture bears testimony to His existence — \*Bṛhadāraṇyaka (Great Forest sacred dialogue)\* ("the highest eternal self is the Lord of all, the ruler of all, the protector of all"), \*Śvetāśvatara (sacred dialogue of the Svetasvatara tradition)\* ("the one God lies hidden in all, is all-pervading, is the inmost self of all"), \*Kauṣītaki (sacred dialogue of the Kausitaki tradition)\*, and the \*Bhagavadgītā (Song of the Lord)\* ("I am the highest end of all, the maintainer of all, the controller of all, the witness of all...").

FACT The circularity objection and Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s reply — a genuinely elegant piece of philosophy that almost no candidate writes.



### BASIC NODE 138 | • Proofs 3 and 4 — the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge)'s authority (\*padāt (from meaningful words) / āptaprāmānya (authority of a trustworthy speaker)\*) and śruti (revealed scripture)'s testimony — continued 3/4

The objection: proof 3 shows God is the author of the Vedas (sacred bodies of revealed knowledge), while proof 4 exhibits the Vedas as the ground of our knowledge of God — a circle.

The reply distinguishes the order of existence from the order of knowledge:

ORDER OF EXISTENCE : GOD —creates—► VEDA

ORDER OF KNOWLEDGE : VEDA —leads to—► KNOWLEDGE OF GOD

The Vedas depend on God for their EXISTENCE but not for our KNOWLEDGE of them

(they may be learned from a competent teacher);

God depends on the Vedas for our KNOWLEDGE of Him but not for His EXISTENCE.

therefore Reciprocal dependence across two different orders is not a vicious circle.



### BASIC NODE 139 | • Proofs 3 and 4 — the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge)'s authority (\*padāt (from meaningful words) / āptaprāmānya (authority of a trustworthy speaker)\*) and śruti (revealed scripture)'s testimony — continued 4/4

Circularity arises only within the SAME order or universe of discourse.

CAUTION A second classical objection with a dilemma-reply: if God be the creator of the world He must have a body, since without a body no action is possible.

The Naiyāyikas (adherents of the school of logic and realism) reply that the objection is caught between two horns — if God's existence is proved by śruti, arguing against what is already proved is pointless; and if God's existence is not yet granted, the objection presupposes what it disputes.



**BASIC NODE 140 | • Anti-theistic criticism — including from within the Indian textbook tradition — continued 1/4**

| Critic | Objection | Nyāya (school of logic and realism) reply | Assessment |

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

| FACT Cārvāka (materialist school) | God cannot be perceived; the world is made by the automatic combination of the material elements, not by God; inference is unreliable | CAUTION Inference is an independent \*pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge)\*; the Cārvāka's own denial uses inference | CAUTION The dispute is really about the scope of \*pramāṇas (means of valid knowledge)\* |

| FACT Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) | The Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) is eternal and authorless (\*apauruṣeya (not of human authorship)\*), so no divine author is needed; karma (morally consequential action) is self-operating | FACT Nyāya: an unconscious principle cannot intelligently allot determinate fruits | QUESTION The dispute tracks rival metaphysics of causation and normativity |

| FACT Buddhism / Jainism | The world runs by karma and conditions without a creator | CAUTION Same reply as above, plus the \*kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)\* premise | CAUTION Requires defending the artefact analogy |



**BASIC NODE 141 | • Anti-theistic criticism — including from within the Indian textbook tradition — continued 2/4**

| FACT Śaṅkara (Advaita (non-dual school)) | Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s God is a \*saguṇa (with qualities)\* Īśvara (Lord or personal God) at the empirical level, not the absolute Nirguṇa (without limiting qualities) Brahman (ultimate reality); and the atomistic scheme is logically weak | CAUTION Nyāya denies that the empirical order is \*mithyā (empirically experienced but not absolutely real)\* and defends realist pluralism | CAUTION A level-distinction dispute, not a simple refutation |

| FACT Śaṅkara's atomism dilemma (reported by C. D. Sharma) | Are atoms essentially active, inactive, both or neither?

If active, creation is permanent; if inactive, creation is impossible; if both, the conception is self-contradictory; if neither, activity must come from an outside agency — and that agency, seen or unseen, generates further absurdities | CAUTION Nyāya locates the initiating impulse in God's will operating through \*adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\* | CAUTION Sharp, and still discussed |



**BASIC NODE 142 | • Anti-theistic criticism — including from within the Indian textbook tradition — continued 3/4**

| FACT Sharma's own verdict | The Vaiśeṣika (school of categories and realism) God "is not the creator of this universe... He has been reduced to the status of a supervisor," His "hands and feet chained by the shackles of the Law of Karma (morally consequential action) unfolding itself as the Adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)"; the system "could have easily done away with a God" | CAUTION Nyāya (school of logic and realism) answers that a supervisor who alone can intelligently allot is not dispensable | CAUTION The redundancy objection is the most serious challenge Nyāya theism faces |

FACT The textbook's own conclusion, which is examiner-gold when quoted as a critical position: Chatterjee and Datta, invoking Kant and Lotze, argue that none of the so-called proofs can really prove God's existence.

To prove anything is to deduce it as a necessary conclusion from given premises; but God, being the ultimate reality, is "the highest of all premises", so there can be no anterior premise from which God is deducible.



**BASIC NODE 143 | • Anti-theistic criticism — including from within the Indian textbook tradition — continued 4/4**

All the proofs, they say, are vitiated by deducing God's existence from the mere idea of Him: "the idea of the most perfect being may involve the idea of existence, but not actual existence, just as the thought of one hundred rupees in my pocket involves the image or the idea of their existence, but not their real physical existence." Their positive conclusion: God must be known through direct experience, not through reasoning — and they quote Lotze: "all proofs that God exists are pleas put forward in justification of our faith and of the particular way in which we feel that we must apprehend this highest principle."

CAUTION Deploy this as your evaluative paragraph in 2023 Q7(a) and 2025 Q7(b).

It lets you criticise Nyāya (school of logic and realism) from \*within\* the Indian tradition rather than importing Hume, which is what a first-class script does.



**BASIC NODE 144 | • Solved PYQ — 2018, Q8(a), 20 marks (the comparison question) — continued 1/3**

FACT Exact question: "Compare St. Thomas Aquinas' five ways of knowing God with the arguments of the Nyāya (school of logic and realism) School of Indian Philosophy for the existence of God."

| Comparison axis | Aquinas | Nyāya |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Epistemic type | FACT A posteriori demonstration (\*demonstratio quia\*) | FACT \*Anumāna (inference)\* requiring \*vyāpti (invariable concomitance)\*, modelled on artefacts |

| Starting facts | Motion, causation, contingency, degrees, purpose | Compositeness, arrangement, maintenance, \*adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\*, Vedic authority |

| Cause of \*existence\* | FACT Yes — God creates being itself | FACT No — atoms are eternal, uncreated |

| Cause of \*order\* | Yes | FACT Yes, and only this |



**BASIC NODE 145 | • Solved PYQ — 2018, Q8(a), 20 marks (the comparison question) — continued 2/3**

| Relation to scripture | FACT Proofs are \*praeambula fidei\*, from reason alone | FACT Two of the standard proofs are explicitly scriptural |

| Moral government | Providence | FACT \*Karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits)\* administering \*adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\* |

| Divine attributes reached | Pure act, simplicity, infinity | FACT Omniscience derived from the need to know atoms |

| Principal internal weakness | Regress-exclusion; the identification with God | Artefact analogy; the redundancy of God given karma (morally consequential action) |

| Standard critique | Hume, Kant | Cārvāka (materialist school), Buddhism, Jainism, Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty), Advaita (non-dual school) |

CAUTION The conclusion that earns marks: "Both traditions produce a posteriori natural theology from order to intelligence, and both are attacked on the same two tiers — the strength of the inference and the adequacy of the God reached."



### BASIC NODE 146 | • Solved PYQ — 2018, Q8(a), 20 marks (the comparison question) — continued 3/3

They diverge decisively on material causation: Aquinas' God is the source of being, Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s Īśvara (Lord or personal God) only the architect of an eternally given material.

The Indian argument is consequently more modest in metaphysical ambition and more exposed to the charge of divine redundancy."\*



### BASIC NODE 147 | UPSC traps — continued 1/2

- CAUTION Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s God is the efficient, never the material, cause.

Atoms are the eternal material causes.

- CAUTION Nyāya theism is theism, not deism — God preserves and destroys as well as creates.
- CAUTION Eternal intelligence is an \*inseparable attribute\* of God in Nyāya, not His essence as in Advaita (non-dual school).
- CAUTION Do not answer "the nature of Nyāya's God" merely by listing Udayana's proofs, or vice versa.
- CAUTION \*Adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\* does not consciously distribute its own fruits — that unconsciousness is the whole premise of the argument.
- CAUTION Enumerations of the proofs vary; say so and use the ones the question needs.
- CAUTION The Veda (sacred revealed knowledge)—God circularity is answered by the order-of-existence / order-of-knowledge distinction; do not concede the circle.



### BASIC NODE 148 | UPSC traps — continued 2/2

- CAUTION Do not treat Nyāya (school of logic and realism) as "the Indian Aquinas" without flagging the material-causation divergence.

KEY Mnemonic — "K-A-D-P-Ś + adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)": Kāryāt (from the world's being an effect) · Āyojanāt (from combination or coordination) · Dhṛtyādeḥ (from support and maintenance) · Padāt (from meaningful words) · Śruteḥ (from revealed scripture), plus the argument from adṛṣṭa.

KEY Second mnemonic — "E-A-K-V": Efficient cause · Atoms · Karma (morally consequential action) · Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) — the four pillars of Nyāya theology.



### BASIC NODE 149 | Revision notes — continued 1/3

- Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s Īśvara (Lord or personal God) is an eternal, omniscient, omnipotent special self, never bound by karma (morally consequential action).
- God is the first efficient cause, a builder or \*демиург\*, not the material cause.
- Atoms, souls, space, time, ether, manas and \*адṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\* are eternal and co-present with God.
- God is creator, preserver and destroyer — hence theism, not deism.
- God is \*prayojaka kartā (directing efficient agent)\*, the efficient directive cause of human action; man is relatively free.
- God is \*karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits)\*, impartial dispenser of the fruits of action.
- Eternal intelligence is an inseparable attribute of God, not His essence.
- \*Kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)\*: the composite world (\*sāvayava (composite or possessing parts)\*, \*avāntara-mahattva (intermediate magnitude)\*) is an effect and needs an intelligent maker.



### BASIC NODE 150 | Revision notes — continued 2/3

- Omniscience is inferred because only an omniscient being can directly know atoms.
- \*Āyojanāt (from combination or coordination)\*: inert atoms cannot combine purposively without a conscious arranger.
- \*Dhṛtyādeḥ (from support and maintenance)\*: the world's support, maintenance and destruction require governance.
- \*Adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\* argument: unconscious merit and demerit require an intelligent dispenser.
- \*Padāt (from meaningful words) / āptaprāmānya (authority of a trustworthy speaker)\*: the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge)'s authority presupposes an omniscient trustworthy author.
- \*Śruteḥ (from revealed scripture)\*: scriptural texts testify to God's existence.
- The circularity charge is met by distinguishing the order of existence from the order of knowledge.
- The bodiless-agent objection is answered by a dilemma.



### BASIC NODE 151 | Revision notes — continued 3/3

- Janet, Lotze and Martineau are the Western parallels; but they make God the source of existence, Nyāya (school of logic and realism) only of order.
- Cārvāka (materialist school), Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty), Buddhism, Jainism and Advaita (non-dual school) each reject the proofs on distinct grounds.
- Śaṅkara's dilemma of active/inactive atoms attacks the whole Vaiśeṣika (school of categories and realism) cosmology.
- Chatterjee–Datta conclude with Kant and Lotze that no proof proves God; direct experience is required.
- Sharma's redundancy objection — Nyāya "could have easily done away with a God" — is the sharpest internal criticism.



## BASIC NODE 152 | VISUAL VISUAL — Two completely different senses of "God" in the Indian debate — continued 1/3

SENSE 1 : GOD AS WORLD-MAKER (jagat-kartā (maker of the world))

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Affirmed by : Nyaya-Vaisesika (efficient cause), theistic Vedanta (school based on the philosophical culmination of sacred revelation)

DENIED by : JAINA · BAUDDHA · MIMAMSA (inquiry into Vedic duty) · SANKHYA · CARVAKA (materialist school)

▲ ▲

└─ denial on METAPHYSICAL grounds └─ on EPISTEMIC

(karma (morally consequential action)/conditions suffice) grounds (no perception)



## BASIC NODE 153 | VISUAL VISUAL — Two completely different senses of "God" in the Indian debate — continued 2/3

SENSE 2 : GOD AS PERFECTED BEING (paramatman / siddha (liberated disembodied soul) / arhat)

---

AFFIRMED by JAINISM : "Jainism denies God, but does not deny GODHEAD.

EVERY LIBERATED SOUL IS A GOD."

Godhood is ACHIEVED, not eternal · PLURAL, not unique ·

a MODEL, not a maker.

=> THEREFORE the 2019 question "proofs for the existence of God as propounded in Jainism" is answered in SENSE 2, together with



## BASIC NODE 154 | VISUAL VISUAL — Two completely different senses of "God" in the Indian debate — continued 3/3

Jainism's refutation of SENSE 1.

Answering only "Jainism is

atheistic" mis-reads the question.

CAUTION This is the single most important interpretive move in the entire subtopic.

UPSC's 2019 wording presupposes that Jainism has \*something\* to prove; the mature answer explains which sense of "God" Jainism proves and which it refutes.



BASIC NODE 155 | Part I — Jainism

Route marker retained from the learner-v2 source.



BASIC NODE 156 | • What Jainism denies

FACT Jainism is "a religion without God" in the sense of a creator.

FACT There is no necessity of bringing in God to explain creation, for the world was never created: production, destruction and permanence characterise all substances; things have creation and dissolution because of their modes (paryāya (changing mode)), while the substances themselves are eternal.

The six \*dravyas\* — \*jīva (individual living self)\*, \*pudgala (matter)\*, \*dharma (duty or sustaining moral order)\*, \*adharma (wrongdoing or non-duty)\*, \*ākāśa (space or ether)\* and \*kāla (time)\* — are beginningless.

FACT CAUTION Terminological caution that impresses examiners: \*nāstika (school that rejects Vedic authority)\* in Indian philosophy standardly means "one who denies the authority of the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge)", not "one who denies the spirit".

In that Vedic sense Jainism and Buddhism are \*nāstika\*; but they are intensely spiritual and ethical, and denial of God does not amount to atheism in the Western sense — otherwise Sāṃkhya (dualist school based on enumerated principles) and Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty), which likewise do not believe in a creator God, could not have been counted orthodox.



BASIC NODE 157 | • What Jainism affirms — godhood, and the proofs for it — continued 1/5

FACT "Though Jainism denies God, it does not deny godhead.

Every liberated soul is a god." FACT The Tirthaṅkaras (ford-makers who teach the path to liberation), who were mortal beings like us but obtained liberation through personal effort, are always there to inspire us.

We are all potential Jinas (spiritual conquerors), for what man has done man can do.

Jainism is a religion of self-help.

CAUTION The Jaina "proofs" are therefore proofs of the possibility and actuality of divine perfection in the soul, arranged as follows:

PROOF 1 — FROM THE INTRINSIC NATURE OF THE JIVA (svabhava (intrinsic nature)-siddhi)

- Every jīva intrinsically possesses infinite knowledge, infinite perception, infinite bliss and infinite power (ananta-catustaya (four infinitudes of the liberated soul)).



### BASIC NODE 158 | • What Jainism affirms — godhood, and the proofs for it — continued 2/5

- Empirically these are obscured, not absent, since we observe

DEGREES of knowledge, not its total absence.

- Obscuration is caused by karmic matter (pudgala (matter)) adhering to the soul.
- Remove the obscuring karma (morally consequential action) completely and the native perfections

manifest completely.

- therefore Godhood is the soul's own nature recovered, not a status conferred from outside.

[RECOVERY, not creation]



### BASIC NODE 159 | • What Jainism affirms — godhood, and the proofs for it — continued 3/5

PROOF 2 — FROM DEGREES OF KNOWLEDGE TO OMNISCIENCE (sarvajna-siddhi (establishment of omniscience))

- Knowledge occurs in graded kinds: mati (sensory and mental knowledge), sruta (knowledge received through testimony or scripture), avadhi (clairvoyant knowledge), manahpariyaya (direct knowledge of others' thoughts).
- The gradation maps the progressive removal of karmic obstruction.
- A graded series of obstruction-removal has a limiting case:

COMPLETE removal.

- At that limit knowledge is total, direct and unobstructed = KEVALA-JNANA (perfect omniscience).
- therefore An omniscient being (kevalin (embodied possessor of perfect knowledge)) is possible, and the Tirthankaras (ford-makers who teach the path to liberation) are its actual instances.





## BASIC NODE 160 | • What Jainism affirms — godhood, and the proofs for it — continued 4/5

PROOF 3 — FROM THE TESTIMONY OF THE OMNISCIENT (apta (trustworthy competent person) / agama)

- Right faith rests on the teaching of the omniscient Tirthankaras (ford-makers who teach the path to liberation).
- Their teaching is internally coherent, ascetically verified and

transmitted through the Agama.

- therefore Their attained godhood is credible on the strength of apta-vacana (statement of a trustworthy person).

CAUTION FACT Sharma states the epistemic role of Proof 3 exactly: faith is necessary because the deepest truths rest on the word "of the omniscient Tirthankaras"; and right faith, right knowledge and right conduct — the tri-ratna (three jewels of liberation) — jointly constitute the path.

FACT The resulting concept of God: plural (infinitely many \*siddhas (liberated disembodied souls)\*), achieved (not eternal in status), non-creative (no cosmic function), non-interventionist (a \*siddha (liberated disembodied soul)\* does not answer prayer or dispense karma (morally consequential action)), and purely exemplary.



## BASIC NODE 161 | • What Jainism affirms — godhood, and the proofs for it — continued 5/5

CAUTION Sharma notes the historical tension frankly: strictly there is no room for devotion in Jainism, since asceticism must burn all emotion to ashes; yet the ordinary Jaina, under Brahmanical influence, has deified the Tirthankaras (ford-makers who teach the path to liberation), built temples and worshipped their images.



## BASIC NODE 162 | • Jaina refutation of a creator God — continued 1/2

CAUTION The classical Jaina anti-creator arguments (developed in the Digambara tradition and standard in Indian philosophical summaries) run:

| # | Argument | Force |

| ---: | --- | --- |

| 1 | CAUTION From what did God create?

If from pre-existing matter, matter is uncreated and God is not the sole ultimate; if from nothing, anything could be produced anywhere at any time. | Attacks the coherence of creation |

| 2 | CAUTION Why did God create?

A perfect being has no unfulfilled desire; a motive implies lack. | Attacks divine perfection |

| 3 | CAUTION If out of compassion, the world should contain only happiness. | Empirical refutation |



## BASIC NODE 163 | • Jaina refutation of a creator God — continued 2/2

| 4 | CAUTION If in sport (līlā (divine play)), God is childish, and cruel toward the suffering. | Moral refutation |

| 5 | CAUTION Who created God?

If God is self-existent, the world may equally be self-existent — the theist's own concession destroys the argument. | Regress / parity |

| 6 | FACT Karma (morally consequential action) suffices.

The world-order and the distribution of pleasure and pain are explained by each soul's own karmic matter; no external allocator is required. | Explanatory economy |

FACT The Jaina positive alternative: the universe is eternal and uncreated; \*utpāda–vyaya–dhrauvya (origination, decay and persistence)\* (origination, decay, permanence) is the structure of every substance; change is real without a changer standing outside.



## BASIC NODE 164 | • Solved PYQ — 2019, Q5(e), 10 marks — continued 1/2

FACT Exact question: "State and evaluate the proofs for the existence of God as propounded in Jainism."

1 min : Disambiguate "God" — Jainism denies jagat-karta (maker of the world) but affirms GODHEAD.

4 min : The three Jaina routes — intrinsic ananta-catustaya (four infinitudes of the liberated soul) of the jiva (individual living self);

the gradation of knowledge culminating in kevala-jnana (perfect omniscience); the

testimony of the omniscient Tirthankaras (apta-vacana (statement of a trustworthy person)).

2 min : The refutation of a creator — motive, material, compassion, sport,

regress, karmic sufficiency.

2 min : EVALUATE — the proofs succeed in establishing an ideal of attainable



## BASIC NODE 165 | • Solved PYQ — 2019, Q5(e), 10 marks — continued 2/2

perfection, but they are internal to Jaina metaphysics: they

presuppose the soul's intrinsic omniscience and material karma (morally consequential action).

They do NOT prove, and do not attempt to prove, a cosmic God.

1 min : Verdict — Jaina theology is a soteriological, not a cosmological,

theism; "God" names the terminus of the path, not its author.

CAUTION Evaluation lines available from within the Indian tradition (use one, not all): Sharma presses the classic realist-pluralist difficulty — if ignorance and karma are inseparable from the soul, liberation is impossible; if they are external to it, bondage is impossible — and holds that the Jainas have no real answer.

If the soul is by nature pure consciousness and power, how can it be really tinged with ignorance, passion and karma?

This objection strikes at the very premise on which Proof 1 rests.



## BASIC NODE 166 | Part II — Buddhism

Route marker retained from the learner-v2 source.



## BASIC NODE 167 | • The Buddhist arguments against a creator God — continued 1/3

FACT Four core lines, as recorded in the authored knowledge file:

- FACT If God is eternal and unchanging, genuine creation becomes difficult to explain, because willing or producing seems to involve change.
- FACT If God creates from desire or purpose, that suggests lack, preference or incompleteness.
- FACT The presence of suffering and evil sits uneasily with an omnipotent benevolent creator.
- FACT Dependent origination (pratītyasamutpāda (dependent origination)) already explains the arising of phenomena through conditions, making a creator unnecessary.

CAUTION Three further lines that raise a 15-marker to distinction level:

- CAUTION The doctrinal-method argument.



### BASIC NODE 168 | • The Buddhist arguments against a creator God — continued 2/3

Questions about a first beginning belong to the \*avyākṛta (undeclared or deliberately unanswered)\* (undeclared) questions; the Buddha's refusal to answer them is not evasion but a judgement that they are soteriologically idle — the parable of the man wounded by an arrow, who dies while demanding to know the archer's caste before allowing the arrow to be drawn.

• CAUTION The moral-agency argument.

If God determines all, karma (morally consequential action) and moral effort are meaningless; if God does not determine all, God is not the sufficient cause and the theistic explanation is redundant.

• CAUTION The Dharmakīrti / Śāntarakṣita line.

A permanent, partless, immutable cause cannot produce \*successive\* effects, since a cause that is unchanging and fully present must produce its effect all at once and always; therefore an eternal God cannot be the cause of a temporally ordered world.



### BASIC NODE 169 | • The Buddhist arguments against a creator God — continued 3/3

FACT Philosophical force, stated correctly: the Buddhist critique is not mere atheistic denial; it is a systematic refusal of explanatory surplus.

If conditioned arising explains the world-process, God is not needed.

It is Ockhamite before Ockham.

CAUTION Presupposition to expose: the critique assumes (i) that explanation should proceed through conditional relations rather than through a substratum or an external agent, and (ii) that what matters philosophically is not an absolutely first beginning but the structure by which bondage is maintained here and now.



### BASIC NODE 170 | • Solved PYQ — 2018, Q8(b), 15 marks — continued 1/4

FACT Exact question: "\*\*Critically evaluate the Buddhistic arguments against the existence of God as the creator of the world.\*\*"

FRAME : Buddhism denies a creator without denying the sacred; the target is

jagat-karta (maker of the world), not spiritual ultimacy.

STATE : (a) eternal unchanging cause cannot create; (b) creation from desire

implies lack; (c) suffering tells against a benevolent omnipotent

creator; (d) pratītyasamutpāda (dependent origination) makes a creator explanatorily

redundant; (e) the avyakṛta (undeclared or deliberately unanswered) silence; (f) the freedom/karma (morally consequential action) dilemma;

(g) Dharmakīrti: a permanent cause cannot yield successive effects.



### BASIC NODE 171 | • Solved PYQ — 2018, Q8(b), 15 marks — continued 2/4

CRITIQUE: — (i) Nyaya (school of logic and realism) replies that unconscious karma (morally consequential action) cannot intelligently allot determinate fruits, so dependent origination explains sequence but not desert-appropriate ALLOCATION.

— (ii) The change objection assumes a temporal model of divine willing; classical theism replies with an eternal act producing a temporal effect.

— (iii) The desire objection assumes creation must satisfy a lack; theists appeal to gratuitous diffusive goodness.



### BASIC NODE 172 | • Solved PYQ — 2018, Q8(b), 15 marks — continued 3/4

— (iv) Explanatory economy is a methodological preference, not a disproof.

ASSESS : the arguments are strong AGAINST an anthropomorphic, purposive, benevolent world-maker; weaker against a metaphysically refined classical theism.

They shift the burden rather than close the case.

CONCLUDE: Buddhism establishes that a coherent, ethically serious cosmology is possible without a creator — which is a substantial result even



### BASIC NODE 173 | • Solved PYQ — 2018, Q8(b), 15 marks — continued 4/4

if it is not a demonstration of atheism.



### BASIC NODE 174 | Part III — Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty)

Route marker retained from the learner-v2 source.



### BASIC NODE 175 | • Why Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) needs no God — continued 1/3

FACT The Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) is authoritative because it is apauruṣeya (not of human authorship) — eternal, authorless and self-valid.

It is not authored by any human, nor is a divine author needed.

FACT Authorlessness protects it from personal defects: a personal author may deceive, or may lack complete knowledge; if the Veda had an author, its authority would depend on first proving that author's competence and sincerity.

FACT The direct counter to Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s proof 3: Mīmāṃsā objects that the Nyāya route is cumbersome — first prove God exists, then prove God is omniscient, then prove God intends truth, each stage needing independent support.

Authorlessness avoids the entire dependence.

FACT Coupled with \*svataḥ-prāmāṇya (intrinsic validity of cognition)\* (intrinsic validity of cognition), this blocks scepticism at the starting point without theological guarantee.



### BASIC NODE 176 | • Why Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) needs no God — continued 2/3

FACT And the direct counter to Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency) proof: apūrva (unseen potency generated by ritual duty) is the unseen potency produced by correctly performed ritual; it persists after the act and matures into future fruit.

This allows Mīmāṃsā to explain ritual efficacy without God as fruit-dispenser.

Prābhākara adds \*niyoga (binding Vedic injunction)\*: the injunction itself creates obligation, so one ought to act because the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) commands, not because a deity rewards.

FACT Chatterjee–Datta's report of the wider debate: the Mīmāṃsā rejects the proofs of God's existence, like the Jainas, without replacing them by others.

They also record Max Müller's contention that if God were supposed to be the creator, He would be liable to the charges of cruelty and partiality; and Müller's further point that rejection of a \*creator\*-God is not necessarily rejection of God, since pantheisms such as Advaita (non-dual school) and Spinoza's do not accept the reality of creation and yet are not fairly called atheistic.



### BASIC NODE 177 | • Why Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) needs no God — continued 3/3

CAUTION Their own verdict is more sceptical: judged by what the Mīmāṃsā itself does and says, the Vedic deities are not treated as objects of worship and are not believed to exist anywhere except in the \*mantras (sacred utterances)\* that describe them — "eternal and self-manifesting concepts", like the immortal characters of classical epics.

CAUTION In its anxiety to maintain the supremacy of the Vedas (sacred bodies of revealed knowledge), the Mīmāṃsā "relegates God to an ambiguous position".



## BASIC NODE 178 | • Cārvāka (materialist school) — and the Nyāya (school of logic and realism) replies to all three — continued 1/2

FACT Cārvāka: the existence of God is a myth;

God cannot be perceived; the world is made by the automatic combination of the material elements and not by God; no faith should be put in the Vedas (sacred bodies of revealed knowledge).

CAUTION Perception alone is a \*pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge)\*, so inference — on which every theistic proof depends — is unreliable.

| Objector | Core claim | CAUTION Nyāya's reply | Assessment |

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Cārvāka | No perception of God; inference invalid | Inference is an independent \*pramāṇa\*; the Cārvāka's own general denial itself requires inference | CAUTION The dispute is about the scope of \*pramāṇas (means of valid knowledge)\*, not about God directly |

| Buddhism | Conditions suffice; a permanent cause cannot produce successive effects | An unconscious causal nexus explains sequence but not desert-appropriate allocation | QUESTION Rival metaphysics; no knock-down |



## BASIC NODE 179 | • Cārvāka (materialist school) — and the Nyāya (school of logic and realism) replies to all three — continued 2/2

| Jainism | Karma (morally consequential action) is material and self-operating; creation never happened | Material karma still requires an intelligent principle to allot determinate fruits | CAUTION Nyāya's reply presupposes what Jainism denies |

| Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) | Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) is \*apauruṣeya (not of human authorship)\*; \*apūrva (unseen potency generated by ritual duty)\* self-matures | Unconscious \*apūrva\* cannot intelligently proportion fruit to desert; authorless language is normatively unexplained | QUESTION The deepest and most evenly matched Indian dispute |

| Advaita (non-dual school) | Nyāya's Īśvara (Lord or personal God) is only \*saṃguṇa (with qualities)\*, empirically valid; atomism is incoherent | Realist pluralism denies the \*mithyā (empirically experienced but not absolutely real)\* verdict on the empirical order | CAUTION A level-distinction dispute |



## BASIC NODE 180 | India–West comparison — continued 1/2

| Objection type | Indian instance | Western counterpart |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Explanatory economy | FACT \*Pratītyasamutpāda (dependent origination)\*; karma (morally consequential action); \*apūrva (unseen potency generated by ritual duty)\* | FACT Darwinian natural selection;

Hume's Epicurean hypothesis |

| Coherence of attributes | CAUTION Immutable cause cannot produce successive effects | FACT Omnipotence paradoxes; immutability vs responsiveness |

| Evil | FACT Suffering vs a benevolent creator;

Müller's cruelty/partiality charge | FACT Hume's fifth front; the evidential problem of evil |

| Epistemic restriction | FACT Cārvāka (materialist school)'s perception-only | FACT Logical positivist verificationism |



## BASIC NODE 181 | India–West comparison — continued 2/2

| Authority without an author | FACT Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) \*apauruṣeya (not of human authorship)\* | CAUTION No close Western analogue — a genuinely distinctive Indian contribution |



## BASIC NODE 182 | UPSC traps — continued 1/2

- CAUTION Jainism denies God but not godhead.

Answering the 2019 question with "Jainism is atheistic" misreads it.

- CAUTION Jaina godhood is plural, achieved and non-creative; a \*siddha (liberated disembodied soul)\* has no cosmic function.
- CAUTION Jaina karma (morally consequential action) is material (pudgala (matter)); do not equate it with Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s \*adrṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\* or a generic moral force.
- CAUTION \*Nāstika (school that rejects Vedic authority)\* means denier of Vedic authority, not denier of spirit.
- CAUTION Buddhism's critique is a refusal of explanatory surplus, not a proof of atheism.
- CAUTION The \*avyākṛta (undeclared or deliberately unanswered)\* silence is a methodological judgement, not agnostic evasion.
- CAUTION Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty)'s Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) is authorless — not God-authored; this is the exact contradictory of Nyāya's third proof.



## BASIC NODE 183 | UPSC traps — continued 2/2

- CAUTION \*Apūrva (unseen potency generated by ritual duty)\* is Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty)'s substitute for a fruit-dispensing God; do not call it "karma (morally consequential action)" loosely.
- CAUTION Do not say Sāṃkhya (dualist school based on enumerated principles) "has no view"; classical Sāṃkhya is \*nirīśvara (without a creator God)\* and also denies a creator.
- CAUTION Do not present these schools as a single "Indian atheism".

Their grounds differ — economy, coherence, epistemic restriction.

KEY Mnemonic — "E-C-E": every Indian anti-creator argument is an Economy, Coherence or Epistemic move.





## BASIC NODE 184 | Revision notes — continued 1/3

- Jainism denies a creator God but affirms godhood: every liberated soul is a god.
- The world was never created; substances are eternal and change through modes.
- \*Utpāda–vyaya–dhrauvya (origination, decay and persistence)\* — origination, decay and permanence characterise all substances.
- Jaina proof 1: the \*jīva (individual living self)\*'s intrinsic \*ananta-catuṣṭaya (four infinitudes of the liberated soul)\* is obscured, not absent.
- Jaina proof 2: graded knowledge (matī (sensory and mental knowledge), śruta (knowledge received through testimony or scripture), avadhi (clairvoyant knowledge), manahparyāya (direct knowledge of others' thoughts)) has a limiting case in \*kevala-jñāna (perfect omniscience)\*.
- Jaina proof 3: the testimony of the omniscient Tīrthaṅkaras (\*āpta-vacana (statement of a trustworthy person)\*).
- Tīrthaṅkaras were mortals who attained liberation by personal effort — "we are all potential Jinas (spiritual conquerors)".
- Jaina anti-creator arguments: material of creation, motive, compassion, sport, regress, karmic sufficiency.



## BASIC NODE 185 | Revision notes — continued 2/3

- Sharma's internal objection: if karma (morally consequential action) is inseparable from the soul, liberation is impossible; if external, bondage is.
  - \*Nāstika (school that rejects Vedic authority)\* means denier of Vedic authority;
- Jainism and Buddhism are \*nāstika\* only in that sense.
- Buddhism: an immutable eternal cause cannot create; creation from desire implies lack.
  - Buddhism: suffering counts against a benevolent creator; dependent origination makes God redundant.
  - The \*avyākṛta (undeclared or deliberately unanswered)\* questions and the arrow parable show the critique is soteriological in motive.
  - Dharmakīrti-type argument: a permanent cause cannot produce successive effects.
  - Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty): the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) is \*apauruṣeya (not of human authorship)\*, eternal and authorless; no divine author is needed.



## BASIC NODE 186 | Revision notes — continued 3/3

- Authorlessness protects the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) from an author's deceit or ignorance.
- Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty)'s objection to Nyāya (school of logic and realism): proving God, then omniscience, then truthfulness, is cumbersome.
- \*Apūrva (unseen potency generated by ritual duty)\* explains ritual fruit without a divine dispenser; \*niyoga (binding Vedic injunction)\* grounds obligation in injunction.
- Max Müller: a creator God would face charges of cruelty and partiality.
- Cārvāka (materialist school): God is unperceived; the world results from the automatic combination of elements.
- All Indian anti-creator arguments reduce to economy, coherence or epistemic-restriction moves.



**BASIC NODE 187 | VISUAL MASTER CONCEPT MAP — the whole syllabus item on one page — continued 1/5**

## DOES ANYTHING PROVE GOD?



## FROM THE CONCEPT FROM THE WORLD



## Anselm P2 / P3 MOTION CAUSATION CONTINGENCY ORDER MORALITY

Descartes Way 1 Way 2 Way 3 Way 5 Kant



**BASIC NODE 188 | VISUAL MASTER CONCEPT MAP — the whole syllabus item on one page — continued 2/5**



Gaunilo: parody COSMOLOGICAL TELEOLOGICAL |

Kant: not a real predicate | | |

Modal repair: possibility premise | | |

| Hume: regress?

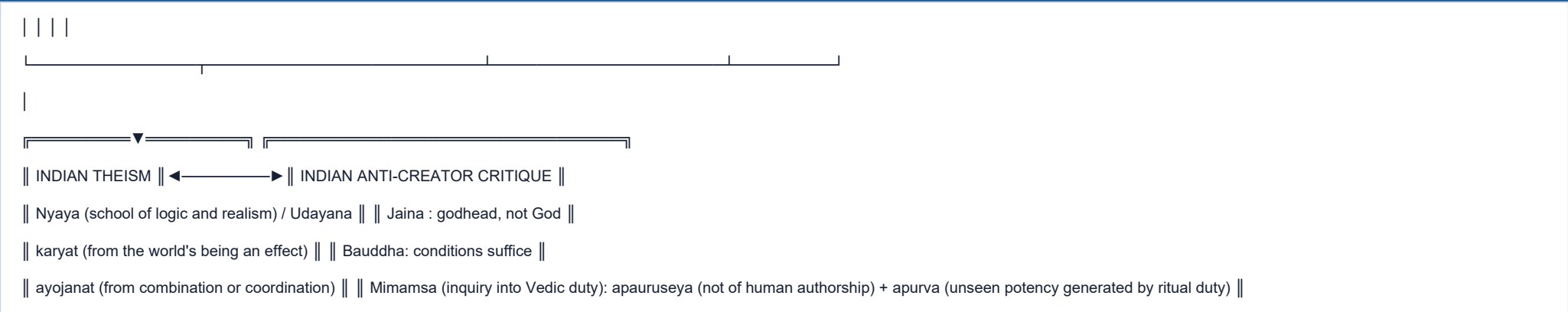
Hume x5 |

| Kant: borrows Darwin |

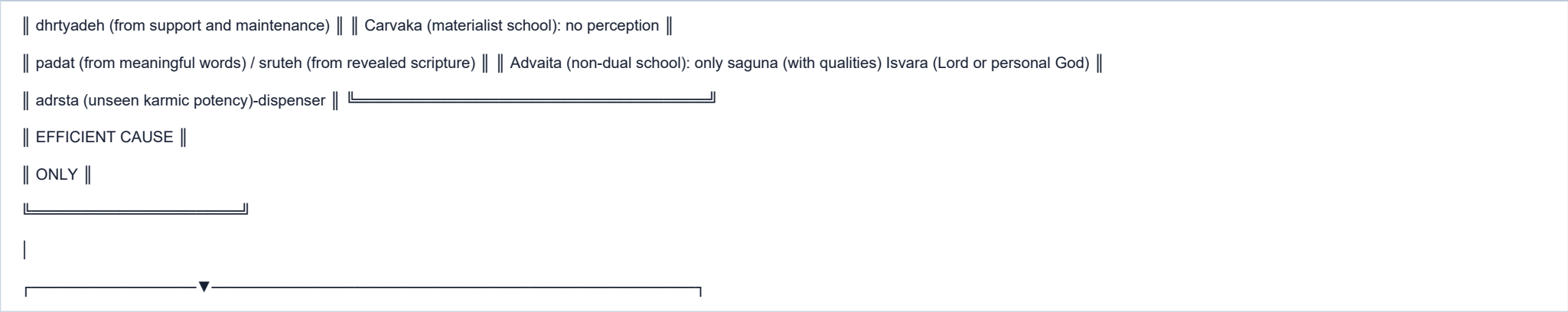
| the ontological fine-tuning |



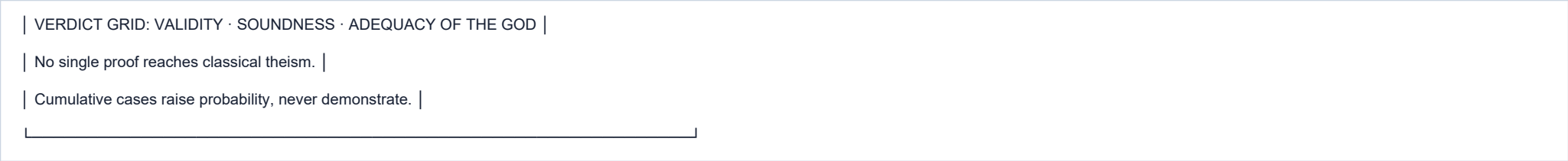
BASIC NODE 189 | VISUAL MASTER CONCEPT MAP — the whole syllabus item on one page — continued 3/5



BASIC NODE 190 | VISUAL MASTER CONCEPT MAP — the whole syllabus item on one page — continued 4/5



BASIC NODE 191 | VISUAL MASTER CONCEPT MAP — the whole syllabus item on one page — continued 5/5



BASIC NODE 192 | • The master comparison table — continued 1/2

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Proof   Starting point   Conclusion claimed   Indian parallel   Main critic   What actually survives                                                                                                                                  |
| ---   ---   ---   ---   ---   ---                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Ontological   FACT Concept of maximal being   Necessary existence   CAUTION No exact classical analogue   Gaunilo, Kant   CAUTION A conditional: *if* possible, then necessary                                                        |
| Cosmological   FACT Motion, causation, contingency   First / necessary cause   FACT Nyāya (school of logic and realism) *kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)*   Hume, Kant   CAUTION An explanatory demand, not a demonstration |
| Design   FACT Order, adaptation, fine order   Intelligent designer   FACT Nyāya *āyōjanāt (from combination or coordination)*   Hume, Darwin   CAUTION Inference to the best explanation, at best                                     |
| Moral   FACT Moral law and the highest good   Practical postulate   FACT Nyāya *karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits)*   Naturalist axiology, Euthyphro   CAUTION A rational hope internal to moral seriousness                 |



BASIC NODE 193 | • The master comparison table — continued 2/2

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nyāya (school of logic and realism) inference   FACT World as composite *kārya (effect)*   Omniscient efficient cause   —   Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty), Buddhism, Jainism, Cārvāka (materialist school)   CAUTION A cumulative theism vulnerable to the redundancy charge |
| Mīmāṃsā counter   FACT Eternal Veda (sacred revealed knowledge); self-operating *apūrva (unseen potency generated by ritual duty)*   No creator required   —   Nyāya   FACT A coherent non-theistic account of normativity                                                       |
| Jaina counter   FACT Uncreated world; material karma (morally consequential action)   Godhood without God   —   Nyāya   FACT A soteriological theism without cosmology                                                                                                           |



BASIC NODE 194 | • Criticisms and replies — the consolidated grid — continued 1/2

|                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Objection   Proof affected   Reply   Assessment                                                                                                                                          |
| ---   ---   ---   ---                                                                                                                                                                    |
| FACT "Existence is not a predicate"   Ontological   CAUTION Modal versions use *necessary* existence   CAUTION The possibility premise now bears the burden                              |
| FACT Fallacy of composition   Cosmological   CAUTION The argument concerns dependence, not property-transfer   CAUTION Must be framed as an essentially ordered series                   |
| FACT Infinite regress may be acceptable   Cosmological   CAUTION An infinite series of derivative causes supplies no actualising power   CAUTION Requires proving the series is *per se* |
| FACT Cosmological borrows the ontological   Cosmological   CAUTION Thomists identify the necessary being with God by further argument   CAUTION That further argument is disputable      |
| FACT Weak world–artefact analogy   Design, Nyāya (school of logic and realism)   CAUTION Treat as probabilistic rather than deductive   CAUTION The conclusion becomes modest            |



## BASIC NODE 195 | • Criticisms and replies — the consolidated grid — continued 2/2

| FACT Natural selection explains adaptation | Paley | CAUTION Relocate to law-governedness and fine-tuning | CAUTION Rivals (multiverse) remain available |

| FACT Cause need not be one, personal or perfect | Cosmological, design | CAUTION Cumulative arguments add attributes | FACT No single proof reaches classical theism |

| FACT Karma (morally consequential action) can operate without God | Nyāya (school of logic and realism) | CAUTION Intelligent allocation explains determinate desert | QUESTION Tracks rival metaphysics |

| FACT The Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) needs no author | Nyāya \*padāt (from meaningful words)/śruteḥ (from revealed scripture)\* | CAUTION Authorless normativity is itself unexplained | QUESTION The most evenly matched Indian dispute |

| FACT Moral values may be naturalistically explained | Moral | CAUTION Kant postulates rather than infers | CAUTION The postulate can still be declined |

| CAUTION Divine redundancy (Sharma) | Nyāya | CAUTION A supervisor who alone allots is not dispensable | CAUTION Nyāya's hardest challenge |



## BASIC NODE 196 | • Four verdicts you may safely defend — continued 1/2

CAUTION Choose one as the thesis of any answer, and defend it; do not hedge across all four.

V1 MINIMAL : No proof is demonstrative; each fails on validity, soundness

or adequacy. (Chatterjee-Datta, following Kant and Lotze.)

V2 CUMULATIVE: Individually weak, jointly they raise the probability of

theism. (Udayana;

Swinburne; the 2025-26 literature.)

V3 DIVERGENT : Different proofs establish different things — necessity,

agency, intelligence, moral government — and no single one



## BASIC NODE 197 | • Four verdicts you may safely defend — continued 2/2

was ever meant to deliver the whole God of religion.

V4 EXPERIENTIAL: Proofs are "pleas put forward in justification of our

faith" (Lotze);

God must be known through direct experience,

not through reasoning. (Chatterjee-Datta's own conclusion.)



BASIC NODE 198 | • India and the West — convergence and divergence — continued 1/2

| Axis | FACT Convergence | FACT Divergence |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Method | Both build a posteriori inferences from order to intelligence | CAUTION India has no a priori ontological route;

Nyāya (school of logic and realism) requires \*vyāpti (invariable concomitance)\* |

| Object established | Both reach an intelligent cause | FACT Aquinas' God causes \*being\*;

Nyāya's Īśvara (Lord or personal God) causes only \*order\* |

| Material cause | — | FACT Creation \*ex nihilo\* vs eternal atoms |

| Moral government | FACT Providence ≈ \*karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits)\* | CAUTION Kant postulates it;



BASIC NODE 199 | • India and the West — convergence and divergence — continued 2/2

Nyāya (school of logic and realism) infers it |

| Scriptural authority | Both invoke revelation somewhere | FACT Nyāya makes God the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge)'s author;

Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) makes the Veda authorless — no Western analogue |

| Anti-theistic critique | FACT Both traditions field economy, coherence and evil-based objections | CAUTION India's critiques come from \*within\* orthodoxy (Mīmāṃsā, Sāṃkhya (dualist school based on enumerated principles)), not only from sceptics |

CAUTION The best single comparative sentence in the topic: **"Nyāya and Western natural theology converge in inferring from order to intelligence, but diverge over material causation and karma (morally consequential action) — and where the West's sharpest critics stood outside religion, India's stood inside it."**



BASIC NODE 200 | • Answer architecture

Route marker retained from the learner-v2 source.



BASIC NODE 201 | 10 marks (≈150 words, 7–8 minutes)

Name and classify the proof → state its premises in sequence →

identify ONE presupposition → give the canonical objection →

one-sentence verdict on what the proof actually establishes.



## BASIC NODE 202 | 15 marks (≈220–260 words, 12–13 minutes)

Frame the explanatory question the proof answers → reconstruct the argument  
as numbered steps → give the canonical example (watch, pot, stick-stone) →  
the critic's strongest objection → the proponent's best reply →  
assess VALIDITY and the ADEQUACY OF THE CONCLUSION SEPARATELY.



## BASIC NODE 203 | 20 marks (≈320–360 words, 17–18 minutes)

Classify the family of proofs → full internal steps → contrast the  
Indian/Western analogue → TWO objections with replies → the  
underdetermination of divine attributes → a graded, criterion-named  
conclusion.



## BASIC NODE 204 | • PYQ routing — the complete 2018–2025 map — continued 1/2

| Year | Q | Marks | Demand | Session route |  
| --- | --- | ---: | --- | --- |  
| 2018 | Q6(c) | 15 | Does the concept of God entail the existence of God? (ontological) | Subtopic 2 §8 |  
| 2018 | Q8(a) | 20 | Compare Aquinas' five ways with Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s arguments | Subtopics 3 + 6 |  
| 2018 | Q8(b) | 15 | Critically evaluate the Buddhistic arguments against a creator God | Subtopic 7 Part II |  
| 2019 | Q5(e) | 10 | State and evaluate the Jaina proofs | Subtopic 7 Part I |  
| 2020 | Q6(a) | 20 | Is Anselm's ontological proof logical? | Subtopic 2 |  
| 2021 | Q7(b) | 15 | Critical account of the moral argument | Subtopic 5 |



## BASIC NODE 205 | • PYQ routing — the complete 2018–2025 map — continued 2/2

| 2022 | Q6(a) | 20 | Critical exposition of the Five Ways; which is most interesting? | Subtopics 3 + 4 |

| 2022 | Q8(a) | 20 | A priori vs a posteriori; which is preferable? | Subtopic 1 §2 |

| 2023 | Q7(a) | 20 | Critically examine Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s arguments | Subtopic 6 |

| 2024 | Q7(c) | 15 (10+5) | Exposition of the ontological proof with criticism | Subtopic 2 |

| 2025 | Q6(a) | 20 | Design argument with Hume's criticism | Subtopic 4 |

| 2025 | Q7(b) | 15 | What proofs do Nyāya philosophers offer? | Subtopic 6 |



## BASIC NODE 206 | • "Which Way is philosophically most interesting?" — handling the 2022 evaluative demand

CAUTION The question invites a defended personal judgement.

The two strongest defensible answers:

| Choice | Why defensible | What you must then show |

| --- | --- | --- |

| CAUTION Way 3 (contingency) | It alone asks the deepest question — why is there anything at all rather than nothing? — and connects to the live PSR/brute-fact debate | That you can state the quantifier-shift objection and the \*ab alio / a se\* distinction |

| CAUTION Way 5 (purposiveness) | It generates the richest downstream tradition — Paley, Hume, Darwin, fine-tuning — and is the one still being fought over | That you can separate Aquinas' regularity premise from Paley's analogy |

CAUTION What loses marks: choosing Way 2 and describing it as "the first cause who started the universe", which is not Aquinas' argument at all.



## BASIC NODE 207 | • Model philosophical conclusion

CAUTION "The proofs for God's existence fail as demonstrations but succeed as diagnostics.

The ontological argument shows that God, if real, cannot be a contingent item in the world; the cosmological arguments show that contingent reality does not explain itself; the design argument shows that order invites, without compelling, an intentional explanation; the moral argument shows what a serious moral agent must hope; and Nyāya (school of logic and realism) shows that the same inferential path was walked in India, and met the same objections from Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) and Buddhism that Hume and Kant later pressed in Europe.

What no proof delivers is the passage from the being it establishes to the God actually worshipped — which is why every tradition, Indian and Western alike, eventually supplements proof with experience, testimony or faith."



# PRACTICE

Visual route maps only: diagnostic coverage, PYQ demands and answer pathways.

## PRACTICE NODE 1 | Premium diagnostics — [CORE PAPER II]

Key discipline: Questions 1–32 follow the correct-answer sequence A, B, C, D repeated exactly eight times, with no deviation.

Each question has four plausible options, a detailed explanation, and a one-line trap note.



## PRACTICE NODE 2 | Premium remediation — [CORE ANSWER]

These target the six category errors that cost the most marks in this syllabus item.

Attempt them only after Part II.



## PRACTICE NODE 3 | Remedial R5 — What Hume actually establishes

A.

Hume's target is the strength of the inference and the attributes of the being inferred; in the "Dialogues", Philo himself concedes a remote and undefined analogy between the cause of order and human intelligence

Answer: A · Note: B is Darwin, seventy years later.

A is one of Hume's dialectical alternatives, not his conclusion.



## PRACTICE NODE 4 | Remedial R7 — Validity, soundness, adequacy

Answer: C · Note: A, C and D all grant an inference and question the attributes of its terminus.

Sorting objections by tier is the fastest route to an evaluative conclusion.



## PRACTICE NODE 5 | Remedial R8 — Register of the concluding verdict

Answer: D · Note: D names its criteria, grades its verdict and is comparative.

C is the "safe" conclusion most candidates write; it earns few evaluative marks because it names no criterion.



## PRACTICE NODE 6 | Verified-question status — [CORE ANSWER]

All 12 items below are direct verified owner PYQs.

Exact wording, years and marks are retained.

Demand decoding, full model solutions, marks rationale, timing skeletons and examiner traps are pedagogic answer support, not an official answer key.

Corpus note: FACT The audited Paper II corpus for 2018–2025 contains 12 primary-owned question-parts for this syllabus item, out of 112 parts overall.

The corpus is continuous across all eight years.

Cross-linked questions owned by \*Notions of God\*, \*Reason–Revelation–Faith\* or \*Soul, Immortality, Rebirth and Liberation\* are not duplicated here.

| # | Year | Q | Marks | Theme |



## PRACTICE NODE 7 | Model answer (~240 words) — continued 1/2

The ontological argument claims a unique entailment: that the very concept of God contains, and therefore yields, God's existence.

Anselm defines God as "that than which nothing greater can be conceived", where "greater" means more perfect.

In \*Proslogion\* 2 he argues by \*reductio\*: if this being existed only in the understanding, a greater could be conceived — namely the same being existing in reality as well — which contradicts the definition.

In \*Proslogion\* 3 the claim is strengthened: a being that cannot be thought not to exist is greater than one that can;

God therefore exists necessarily, by aseity.

Descartes recasts this through essence-containment: existence belongs to a supremely perfect being as three angles belong to a triangle.

The entailment fails at a precise point.

Gaunilo's perfect-island parody shows the form proves too much;



## PRACTICE NODE 8 | Model answer (~240 words) — continued 2/2

Anselm replies that only God is defined with necessary, non-contingent existence, which an island by definition lacks.

That reply protects the second form but shifts the burden onto the coherence of maximal greatness.

Kant's objection is decisive: existence is not a real predicate.

A hundred real thalers contain no more concept than a hundred possible ones; existence posits an object rather than enriching a concept.

Chatterjee and Datta restate this in the Indian idiom of a hundred rupees imagined in one's pocket.

Modal reconstructions retain necessary existence but transfer the whole weight to the possibility premise, which a parallel possibility-of-non-existence can offset.



### PRACTICE NODE 9 | What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: state the entailment claim → both Anselmian forms → Descartes → Gaunilo and reply → Kant → modal repair → conditional verdict.
- Conclusion: a conditional entailment verdict — the strongest available and the one the question invites.



### PRACTICE NODE 10 | Model answer (≈345 words)

Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s Tśvara-anumāna (inference to God) proceeds through several routes.

Kāryāt (from the world's being an effect): composite objects are effects, since they are made of parts (\*sāvayava (composite or possessing parts)\*) and possess intermediate magnitude (\*avāntara-mahattva (intermediate magnitude)\*); material causes cannot achieve the required order and co-ordination without an intelligent maker, who must be omniscient, since only such a being can directly know atoms. Āyojanāt (from combination or coordination): inert atoms need purposive combination.

Dhṛtyādeḥ (from support and maintenance): the world's support and dissolution require governance.

Padāt (from meaningful words) / śruteḥ (from revealed scripture): Vedic authority presupposes an omniscient author.

Finally, the argument from adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency): the unconscious stock of merit and demerit cannot allot determinate joys and sorrows, so God is karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits).

The convergence: both infer intelligence from order; both add attributes stepwise rather than by definition; both are cumulative rather than single-inference systems, Udayana multiplying routes exactly as Aquinas multiplies Ways.



### PRACTICE NODE 11 | What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: a comparative frame first, then axis-by-axis treatment — never two disconnected halves.
- Doctrine: all five Ways correctly identified; at least four Nyāya (school of logic and realism) routes with Sanskrit terms.
- Conclusion: same architecture, different terminus — stated as a criterion-named judgement.



## PRACTICE NODE 12 | Model answer (≈245 words) — continued 1/2

Four canonical lines recur.

First, if God is eternal and unchanging, genuine creation is hard to explain, since willing or producing appears to involve change;

Dharmakīrti-type reasoning sharpens this — a permanent, immutable cause fully present at all times should produce its effect always and at once, never in temporal succession.

Second, if God creates from desire or purpose, this implies lack, preference or incompleteness, which is inconsistent with perfection.

Third, suffering and evil sit uneasily with an omnipotent benevolent creator.

Fourth, dependent origination already explains the arising of phenomena through conditions, so a creator is redundant.

To these may be added the methodological point that questions of a first beginning fall among the \*avyākṛta (undeclared or deliberately unanswered)\*, undeclared because soteriologically idle — the wounded man who insists on knowing the archer before the arrow is removed.



## PRACTICE NODE 13 | Model answer (≈245 words) — continued 2/2

Verdict: Buddhism establishes that a coherent, ethically serious cosmology is possible without a creator.

That is a substantial philosophical achievement — but it shifts the burden of proof rather than closing the question.



## PRACTICE NODE 14 | What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: clarify the target → four to six arguments as reconstructions → theistic replies → graded verdict.
- Doctrine: \*pratītyasamutpāda (dependent origination)\*; the \*avyākṛta (undeclared or deliberately unanswered)\* questions; anti-\*Īśvara (Lord or personal God)\* argumentation in Dharmakīrti and Śāntarakṣita.
- Conclusion: decisive against a purposive anthropomorphic maker; inconclusive against refined theism.



## PRACTICE NODE 15 | What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: disambiguate "God" → three proofs → one internal criticism → verdict, all within 150 words.
- Conclusion: a soteriological rather than cosmological theism.



### PRACTICE NODE 16 | Model answer (≈350 words) — continued 1/3

Whether Anselm's proof is "logical" must be split into two questions: is it valid, and is its key premise legitimate?

Anselm's \*Proslogion\* 2 argument is a \*reductio\*.

Suppose that than which nothing greater can be conceived exists in the understanding alone.

Existing in reality is greater than existing in the understanding alone.

Then a greater than the greatest conceivable could be conceived — a contradiction.

Therefore it exists in reality.

Formally this is impeccable: given the definition and the comparative premise, the conclusion follows. \*Proslogion\* 3 strengthens it: a being that cannot be thought not to exist is greater than one that can, so God exists necessarily; since God as infinitely perfect is not limited by time, both coming-to-be and ceasing-to-be are excluded.

The difficulty is not the inference but the comparative premise.



### PRACTICE NODE 17 | Model answer (≈350 words) — continued 2/3

Gaunilo, in In Behalf of the Fool, constructs a parallel for the most perfect conceivable island; if the form is valid, it manufactures islands.

Anselm replies that only God is defined as having eternal and independent existence, whereas an island — a piece of land surrounded by water — is by definition contingent and can without contradiction be thought not to exist.

The reply succeeds for the second form, but it transfers the burden: it must now be shown that maximal greatness is a coherent notion with an intrinsic maximum, whereas island-perfections plainly are not.

Modal reconstructions by Malcolm, Hartshorne and Plantinga preserve necessary existence and are formally valid in S5; but their possibility premise — that a maximally great being is possible — is precisely what is disputed, and a symmetrical possibility-of-non-existence yields the opposite conclusion.



### PRACTICE NODE 18 | Model answer (≈350 words) — continued 3/3

Verdict: Anselm's proof is logically well-formed but not logically compelling.

It is valid in form, question-begging in premise, and at best establishes a conditional: if a maximally great being is possible, it exists necessarily.



### PRACTICE NODE 19 | What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: split "logical" into validity and legitimacy → both forms → Gaunilo → Kant → modal → explicit verdict.
- Doctrine: the \*reductio\* structure; aseity; necessary existence.
- Conclusion: an explicit, defended answer to "is it logical?" — hedging is penalised here more than anywhere else in this topic.



### PRACTICE NODE 20 | Model answer (≈250 words) — continued 1/2

The first form is a straightforward inference: from objective moral laws to a divine Law Giver, or from conscience to a God whose voice it is.

Newman's Grammar of Assent argues that feeling shame and fear before conscience implies One before whom we are ashamed.

The objection is fatal: this assumes that moral values admit of no naturalistic explanation in terms of human needs, social structure or practical reason.

That assumption is precisely what is in dispute, so the argument begs the question.

Criticism cuts several ways.

The postulate may be a projection of a desire for cosmic fairness, though Kant answers that it arises from the structure of moral reason, not from reward-seeking, which would be heteronomy.

If morality is autonomous, God's role is confined to realisability, not obligation — which also insulates Kant from the Euthyphro dilemma, whose real target is divine-command theory.



### PRACTICE NODE 21 | Model answer (≈250 words) — continued 2/2

Adequacy remains the deepest problem: as Hick notes, moral values cannot be said to point all the way to the infinite, self-existent personal creator.



### PRACTICE NODE 22 | What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: two forms distinguished → Kant's derivation as steps → four to five criticisms → graded verdict.
- Conclusion: it establishes a rational hope, not a demonstrated being.



### PRACTICE NODE 23 | Model answer (≈350 words)

Most interesting: Way 3.

It alone poses the deepest question — why is there anything at all rather than nothing? — and it is the only Way whose central premise, the Principle of Sufficient Reason, remains a live philosophical dispute against brute-fact naturalism.

Its conclusion is also modally strongest: not merely a first mover but a being whose non-existence is impossible.

That it is simultaneously the most vulnerable, at the quantifier-shift step, makes it philosophically the richest rather than the weakest — a bad argument for the best question is more instructive than a safe argument for a smaller one.



### PRACTICE NODE 24 | What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: all five expounded compactly → critical apparatus → a defended choice with its own objection answered.
- Comparison: one line on Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s parallel cumulative structure, or on the Kalām's contrasting temporal claim.
- Conclusion: the personal judgement must be argued, with a criterion named — depth of question, modal strength, or contemporary liveness.



### PRACTICE NODE 25 | Model answer (~345 words) — continued 1/3

An a posteriori argument reasons from some general feature of the world.

Aquinas' Ways begin from motion, causation, contingency, degrees and purposive order;

Paley begins from means–end adjustment;

Kant's moral argument begins from the structure of moral obligation; and Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s Īśvara-anumāna (inference to God) begins from the world as a composite effect requiring an omniscient intelligent maker.

Their method is inference from effect to cause, or inference to the best explanation, and their conclusions are correspondingly probable rather than necessary.

Their vulnerabilities differ accordingly.

The a priori route faces Kant's charge that existence is not a real predicate, and Gaunilo's demonstration that the form proves too much; modal repairs shift the burden to an unestablished possibility premise.

The a posteriori route faces Hume: the world–artefact analogy is weak, and from a finite effect one may infer only a finite cause.



### PRACTICE NODE 26 | Model answer (~345 words) — continued 2/3

It is also exposed to scientific advance — Darwin against Paley, cosmological alternatives against the Kalām — whereas the a priori route is immune to empirical developments precisely because it is empirically empty.

Preference.

I prefer the a posteriori route, on three grounds.

First, dialectical: it begins from premises the opponent already grants — that things change, that order exists, that we are obligated — whereas the a priori route asks the opponent to grant a contested concept.

Second, epistemic: it does not require the illegitimate treatment of existence as a determining predicate.

Third, traditional convergence: two independent civilisations, Thomist Europe and Nyāya (school of logic and realism) India, arrived at structurally similar a posteriori arguments, which suggests the route tracks something real in the explanatory demand.

But the preference must be graded.



### PRACTICE NODE 27 | Model answer (~345 words) — continued 3/3

The price is that a posteriori arguments deliver at most a probable, possibly finite cause, and never the God of developed religion.

If the criterion were modal strength rather than evidential contact, the ranking would reverse.

Neither route alone secures religious adequacy — which is why every tradition eventually supplements proof with experience, testimony or faith.



### PRACTICE NODE 28 | What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: multi-axis distinction → exemplars on both sides → differential vulnerabilities → a preference with three named reasons → a graded qualification.
- Conclusion: criterion-relative preference, explicitly named, never a bare "both are useful".



### PRACTICE NODE 29 | What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: nature of Ísvara (Lord or personal God) in two lines → four to five arguments as reconstructions → internal replies → external critiques → graded verdict.
- Conclusion: cumulative but not demonstrative; note the textbook tradition's own experiential turn.



### PRACTICE NODE 30 | Model answer (≈250 words) — continued 1/2

Exposition (10).

The ontological proof is the sole classical a priori argument: it moves from the concept of God to God's existence without any empirical premise.

Anselm defines God as "that than which nothing greater can be conceived", where "greater" means more perfect — and deliberately not as "the most perfect being that there is", which would guarantee nothing.

In \*Proslogion\* 2 he argues by \*reductio\*: even the fool who denies God understands the concept; but if this being existed in the understanding alone, we could conceive a greater — the same being existing in reality as well — which contradicts the definition; therefore it exists in reality.

In \*Proslogion\* 3 he strengthens the conclusion: a being that cannot be thought not to exist is greater than one that can; and since God as infinitely perfect is not limited by time, both coming-to-be and ceasing-to-be are excluded.



### PRACTICE NODE 31 | Model answer (≈250 words) — continued 2/2

God therefore exists necessarily, by aseity.

Descartes reformulates it in \*Meditations\* V: existence belongs to the essence of a supremely perfect being as three angles belong to a triangle, or a valley to a mountain; a perfect being lacking existence would lack a perfection.

Criticism (5).

Gaunilo, in In Behalf of the Fool, parodies the form with the most perfect conceivable island;

Anselm replies that only God is defined with necessary existence, an island being by definition contingent — but the reply then requires that maximal greatness be coherent.

Kant's objection is decisive: existence is not a real predicate; a hundred real thalers add no concept to a hundred possible ones.

Modal repairs preserve validity but relocate the burden onto an unestablished possibility premise.





### PRACTICE NODE 32 | What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: the 10 + 5 split must be visible, ideally with the exposition twice the length of the criticism.
- Conclusion: state what survives: a conditional, not an instantiation.



### PRACTICE NODE 33 | Model answer (≈355 words) — continued 1/2

Hume's critique, in the Dialogues Concerning Natural Religion, was published in 1779, twenty-three years before Paley, who took no apparent account of it.

It attacks on five fronts.

First, any universe capable of persisting must display mutual adaptation — there could not be birds with wings unable to live in air — so adaptation is a precondition of order, not evidence of design;

Hume offers the Epicurean hypothesis, that a finite number of particles in random motion will in unlimited time pass through every combination, one of which is a stable order.

Second, the analogy is weak: the universe resembles a vegetable or a crustacean as much as a machine, and whether those are designed is the very question at issue.



### PRACTICE NODE 34 | Model answer (≈355 words) — continued 2/2

Third, cause must be proportioned to effect: from a finite world one may infer only a finite cause — his illustration of the scales, where an unseen weight can be inferred to exceed ten ounces but never to be infinite.

Fourth, the evidence equally supports many designers, an inferior one, an infant or senile deity, or an abandoned first attempt.

Fifth, evil and disorder count against a good and powerful designer.



### PRACTICE NODE 35 | What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: distinguish the two forms → Paley in full → Hume's five fronts → Darwin and fine-tuning → graded verdict.
- Conclusion: demonstrative failure plus surviving explanatory force, stated as a graded verdict.



### PRACTICE NODE 36 | What a top Philosophy Optional answer must contain

- Structure: note the plurality of proofs → present five or six with Sanskrit names → state the efficient-cause thesis → short evaluation.
- Argument: \*kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)\* must be a reconstruction; the others may be compressed to one or two lines each.
- Technical terms: all six Sanskrit route-names, correctly glossed.
- Conclusion: cumulative persuasiveness with a modest terminus.



### PRACTICE NODE 37 | Six non-duplicative original Mains models — [CORE ANSWER]

These retained models extend coverage rather than repeat a direct verified PYQ.



### PRACTICE NODE 38 | Top-answer checklist

- Simultaneity and derivative power identified as the marks of the \*per se\* series.



### PRACTICE NODE 39 | Model answer (≈160 words)

Jaina divinity is therefore plural, achieved, non-creative and exemplary.

It answers the soteriological question, not the cosmological one — which is why the label "atheism" misdescribes it.



### PRACTICE NODE 40 | Model answer (≈250 words) — continued 1/2

Kant's objection is that existence is not a real or determining predicate: it adds nothing to a concept but posits its object, as a hundred real thalers add no concept to a hundred possible ones.

If so, Anselm's comparative — that existing in reality is \*greater\* — is illegitimate, and the argument builds its conclusion into its premise.

Modal reconstructions by Malcolm, Hartshorne and, most influentially, Plantinga work exclusively with Anselm's second form.

Their claim is that the relevant property is not bare existence but necessary existence, a modal status.

The argument runs: it is possible that a maximally great being exists; a maximally great being exists necessarily and is maximally excellent in every possible world; what is possibly necessary is, in S5, actually necessary; therefore such a being exists.

But it does not escape the objection's spirit.

The entire weight now falls on the possibility premise.



### PRACTICE NODE 41 | Model answer (≈250 words) — continued 2/2

A symmetrical premise — that it is possible that no maximally great being exists — yields, in the same modal system, the contradictory conclusion.

The premises are thus evidentially on a par, and the argument establishes nothing until it is independently shown that maximal greatness is coherent.

That is precisely the question Kant's objection was raising in another form: whether the concept of God can be so specified that its analysis yields existence.



### PRACTICE NODE 42 | Model answer (≈250 words)

The first concerns authority.

The Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) is *apauruṣeya* (not of human authorship) — eternal, authorless and self-valid.

Authorlessness is not a deficiency but a protection: a personal author may deceive or may lack complete knowledge, and if the Veda had an author, its authority would depend on first proving that author's competence and sincerity.

*Mīmāṃsā* (inquiry into Vedic duty) presses the point directly against *Nyāya* (school of logic and realism): the theistic route requires proving that God exists, then that God is omniscient, then that God intends truth, each stage needing independent support.

Combined with *svataḥ-prāmāṇya* (intrinsic validity of cognition), the intrinsic validity of cognition, authorlessness blocks scepticism at the outset without theological machinery.



### PRACTICE NODE 43 | Model answer (≈350 words)

Neither wave is a disproof.

Undercutting objections show the evidence does not support the conclusion; they do not show the conclusion false.

Adequacy objections \*grant\* an inference and deny only its reach.

Hume's own Philo concedes a remote, undefined analogy between the cause of order in the universe and human intelligence.

Darwin later supplies the mechanism Hume lacked, removing Paley's biological premise — Hick's ozone example inverts the intuition — but that too is an explanation, not a refutation.

Modern fine-tuning arguments answer Hume's first wave by relocating the evidence to pre-biological constants, while remaining fully exposed to the second and facing multiverse rivals.



### PRACTICE NODE 44 | Model answer (≈350 words) — continued 1/2

Coherence moves claim that the divine attributes are inconsistent with the act of creating.

Buddhism argues that an eternal, immutable cause cannot produce successive effects, and that creation from desire implies lack.

Jainism asks what God created from, why a perfect being would create at all, and why a compassionate creator's world contains suffering.

Chatterjee and Datta record Max Müller's related point that a creator would be liable to charges of cruelty and partiality.

Epistemic moves deny that the required *pramāṇa* (means of valid knowledge) is available.

*Cārvāka* (materialist school) restricts valid cognition to perception, which undercuts every inferential proof at the outset.

*Mīmāṃsā* (inquiry into Vedic duty)'s *svataḥ-prāmāṇya* (intrinsic validity of cognition) and *apauruṣeya* (not of human authorship) make Vedic authority intrinsic, so no divine certifier is needed;

*Nyāya* (school of logic and realism)'s route, requiring one to prove God, then omniscience, then truthfulness, is dismissed as cumbersome.



PRACTICE NODE 45 | Model answer (≈350 words) — continued 2/2

Verdict: the taxonomy is a genuine advance over school-by-school listing, because it exposes that Indian and Western critiques share the same three structures — Hume's Epicurean hypothesis is an economy move, his proportioning principle a coherence-adjacent adequacy move, and logical positivist verificationism an epistemic move.

It should be used as a framework, not as a straitjacket.



PRACTICE NODE 46 | • Grade the verdict and name the criterion

- "valid in form but question-begging in premise",



PRACTICE NODE 47 | Part VI — Final Rapid Revision Matrix

| Argument / doctrine | Thinker / school | Starting point | Terminus reached | Central criticism | Likely question form |

| Island parody | Gaunilo | Any maximally perfect object | Absurd conclusions | Answered by necessary existence | Criticism of Anselm |

| Five-front critique | Hume, \*Dialogues\* 1779 | Analogy, adaptation, proportion, plurality, evil | Design inference dismantled | Does not disprove a designer | 2025-type question |

| Moral, first form | Newman | Conscience and objective values | Divine Law Giver | Begs the question against naturalism | Critical account of the moral argument |

| Cumulative case | Udayana; modern theists | Multiple independent routes | Higher overall probability | Independence and logical type | 20-mark evaluation |



PRACTICE NODE 48 | Last-minute memory spine

VERDICT : classify → reconstruct → presuppose → object → reply → GRADE

# ADVANCED

Optional refinements, second-order objections and controlled answer use.

## ADVANCED NODE 1 | Advanced cards moved from the complete learner source — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

Route marker retained from the learner-v2 source.



## ADVANCED NODE 2 | BOOK Advanced refinement

CAUTION Anselm's argument is better read as *\*fides quaerens intellectum\** — faith seeking understanding — than as a neutral proof aimed at converting the atheist.

On that reading, its function is to display the internal grammar of the God-concept for one who already believes: God is not one more entity that happens to exist, but that whose non-existence is unthinkable.

This does not save it as a proof, but it explains its extraordinary durability, and it is a mature line to deploy in the concluding paragraph of a 20-marker.



## ADVANCED NODE 3 | BOOK Advanced refinement

CAUTION Note the difference in what the conclusion has to do.

Aquinas needs a being that is *\*ipsum esse subsistens\** — subsistent existence itself — because his question is why anything at all is actual.

Udayana needs only an omniscient agent capable of knowing atoms and combining them.

Consequently Hume's "finite effect, finite cause" objection bites *\*harder\** against Aquinas' identification with the infinite God and *\*differently\** against Nyāya (school of logic and realism), whose God is explicitly limited by co-eternal atoms, souls and *\*adr̥ṣṭa\** (unseen karmic potency)\*.

C.

D.

Sharma presses exactly this point from the Advaita (non-dual school) side, complaining that the Vaiśeṣika (school of categories and realism) God "has been reduced to the status of a supervisor" whose "hands and feet are chained by the shackles of the Law of Karma (morally consequential action) unfolding itself as the *Adr̥ṣṭa*."



ADVANCED NODE 4 | BOOK Advanced refinement

CAUTION There is a deep asymmetry between objections (1)–(2) and (3)–(5).

The first two say \*the evidence does not support design at all\*; the last three concede an inference but say \*it does not reach the God of religion\*.

A candidate who separates these two waves demonstrates control of the argument's logical structure — and can then make the mature observation that the modern fine-tuning revival answers the \*first\* wave (by relocating the evidence to the constants) while remaining fully exposed to the \*second\* (a fine-tuner need not be one, infinite or good).



ADVANCED NODE 5 | BOOK Advanced refinement

CAUTION Kant's own later thought puts pressure on the postulate.

If the highest good is redescribed as an \*ethical commonwealth\* achievable through human moral community, the theological postulate becomes less indispensable.

Conversely, if the highest good genuinely requires a proportioning of nature to desert, no naturalistic substitute is available.

So the argument's fate turns entirely on how the highest good is specified — a point worth one sentence in a 15-marker and a full paragraph in a 20-marker.



ADVANCED NODE 6 | BOOK Advanced refinement

CAUTION Udayana's cumulative strategy. \*Nyāyakusumāñjali (Bouquet of Flowers of Logic)\* does not rest on one inference; it multiplies independent routes — effect, arrangement, sustenance, word-meaning convention, scriptural credibility, moral desert — so that the failure of any single route does not collapse the case.

This is structurally the same move as the modern Western cumulative-case argument, and saying so is a genuinely advanced comparative observation.

CAUTION The counter is equally structural: a cumulation of individually weak inferences does not automatically yield a strong one unless the routes are evidentially independent.



ADVANCED NODE 7 | BOOK Advanced refinement

CAUTION The structural symmetry worth naming in a 20-marker.

Every Indian anti-creator argument is one of exactly three moves: (i) an economy move — the explanandum is already explained (dependent origination, karma (morally consequential action), apūrva (unseen potency generated by ritual duty)); (ii) a coherence move — the divine attributes are internally inconsistent with the act of creating (immutability vs willing, perfection vs motive); or (iii) an epistemic move — the required \*pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge)\* is unavailable (Cārvāka (materialist school)'s restriction to perception;

Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty)'s insistence that the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge)'s authority is intrinsic).

Classifying the objections this way, rather than listing them by school, is exactly what "critically evaluate" invites — and it lets you show that the Nyāya (school of logic and realism) replies also fall into three matching families.



ADVANCED NODE 8 | Canonical advanced doctrine dossiers — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

Route marker retained from the learner-v2 source.



## ADVANCED NODE 9 | • ADVANCED DOCTRINE DOSSIERS

Route marker retained from the learner-v2 source.



## ADVANCED NODE 10 | 8.1 Ontological argument — continued 1/2

- Doctrine statement.

FACT Anselm argues \*a priori\* from the concept of God as that than which no greater can be conceived to existence not merely in understanding but in reality.

- Argument.

FACT (1) Even the denier understands the concept; (2) existing in reality is greater than existing only in understanding; (3) if God existed only in understanding, a greater could be conceived; (4) contradiction; therefore God exists.

Descartes recasts existence as inseparable from supremely perfect being.

- Presupposition.

CAUTION Existence can function in the relevant greatness/perfection ordering, and the concept of a maximally great being is coherent.

- Distinction.



## ADVANCED NODE 11 | 8.1 Ontological argument — continued 2/2

FACT An \*a priori\* proof does not infer from observed effects; it analyses what is supposedly contained in the God-concept.

- Canonical example.

FACT Gaunilo's perfect-island parody tests whether the form can establish any unsurpassable object's existence.

- Objection → reply.

FACT Kant denies that existence is a real predicate.

A modal reply distinguishes ordinary existence from necessary existence, but it must independently justify the possibility of a maximally great being.



## ADVANCED NODE 12 | 8.2 Cosmological arguments and Aquinas' Ways — continued 1/2

- Doctrine statement.

FACT From motion, efficient causation, contingency, gradation and purposive order, Aquinas argues to a first or ultimate explanatory source.

- Argument.

FACT Ways 1–3 move from actualisation, ordered causes and contingent beings to an unmoved mover, first efficient cause and necessary being.

Way 4 moves from degrees to a maximum/source;

Way 5 from regular goal-directed activity of non-rational things to intelligence.

- Presupposition.

CAUTION Essentially ordered causal series require a here-and-now first member; the principle of sufficient reason has sufficient scope.



## ADVANCED NODE 13 | 8.2 Cosmological arguments and Aquinas' Ways — continued 2/2

- Distinction.

FACT Aquinas' "first" is explanatory priority, not simply the earliest event in time.

- Canonical example.

FACT A stick moves a stone only while moved by a hand: the derivative causal power illustrates an essentially ordered series.

- Objection → reply.

CAUTION Hume asks why the series cannot be brute or infinite.

Thomists answer that even an infinite derivative series lacks non-derivative actualising power.





### ADVANCED NODE 14 | 8.3 Design argument — continued 1/2

- Doctrine statement.

FACT Regularity, adaptation or fine order is presented as evidence for intelligent purposive causation.

- Argument.

FACT Paley's analogical form: watches exhibit means–end adjustment and have designers; organisms exhibit complex adjustment; therefore organismic order points to design.

Aquinas' Fifth Way is not identical: it concerns regular directedness of non-conscious nature.

- Presupposition.

CAUTION Relevant natural order is improbable or explanatorily deficient under non-intentional processes.

- Distinction.



### ADVANCED NODE 15 | 8.3 Design argument — continued 2/2

FACT Paley's artifact analogy differs from contemporary probabilistic/fine-tuning arguments;

Darwin directly weakens biological adaptation as Paley used it.

- Canonical example.

FACT The watch on the heath;

Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s potter–pot inference is the closest Indian analogue.

- Objection → reply.

FACT Hume attacks the analogy, inference to one perfect God, and immunity to counterevidence.

A cumulative reply reduces the claim from demonstration to inference to the best explanation.



## ADVANCED NODE 16 | 8.4 Nyāya (school of logic and realism)—Udayana inference to Īśvara (Lord or personal God) — continued 1/5

- Doctrine statement.

FACT Nyāya infers an omniscient intelligent efficient cause who orders eternal atoms and dispenses karmic results.

The classical locus is Udayana's \*Nyāyakusumāñjali (Bouquet of Flowers of Logic)\* (5th \*stabaka (chapter or cluster)\*), supported by his \*Ātmatattvaviveka (Discernment of the Truth of the Self)\*; earlier statements are in Vātsyāyana, Uddyotakara and Jayanta's \*Nyāyamañjarī (Cluster of Flowers of Logic)\*.

- Udayana's enumeration — the complete list, stated carefully.

FACT Udayana compresses his grounds into a single mnemonic verse whose terms are conventionally unpacked as eight \*hetus\*.

CAUTION Translations and school-summaries differ in how they split and gloss the last four; the safe examination practice is to give the Sanskrit term, one clause of content, and to flag that enumerations vary.

| # | \*Hetu\* (Sanskrit) | Inference offered | Status |

| ---: | --- | --- | --- |



## ADVANCED NODE 17 | 8.4 Nyāya (school of logic and realism)—Udayana inference to Īśvara (Lord or personal God) — continued 2/5

| 1 | kāryāt (from the world's being an effect) | The composite world is an \*effect\*; every effect presupposes an intelligent maker who knows its material, means and purpose | FACT Core |

| 2 | āyojanāt (from combination or coordination) | Inert atoms cannot combine themselves; the initial conjunction (\*saṃyoga (conjunction)\*) of atoms requires a conscious agent's volition | FACT Core |

| 3 | dhṛtyādeḥ (from support and maintenance) | Support, sustenance and periodic dissolution of the cosmos require a governing will ("\*ādi (and so forth)\*" carries the maintenance/destruction pair) | FACT Core |

| 4 | padāt (from meaningful words) | The transmission of language, arts and crafts presupposes an original competent teacher | FACT |

| 5 | pratyayataḥ (from credibility or justified cognition) | The validity (\*prāmānya (validity or authoritativeness)\*) of the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) as a body of knowledge requires a trustworthy (\*āpta (trustworthy competent person)\*) author | FACT |

| 6 | śruteḥ (from revealed scripture) | The Veda's own testimony to Īśvara counts as evidence within the system | FACT |



**ADVANCED NODE 18 | 8.4 Nyāya (school of logic and realism)—Udayana inference to Īśvara (Lord or personal God) — continued 3/5**

| 7 | vākyāt (from meaningful sentences) | The Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) consists of \*sentences\*, and sentences are of the kind produced by persons — hence a personal author | FACT |

| 8 | saṃkhyāviśeṣāt (from numerical specification) | The "special number": the \*dyad\* (\*dvyaṇuka (atomic dyad)\*) that begins creation requires the numerical cognition (\*apekṣā-buddhi (cognition of numerical dependence)\*) of a conscious being present at the start, when no finite self is embodied | QUESTION Technically the hardest; state it only if you can state it correctly |

CAUTION The adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency) argument runs beneath all of these: unconscious merit and demerit cannot themselves select who receives which fruit, so an intelligent superintendent (\*karmādhyaṅṣa (supervisor of karma)\*) is required.

It is usually treated as the philosophical core of (3).

- Presupposition.

CAUTION World-wholes are relevantly analogous to artifacts; unconscious \*adṛṣṭa\* cannot administer itself; inference can range legitimately beyond the perceptible.

- Distinction.

**ADVANCED NODE 19 | 8.4 Nyāya (school of logic and realism)—Udayana inference to Īśvara (Lord or personal God) — continued 4/5**

FACT Īśvara is the efficient, never the material, cause in classical Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika (combined logic-realist and category-realist traditions); atoms (\*paramāṇu (atom)\*) , space, time, ether and selves are eternal and uncreated.

God arranges; he does not manufacture \*ex nihilo\*.

- Canonical example.

FACT A pot's ordered parts warrant inference to a potter; the world is treated as a vastly more complex \*kārya (effect)\*.

- Objection → reply.

FACT Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) denies the need for a Vedic author (the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) is \*apauruṣeya (not of human authorship)\* and self-validating) and treats karma (morally consequential action) as self-fructifying through \*apūrva (unseen potency generated by ritual duty)\*;

Cārvāka (materialist school) denies that inference can reach the supersensible at all;

Buddhists (Dharmakīrti, Śāntarakṣita) attack the causal premise;

**ADVANCED NODE 20 | 8.4 Nyāya (school of logic and realism)—Udayana inference to Īśvara (Lord or personal God) — continued 5/5**

Advaita (non-dual school) grants Īśvara only \*vyāvahārika (empirical level of reality)\* standing.

Nyāya's standing reply is that unconscious merit cannot intelligently allot determinate fruits, and that the dissimilarity between pot and cosmos affects the \*strength\*, not the \*form\*, of the inference.

- Verdict formula.

CAUTION "Udayana's is the most systematic Indian natural theology: it is a cumulative case, not a single demonstration, and it inherits exactly the Humean liabilities of the Western design argument — plus one of its own, that the artifact analogy is doing more work in (1)–(2) than the atomism can bear."



### ADVANCED NODE 21 | 8.5 Moral argument — continued 1/2

- Doctrine statement.

FACT Kant does not theoretically prove God; practical reason postulates God and immortality in relation to the highest good, where virtue and happiness are proportioned.

- Argument.

FACT (1) Moral law obligates pursuit of the highest good; (2) finite agents cannot secure harmony of virtue and happiness; (3) practical rational hope postulates conditions under which it is possible; (4) God and immortality are therefore practical postulates.

- Presupposition.

CAUTION "Ought implies can" applies to the highest good and moral rationality licenses postulation.

- Distinction.

FACT A postulate of practical reason is not a speculative demonstration or empirical hypothesis.



### ADVANCED NODE 22 | 8.5 Moral argument — continued 2/2

- Objection → reply.

CAUTION The argument may project a desire for cosmic fairness.

Kant's reply is that the postulate arises from moral reason's structure, not reward-seeking heteronomy.



### ADVANCED NODE 23 | 8.6 Jainism: rejection of a creator, and what "God" then means (2019 Q5(e) owner-module) — continued 1/7

CAUTION Read the question exactly. "Proofs for the existence of God as propounded in Jainism" is a trap-shaped stem: Jainism offers no proof of a creator God — it offers (a) a battery of arguments \*against\* a creator, and (b) a positive doctrine of divinity as the perfected soul.

A script that invents Jain theistic proofs loses the paper; a script that says only "Jainism is atheistic" loses half the marks.

- Doctrine statement.

FACT Jainism is non-theistic but not irreligious: the universe (\*loka (cosmos)\*) is uncreated, beginningless and eternal, running by its own six \*dravyas\* (jīva (individual living self), pudgala (matter), dharma (duty or sustaining moral order), adharma (wrongdoing or non-duty), ākāśa (space or ether), kāla (time)) and by the karmic mechanism; there is no creator, sustainer or destroyer.

Divinity is not a cosmic office but an achieved state of the soul.

- The Jain arguments against a creator, reconstructed.



### ADVANCED NODE 24 | 8.6 Jainism: rejection of a creator, and what "God" then means (2019 Q5(e) owner-module) — continued 2/7

FACT (classically assembled in Jinasena's \*Mahāpurāṇa (Great Purana)\* and Hemacandra's works; also Haribhadra, Akalaṅka, Vidyānandi)

- Motive argument (the strongest, and the one the examiner wants).

A perfect being is by definition complete — without unfulfilled desire, deficiency or need.

Creation is an \*action\*, and every action presupposes a want or purpose.

Therefore either God is perfect and had no motive to create, or God had a motive and is not perfect.

FACT

- Regress argument.

If everything that exists needs a maker, the maker needs a maker; if the maker can be uncaused, so can the world — the premise defeats itself.



### ADVANCED NODE 25 | 8.6 Jainism: rejection of a creator, and what "God" then means (2019 Q5(e) owner-module) — continued 3/7

FACT

- Instrument/material argument.

Before creation there was no matter, no space, no body and no instrument; an immaterial God with nothing to work on and nothing to work with cannot act.

FACT

- Moral argument (theodicy in reverse).

If God created out of compassion, the world would not contain suffering, inequality and predation; if he created without compassion, he is not good.

Karma (morally consequential action), by contrast, explains the \*distribution\* of fortune without impugning anyone's goodness.

FACT



## ADVANCED NODE 26 | 8.6 Jainism: rejection of a creator, and what "God" then means (2019 Q5(e) owner-module) — continued 4/7

- Redundancy argument.

Karmic matter, the six substances and the causal laws already explain order, bondage and release; a creator adds no explanatory work.

FACT (This is the \*lāghava (explanatory economy or parsimony)\*/parsimony move.)

- Nature (svabhāva (intrinsic nature)) argument.

Things act according to their own nature — fire burns, water flows — so cosmic regularity needs no external superintendent.

FACT

- What Jainism affirms instead — and the distinction you must not blur.

FACT



## ADVANCED NODE 27 | 8.6 Jainism: rejection of a creator, and what "God" then means (2019 Q5(e) owner-module) — continued 5/7

- Arihanta (embodied conqueror of obscuring passions) / Kevalin (embodied possessor of perfect knowledge): one who has destroyed the four \*ghātiyā (soul-obscuring karmas)\* (obscuring) karmas and attained \*kevala-jñāna (perfect omniscience)\* (omniscience) while still embodied.

- Tīrthaṅkara ("ford-maker"): a special class of arihanta who, having attained omniscience, re-establishes the \*tīrtha (ford or path across bondage)\* — the fourfold order of monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen — and preaches the path.

There are 24 in each half-cycle;

Mahāvīra is the 24th of the present.

A Tīrthaṅkara is thus defined by a teaching-and-founding function, not by a metaphysical rank above other Kevalins.

- Siddha (liberated disembodied soul): the soul that has additionally shed the four \*aghātiyā (non-obscuring karmas affecting embodiment)\* karmas at death, is disembodied, and rests at the \*siddhaśīlā (abode of liberated souls)\* at the summit of the \*loka (cosmos)\* with the four infinitudes (\*ananta-catuṣṭaya (four infinitudes of the liberated soul)\*: infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, energy).

FACT



## ADVANCED NODE 28 | 8.6 Jainism: rejection of a creator, and what "God" then means (2019 Q5(e) owner-module) — continued 6/7

- CAUTION Therefore: every Tirthaṅkara (ford-maker who teaches the path to liberation) becomes a Siddha (liberated disembodied soul), but not every Siddha was a Tirthaṅkara; and neither creates, sustains, judges or answers prayer.

Worship of the Tirthaṅkara (\*vītarāga (one free from passions)\*, "one free of passion") is commemorative and aspirational — the object of worship does not respond, and cannot, since responsiveness would be a passion.

- FACT The \*Namokāra (fivefold formula of salutation)\* mantra (sacred utterance)'s five-fold salutation (arihanta (embodied conqueror of obscuring passions), siddha, ācārya (monastic teacher), upādhyāya (scriptural preceptor), sādhu (renunciant)) salutes qualities and stages, not a deity.

- Presupposition.

CAUTION That perfection excludes motivated action; that parsimony favours an intrinsic karmic mechanism; that consciousness belongs intrinsically to an eternal plurality of jīvas (individual living selves).

- Objection → reply.

FACT Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s objection: unconscious karmic matter cannot allot determinate fruits to determinate persons, nor can inert atoms self-organise — an intelligent \*adhyakṣa (supervisor)\* is required.



## ADVANCED NODE 29 | 8.6 Jainism: rejection of a creator, and what "God" then means (2019 Q5(e) owner-module) — continued 7/7

Jain reply: karmic influx and maturation are law-like properties of the jīva (individual living self)–pudgala (matter) relation, exactly as poison acts without a poisoner supervising it.

CAUTION Counter-objection: "God has no motive" assumes creation must be motivated as \*human\* action is — a classical theist replies that creation is a free, non-needy expression of goodness (\*bonum diffusivum sui\*), not the satisfaction of a lack.

This exchange is the highest-yield paragraph in the answer.

- Verdict formula.

CAUTION "Jainism supplies no proof \*of\* God; it supplies a proof-structure \*against\* a creator and a redefinition of divinity as the soul's achieved perfection.

Its motive argument is genuinely powerful against an anthropomorphic creator, and genuinely weaker against a classical theism that denies creation is need-driven."



### ADVANCED NODE 30 | 8.7 The Buddhist case against a creator God, reconstructed (2018 Q8(b) owner-module) — continued 1/5

- Doctrine statement.

FACT Buddhism denies a creator (\*Īśvara (Lord or personal God)\*/\*Brahmā (creator deity)\* understood as world-maker) on three independent fronts: canonical-critical, causal-metaphysical, and moral.

It does not thereby deny the existence of \*devas\*, who are simply long-lived, impermanent beings inside saṃsāra (cycle of rebirth).

- (a) Canonical/critical stratum.

FACT The \*Brahmajāla (Discourse on the Supreme Net) Sutta\* (DN 1) explains belief in a creator genetically: the being first reborn in an empty Brahmā-world, seeing others appear after his wish, mistakenly concludes "I am Brahmā, the Maker, the Creator" — and later arrivals, remembering him, transmit the error.

The \*Aggañña (Discourse on Origins) Sutta\* (DN 27) replaces creation with a naturalistic-cyclic account of cosmic and social evolution.

FACT The avyākata (undeclared) questions and the parable of the man wounded by a poisoned arrow set aside speculative cosmogony as soteriologically useless.



### ADVANCED NODE 31 | 8.7 The Buddhist case against a creator God, reconstructed (2018 Q8(b) owner-module) — continued 2/5

CAUTION Note the honest limit: these are \*diagnoses of the belief\*, not refutations of the proposition.

- (b) Causal-metaphysical stratum (Dharmakīrti, Śāntarakṣita's \*Tattvasaṃgraha (Compendium of Principles)\* with Kamalaśīla's commentary).

FACT This is where the examinable argument lies.

- Criterion of existence: to be real is to be causally efficacious (\*arthakriyā-kāritva (causal efficacy)\*).
- The dilemma of successive vs simultaneous production (\*krama-akrama-virodha (conflict between sequential and non-sequential causation)\*): a permanent, unchanging cause must produce its effects either all at once or successively.

If all at once, the whole cosmos would arise in one instant and nothing would follow.

If successively, then God must change — acquiring at t2 some auxiliary condition he lacked at t1 — and is therefore neither permanent nor self-sufficient.



### ADVANCED NODE 32 | 8.7 The Buddhist case against a creator God, reconstructed (2018 Q8(b) owner-module) — continued 3/5

- Auxiliary-condition regress: if God needs auxiliaries (material, karma (morally consequential action), time), he is not the sole cause; if he does not, the temporal order of the world is unexplained.
- Evidential objection: God is neither perceived nor validly inferred; the inference from "effect" to "intelligent maker" fails because \*vyāpti (invariable concomitance)\* (invariable concomitance) between "being an effect" and "having a conscious maker" is established only for artifacts, and generalising it is the very point at issue.
- Explanatory redundancy: \*pratītyasamutpāda (dependent origination)\* — conditioned co-arising — already accounts for arising and cessation; a creator is an idle wheel.
- (c) Moral stratum.

FACT If a being had the power to create and ordered a world containing this quantity of suffering, that being is either not benevolent or not omnipotent; and if all is God's will, karma and moral effort are pointless.





### ADVANCED NODE 33 | 8.7 The Buddhist case against a creator God, reconstructed (2018 Q8(b) owner-module) — continued 4/5

The \*Devadaha Sutta\* (MN 101) makes the parallel point against determinism generally: a doctrine that makes present effort ineffective destroys the moral life.

CAUTION The verse-form of this argument in the \*Bhūridatta Jātaka\* (story of a previous birth)\* is standardly cited but the wording is translation-dependent — paraphrase it.

- Presupposition.

CAUTION Causal efficacy is the mark of the real; permanence and productive activity are incompatible; soteriology sets the agenda for metaphysics.

- Distinction.

FACT Buddhism is non-theistic, not merely atheistic: it rejects a \*creator\*, not every divine being; it rejects \*Īśvara-kāraṇa-vāda\* (doctrine that God is the cause)\*, not devotion as such.

Later Mahāyāna (Great Vehicle tradition) Buddha-fields and celestial bodhisattvas (beings committed to awakening for all) perform religious functions without an omnipotent creator ever entering the system.

- Objection → reply.



### ADVANCED NODE 34 | 8.7 The Buddhist case against a creator God, reconstructed (2018 Q8(b) owner-module) — continued 5/5

CAUTION Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s reply: God's willing is eternal while its \*effects\* are timed by the readiness of adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency), so no change in God is required; and to demand perception of God is to beg the question against inference.

Buddhist rejoinder: an eternal will whose efficacy is timed by something else is not the sole and sufficient cause the theist claimed.

CAUTION Second objection: if there is no self and no creator, what carries karma (morally consequential action)? — routed to Soul §8.3.

- Verdict formula.

CAUTION "The Buddhist case is strongest where it is metaphysical — the permanence/production dilemma bites on any \*unchanging\* creator — and weakest where it is merely genetic, since explaining why people believe in Brahmā (creator deity) does not show there is none."



### ADVANCED NODE 35 | 8.8 Cumulative-case logic: how the proofs are supposed to work together — continued 1/5

- Doctrine statement.

FACT No single theistic argument is standardly claimed to be demonstrative today; the live claim is that several independently weak arguments jointly raise the probability of theism — Richard Swinburne's programme in \*The Existence of God\*, and Basil Mitchell's in \*The Justification of Religious Belief\*.

- Argument.



### ADVANCED NODE 36 | 8.8 Cumulative-case logic: how the proofs are supposed to work together — continued 2/5

FACT (1) Distinguish a P-inductive argument (premises make the conclusion \*more probable than not\*) from a C-inductive argument (premises \*raise\* the probability of the conclusion without making it more probable than not). (2) Cosmological, teleological, consciousness, providence, religious-experience and moral arguments are individually C-inductive at best. (3) On a Bayesian confirmation model, several independent C-inductive arguments can together yield a P-inductive result, provided the prior probability of theism is not vanishingly small and the evidence-items are genuinely independent. (4) Swinburne adds that theism has a high prior on grounds of simplicity — a personal explanation citing one agent with infinite (hence non-arbitrary) degrees of power, knowledge and freedom is simpler than any finite alternative.

- Presupposition.



### ADVANCED NODE 37 | 8.8 Cumulative-case logic: how the proofs are supposed to work together — continued 3/5

CAUTION That confirmation is probabilistic rather than demonstrative; that the intrinsic simplicity of a hypothesis is evidentially relevant; that the pieces of evidence do not merely repeat one another.

- Distinction.

FACT A cumulative case is not a chain (as strong as its weakest link) but a rope or a legal brief (many strands, none sufficient alone).

FACT Distinguish it also from inference to the best explanation, which compares rival total hypotheses rather than accumulating probability.

- Canonical example.

FACT Basil Mitchell's analogy: a jury convicts on converging circumstantial evidence, none of which alone establishes guilt.

FACT Udayana's \*Nyāyakusumāñjali (Bouquet of Flowers of Logic)\* is structurally the same move made in the eleventh century — and should be presented that way in an Indian–Western comparison.

- Objection → reply.



### ADVANCED NODE 38 | 8.8 Cumulative-case logic: how the proofs are supposed to work together — continued 4/5

FACT Antony Flew's "ten leaky buckets": buckets that each leak hold no more water when stacked; zero plus zero is zero.

Reply: the objection would be correct if each argument had \*no\* evidential force, but a C-inductive argument by definition has some; the correct image is strands of a rope, or Bayesian updating on successive independent evidence.

CAUTION Second objection: the same procedure would confirm rival hypotheses (a finite designer, a committee of gods, an axiarchic principle) — the cumulative case underdetermines \*which\* God.

Reply: simplicity considerations are supposed to select the infinite single agent; critics reply that "simplicity" is doing contested metaphysical work.

CAUTION Third: evil is evidence on the other side, so the case must be run as a \*net\* balance, not a one-way sum — routed to Problem of Evil.

- Verdict formula.



## ADVANCED NODE 39 | 8.8 Cumulative-case logic: how the proofs are supposed to work together — continued 5/5

CAUTION "Individually the proofs fail as demonstrations; cumulatively they can at most establish a probability, and even then they underdetermine the personal, morally perfect God of worship.

That gap — between the God of the arguments and the God of religion — is the standing conclusion of the entire clause."



## ADVANCED NODE 40 | • INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES — continued 1/2

| Proof | Starting point | Conclusion claimed | Indian parallel | Main critic |

| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| Ontological | FACT Concept of maximal being | Necessary existence | CAUTION No exact classical analogue | Gaunilo, Kant |

| Cosmological | FACT Motion/causation/contingency | First/necessary cause | Nyāya (school of logic and realism) \*kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)\* | Hume, Kant |

| Design | FACT Order/purpose | Intelligent designer | Nyāya \*āyojanāt (from combination or coordination)\* | Hume, Darwin |

| Moral | FACT Moral law/highest good | Practical postulate | Karma (morally consequential action)-dispenser in theistic schools | Autonomy/Euthyphro |

| Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) critique | FACT Eternal Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) and self-operating dharma (duty or sustaining moral order) | No creator required | — | Nyāya |

| Jain critique | FACT Perfection excludes motive; karma is self-operating | No creator; divinity = perfected soul | — | Nyāya (adr̥ṣṭa (unseen karmic potency) needs an allocator) |



## ADVANCED NODE 41 | • INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES — continued 2/2

| Buddhist critique | FACT Causal efficacy; \*krama-akrama\* dilemma | A permanent cause cannot produce a temporal world | — | Nyāya (eternal will, timed effects) |

| Cumulative case | FACT Several C-inductive arguments | Probable theism | Udayana's eight-fold \*stabaka (chapter or cluster)\* | Flew's leaky buckets |



## ADVANCED NODE 42 | • CRITICISMS AND REPLIES

| Objection | Proof affected | Reply | Assessment |

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

| "Existence is not a predicate" | Ontological | Modal versions use necessary existence | CAUTION Possibility premise bears the burden |

| Fallacy of composition | Cosmological | Argument concerns dependence, not shared property | CAUTION Must state an essentially ordered series |

| Weak world–artifact analogy | Design/Nyāya (school of logic and realism) | Treat as probabilistic, not deductive | CAUTION Conclusion becomes modest |

| Cause need not be personal/perfect | Cosmological/design | Cumulative arguments add attributes | CAUTION No single proof reaches classical theism |

| Karma (morally consequential action) can operate without God | Nyāya | Intelligent allocation explains specificity | QUESTION Dispute tracks rival metaphysics |



### ADVANCED NODE 43 | • COMMON UPSC TRAPS — continued 1/3

- CAUTION Do not merge Aquinas' five Ways into one temporal "first cause" argument.
- CAUTION Do not attribute the watch analogy to Aquinas; it is associated with Paley.
- CAUTION Do not say Kant proves God through morality; he postulates God for practical reason.
- CAUTION Do not call Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s God the material cause of atoms.
- CAUTION Do not present Hume as proving that no designer exists; his target is the inference's strength and conclusion.
- CAUTION Distinguish a proof's validity from the adequacy of the God it establishes.
- CAUTION Do not invent Jain "proofs for God".

Jainism proves no creator; it argues \*against\* one and relocates divinity in the perfected soul.



### ADVANCED NODE 44 | • COMMON UPSC TRAPS — continued 2/3

Answer the printed stem by saying so in the first line.

- CAUTION Do not equate Tirthaṅkara (ford-maker who teaches the path to liberation) and Siddha (liberated disembodied soul).

Tirthaṅkara = an omniscient, still-embodied arihanta (embodied conqueror of obscuring passions) who re-founds the fourfold order and teaches (24 per half-cycle);

Siddha = the disembodied liberated soul at the \*siddhaśilā (abode of liberated souls)\*.

Every Tirthaṅkara becomes a Siddha; not every Siddha was a Tirthaṅkara.

Neither creates or responds.

- CAUTION Do not say Buddhism denies all gods.

It denies a creator; devas are impermanent beings within saṃsāra (cycle of rebirth).



### ADVANCED NODE 45 | • COMMON UPSC TRAPS — continued 3/3

- CAUTION Do not reduce the Buddhist case to "the Buddha was silent".

The examinable argument is Dharmakīrti/Śāntarakṣita's krama-akrama dilemma about a permanent cause producing a temporal world.

- CAUTION Do not present Udayana's list as a fixed canonical eight without noting that glosses of \*padāt (from meaningful words)/pratyayataḥ (from credibility or justified cognition)/vākyāt (from meaningful sentences)/saṃkhyāviśeṣāt (from numerical specification)\* differ; give the Sanskrit term plus one clause of content.

- CAUTION Do not treat a cumulative case as a chain of deductions.

It is Bayesian/rope-like; the standing objection is Flew's leaky buckets and the standing reply is that C-inductive arguments are not zero-valued.



## ADVANCED NODE 46 | • KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK — continued 1/2

Keywords: FACT \*a priori\* · \*a posteriori\* · ontological · necessary existence · real predicate · cosmological · essentially ordered series · contingency · sufficient reason · teleological · analogy · regularity · fine order · practical postulate · \*summum bonum\* · \*kāryāt\* (from the world's being an effect)\* · \*āyojanāt\* (from combination or coordination)\* · \*dhr̥tyādeḥ\* (from support and maintenance)\* · \*padāt\* (from meaningful words)\* · \*prat̥yayataḥ\* (from credibility or justified cognition)\* · \*śruteḥ\* (from revealed scripture)\* · \*vākyāt\* (from meaningful sentences)\* · \*saṃkhyāviśeṣāt\* (from numerical specification)\* · \*apekṣā-buddhi\* (cognition of numerical dependence)\* · efficient cause · \*adṛṣṭa\* (unseen karmic potency)\* · \*karmādhyaḥ\* (supervisor of karma)\* · \*apauruṣeya\* (not of human authorship)\* · \*arthakriyā-kāritva\* (causal efficacy)\* · \*krama-akrama-virodha\* (conflict between sequential and non-sequential causation)\* · \*prat̥ityasamutpāda\* (dependent origination)\* · \*avyākata\* (undeclared or deliberately unanswered)\* · arihanta (embodied conqueror of obscuring passions)/kevalin (embodied possessor of perfect knowledge) · tīrthaṅkara (ford-maker who teaches the path to liberation) · siddha (liberated disembodied soul) · \*ananta-catuṣṭaya\* (four infinitudes of the liberated soul)\* · \*vītarāga\* (one free from passions)\* · \*svabhāva\* (intrinsic nature)\* · \*lāghava\* (explanatory economy or parsimony)\* (parsimony) · C-inductive/P-inductive · cumulative case · leaky buckets.



## ADVANCED NODE 47 | • KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK — continued 2/2

Safe formulations: CAUTION "Most proofs underdetermine the rich God of religion." · "Nyāya (school of logic and realism) and Western natural theology converge in inference from order, but diverge over material causation and karma (morally consequential action)." · "Jainism and Buddhism do not merely lack a proof of God; they supply arguments that a creator is either unmotivated or causally impossible." · "A cumulative case can raise probability; it cannot by itself select the God of worship."



## ADVANCED NODE 48 | CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (expanded PYQ audit)

- CAUTION Priority: Primary ownership is 12 of 112 parts and now spans Indian and Western proof-families over the full eight years.
- FACT Required doctrinal depth: The expanded burden includes Anselm, Jain proofs, the moral argument, Aquinas–Nyāya (school of logic and realism) comparison and Buddhist anti-creator arguments, alongside Five Ways, design and Nyāya inference.
- TRAP Trap / answer consequence: Do not list proofs without premises and target conclusion; distinguish critique of validity, soundness, divine attributes and the inference from a cause to the God of religion.



## ADVANCED NODE 49 | • PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025) — continued 1/4

CAUTION Corpus signal: 12 primary-owned question-parts out of 112.

The local Paper II corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025.

Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

| Year | Question | Marks | Exact demand |

| --- | --- | ---: | --- |

| 2018 | Q6(c) | 15 marks | Does the concept of God entail the existence of God?

Examine from the perspective of ontological argument. |

| 2018 | Q8(a) | 20 marks | Compare St.



### ADVANCED NODE 50 | • PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025) — continued 2/4

Thomas Aquinas' five ways of knowing God with the arguments of the Nyāya (school of logic and realism) School of Indian Philosophy for the existence of God. |

| 2018 | Q8(b) | 15 marks | Critically evaluate the Buddhistic arguments against the existence of God as the creator of the world. |

| 2019 | Q5(e) | 10 marks | State and evaluate the proofs for the existence of God as propounded in Jainism. |

| 2020 | Q6(a) | 20 marks | Is the ontological proof for the existence of God by St.

Anselm logical?

Discuss. |

| 2021 | Q7(b) | 15 marks | Give a critical account of moral argument to prove the existence of God. |

| 2022 | Q6(a) | 20 marks | Present a critical exposition of different arguments offered by St.



### ADVANCED NODE 51 | • PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025) — continued 3/4

Thomas Aquinas to prove the existence of God also known as 'Five Ways'.

Which one of them do you find philosophically most interesting?

Give reasons in support of your answer. |

| 2022 | Q8(a) | 20 marks | Discuss the main points of distinction between a priori and a posteriori arguments for the existence of God.

Which one according to you should be preferred over the other?

Give reasons and justifications for your answer. |

| 2023 | Q7(a) | 20 marks | Critically examine the arguments of Nyāya (school of logic and realism) for the existence of God. |

| 2024 | Q7(c) | 15 marks (10+5) | Present an exposition of ontological proof for the existence of God along with its criticism. |



### ADVANCED NODE 52 | • PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025) — continued 4/4

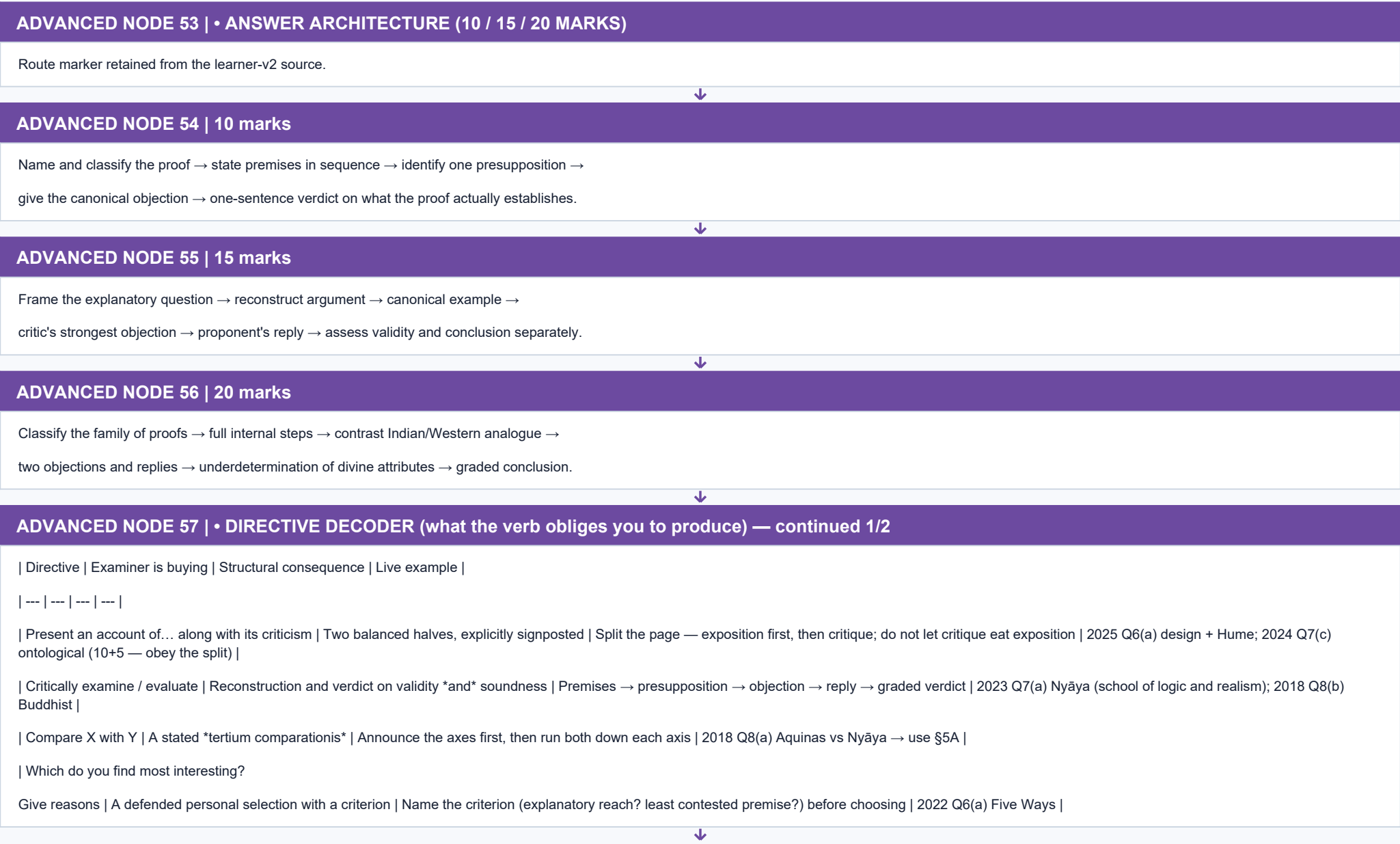
| 2025 | Q6(a) | 20 marks | Present an account of Design argument to prove the existence of God along with its criticism by David Hume. |

| 2025 | Q7(b) | 15 marks | What proofs do Nyāya (school of logic and realism) philosophers offer for the existence of God?

Discuss. |

See the Philosophy of Religion PYQ Bank, 2018–2025.





ADVANCED NODE 58 | • DIRECTIVE DECODER (what the verb obliges you to produce) — continued 2/2

| Does the concept entail the existence? | Engagement with the \*predicate\* question | Kant's premise must be stated, not just named | 2018 Q6(c) |

| Which should be preferred?

Give reasons | Ranking with a cost accounting | Prefer one, then state precisely what you lose | 2022 Q8(a) a priori vs a posteriori |

| State and evaluate the proofs propounded in [school] | Fidelity to what the school actually holds | If the school holds none, \*say so in line 1\* and supply what it does hold | 2019 Q5(e) Jainism → §8.6 |

| What proofs do X offer?

Discuss | Enumeration with premises, not a list of labels | One line of content per named \*hetu\* | 2025 Q7(b) Nyāya (school of logic and realism) → §8.4 table |

KEY Rule: for every proof, answer three separate questions — is it valid? are its premises true? and does its conclusion reach the God of religion?

Most scripts answer only the first.



ADVANCED NODE 59 | • GRADED VERDICT LADDER — continued 1/3

| Band | What the script contains | Typical fault |

| --- | --- | --- |

| Weak (≈40%) | Names the four Western proofs and "Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s inference"; narrates the watch | No premises; critique reduced to "Kant disagreed" |

| Average (≈50%) | One proof reconstructed; standard critique attached | Indian side reduced to one sentence; no distinction between validity and soundness |

| Good (≈60%) | Premises numbered; presupposition named; one objection answered | Conclusion-gap (from "first cause" to "God") not noticed |

| Strong (≈65–70%) | Validity/soundness/adequacy separated;

Indian parallel argued, not asserted; reply to the objection | Cumulative logic still treated as a chain |

| Top (≈70%+) | All the above + a discriminating distinction (essentially vs accidentally ordered series;



ADVANCED NODE 60 | • GRADED VERDICT LADDER — continued 2/3

C- vs P-inductive;

Tirthaṅkara (ford-maker who teaches the path to liberation) vs Siddha (liberated disembodied soul); \*krama-akrama\*) + a statement of what evidence would change the verdict | — |

Graded-verdict templates:

- CAUTION \*Single-proof stem:\* "The argument is valid on reading X but its second premise is exactly what the critic denies; even if sound it delivers only \_\_, and the distance from that to the God of worship must be crossed by a separate argument."
- CAUTION \*Comparison stem:\* "Aquinas and Udayana converge in form — both are cumulative inferences from the world's dependence and order — and diverge in content: Aquinas' God is the source of \*being\*, Udayana's the arranger of \*eternal\* atoms and the allocator of karma (morally consequential action)."





ADVANCED NODE 61 | • GRADED VERDICT LADDER — continued 3/3

• CAUTION \*Anti-theistic stem:\* "The school's negative case succeeds against the creator it targets — an anthropomorphic, motivated, changing maker — and leaves untouched the classical theist's non-needy, timeless creator; whether that surviving concept is intelligible is a different question."



ADVANCED NODE 62 | • FACTUAL AND QUOTATION DISCIPLINE — continued 1/2

| Item | Status | Safe use |

| --- | --- | --- |

| "That than which nothing greater can be conceived" | FACT Anselm, \*Proslogion\* 2 | Quote; then give the reductio form |

| "Existence is not a real predicate" | FACT Kant, \*Critique of Pure Reason\*, A598/B626 region | Quote in this standard English form |

| Watch-and-watchmaker | FACT Paley, \*Natural Theology\* (1802), ch. 1 | Never attribute to Aquinas |

| Aquinas' Five Ways | FACT \*ST\* I q.2 a.3 | Way 5 is about regular directedness, \*not\* Paley's artifact analogy |

| Hume's design critique | FACT \*Dialogues Concerning Natural Religion\* (posth. 1779), Parts II, V, VII, XI | Philo, not Cleanthes, carries the objections |

| Udayana's grounds | FACT \*Nyāyakusumāñjali\* (Bouquet of Flowers of Logic)\*, 5th \*stabaka\* (chapter or cluster)\* | Give Sanskrit term + one clause; flag that glosses vary QUESTION |



ADVANCED NODE 63 | • FACTUAL AND QUOTATION DISCIPLINE — continued 2/2

| Jain anti-creator arguments | FACT Assembled in Jinasena's \*Mahāpurāṇa\* (Great Purana)\* and Hemacandra | Attribute to the tradition; avoid verbatim English "quotations" |

| Buddhist anti-Īśvara (Lord or personal God) argument | FACT Śāntarakṣita, \*Tattvasaṃgraha\* (Compendium of Principles)\* (with Kamalaśīla's \*Pañjikā\* (detailed commentary)\*); Dharmakīrti | Cite the \*argument\*, not an English sentence |

| \*Brahmajāla\* (Discourse on the Supreme Net)\* (DN 1), \*Aggañña\* (Discourse on Origins)\* (DN 27), \*Devadaha\* (MN 101) | FACT Verified nikāya (canonical collection) references | Paraphrase; translations differ |

| Bhūridatta Jātaka (story of a previous birth) anti-creator verses | QUESTION Widely cited, wording translation-dependent | Paraphrase only |

| "Ten leaky buckets" | FACT Antony Flew, \*God and Philosophy\* | Pair it with the rope/Bayesian reply |

| C-inductive / P-inductive | FACT Richard Swinburne's terminology, \*The Existence of God\* | Use precisely — they are not synonyms |



## ADVANCED NODE 64 | • LINK-OUTS — continued 1/2

- Notions of God — what kind of God the proofs are supposed to reach
- Reason, Revelation and Faith — what follows when the proofs underdetermine
- Problem of Evil — the counter-evidence a cumulative case must net out
- Religion without God — Cārvāka (materialist school) on inference to the supersensible;
- Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty)'s \*apūrva (unseen potency generated by ritual duty)\*
- Paper I: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika (combined logic-realist and category-realist traditions) — \*anumāna (inference)\*, \*vyāpti (invariable concomitance)\*, atomism, \*adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\*
- Paper I: Jainism — six \*dravyas\*, karmic matter, the \*guṇasthāna\* ladder
- Paper I: Buddhism — \*pratītyasamutpāda (dependent origination)\*, momentariness, \*arthakriyā\*



## ADVANCED NODE 65 | • LINK-OUTS — continued 2/2

- Paper I: Cārvāka (materialist school) — the attack on inference that undercuts every \*anumāna (inference)\*-based proof
- Paper I: Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) — \*apauruṣeya (not of human authorship)\* Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) against Udayana's \*vākyāt (from meaningful sentences)\*/\*śruteḥ (from revealed scripture)\*
- Paper I: Kant — the predicate objection and the practical postulate
- Philosophy of Religion PYQ Bank, 2018–2025



## ADVANCED NODE 66 | Philosophy of Religion dossier: Topic 2 — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

Route marker retained from the learner-v2 source.



## ADVANCED NODE 67 | • Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique — continued 1/5

- Core prerequisite: Finish ontological, cosmological, teleological, moral, Nyāya (school of logic and realism) proofs, the standard Hume/Kant/Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty)/Buddhist critiques, a priori vs a posteriori, and the owner's answer architectures for 2018-2025 proof questions.
- | Optional advanced debate | Precise competing positions | Strongest extra objection → counter-reply | Safe use in a 15/20-marker |
- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
- | CAUTION Modal ontological argument vs Kantian/ parody critique | Modal defenders argue that if a maximally great being is possible, it exists necessarily;
- Kantian critics deny that conceptual analysis can secure existence, while parody critics attack the form. | Objection: the possibility premise quietly assumes what it must prove. → Reply: the debate shifts from bare existence to the coherence of maximal greatness. | Use as a one-line "modern repair attempt" after Anselm/Descartes, never instead of the core ontological structure. |



ADVANCED NODE 68 | • Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique — continued 2/5

| CAUTION Principle of sufficient reason vs brute-fact universe | Rationalists and Thomists deny that contingent reality can be explanatorily ultimate;

Humean or anti-PSR critics allow brute fact or infinite regress. | Objection: the total universe may simply be there. → Reply: contingent totality still lacks self-explanation, so the explanatory demand does not disappear by enlarging the set. | Useful for the evaluative conclusion of cosmological arguments. |



ADVANCED NODE 69 | • Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique — continued 3/5

| CAUTION Fine-tuning / Bayesian cumulative case vs underdetermination | Some modern theists present design probabilistically through fine-tuning and cumulative evidence; critics appeal to multiverse hypotheses or underdetermination. | Objection: probabilistic design is too weak and rivals remain available. → Reply: defenders present it as an inference-to-best-explanation supplement, not a knock-down proof. | Mention only as a modern extension of teleology; do not replace Paley, Aquinas, or Hume in UPSC exposition. |

| CAUTION Udayana-style cumulative Nyāya (school of logic and realism) theism vs Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty)/Buddhist anti-creator lines | Udayana multiplies inferential routes to Īśvara (Lord or personal God);



ADVANCED NODE 70 | • Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique — continued 4/5

Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty), Buddhism, and anti-creator schools resist the need for a divine allocator or author. | Objection: karma (morally consequential action), Veda (sacred revealed knowledge), and order can function without a creator. → Reply: Nyāya (school of logic and realism) insists unconscious \*adrṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\* and authorless linguistic normativity cannot by themselves explain ordered allocation and intelligibility. | Strong optional finish in Nyāya answers to show that Indian debate is not just a single \*kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)\* inference. |

- What not to over-study: Do not load answers with modal notation, probability equations, or every listed proof in \*Nyāyakusumāñjali (Bouquet of Flowers of Logic)\*.
- Promotion trigger: Promote if a PYQ asks modal versions, cumulative-case reasoning, or specialist Nyāya-Udayana reconstruction directly.
- Credible source trail: FACT Anselm, \*Proslogion\*;

FACT Thomas Aquinas, \*Summa Theologiae\* / \*Summa Contra Gentiles\*;

FACT David Hume, \*Dialogues Concerning Natural Religion\*;

FACT Immanuel Kant, \*Critique of Pure Reason\*;



ADVANCED NODE 71 | • Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique — continued 5/5

FACT Udayana, \*Nyāyakusumāñjali (Bouquet of Flowers of Logic)\*;

FACT B.K.

Matilal, writings on Nyāya (school of logic and realism) reasoning and Indian philosophical method.

EXAM CONVERSION

Final comparison lens, PYQ route map and marks-wise answer spine.

| COMPARISON LENS                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| India–West comparison ->     Ontological (West)   Nyāya (school of logic and realism) inference (India)                                                                                                                                    |
| • India–West comparison ->     Aquinas (Ways 1–3)   Nyāya kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)                                                                                                                                        |
| India–West comparison ->     Paley / Way 5   Nyāya āyojanāt (from combination or coordination)                                                                                                                                             |
| • Solved PYQ — 2018, Q8(a), 20 marks (the comparison question) -> FACT Exact question: <b>"Compare St. Thomas Aquinas' five ways of knowing God with the arguments of the Nyāya School of Indian Philosophy for the existence of God."</b> |
| India–West comparison ->   Objection type   Indian instance   Western counterpart                                                                                                                                                          |
| • The master comparison table ->   Proof   Starting point   Conclusion claimed   Indian parallel   Main critic   What actually survives                                                                                                    |
| Remedial R2 — Efficient versus material causation                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Remedial R4 — Aquinas versus Kalām                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Part VI — Final Rapid Revision Matrix ->   Argument / doctrine   Thinker / school   Starting point   Terminus reached   Central criticism   Likely question form                                                                           |
| Register 8 — Comparative synthesis and answer architecture ->   Item   Register entry                                                                                                                                                      |



PYQ ROUTE MAP

- PYQ 3 — 2018, Q8(b), 15 marks
  - PYQ 4 — 2019, Q5(e), 10 marks
  - PYQ 5 — 2020, Q6(a), 20 marks
  - PYQ 6 — 2021, Q7(b), 15 marks
  - PYQ 7 — 2022, Q6(a), 20 marks
  - PYQ 8 — 2022, Q8(a), 20 marks
  - PYQ 9 — 2023, Q7(a), 20 marks
  - PYQ 10 — 2024, Q7(c), 15 marks (10 + 5)
  - PYQ 11 — 2025, Q6(a), 20 marks
  - PYQ 12 — 2025, Q7(b), 15 marks
- CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (expanded PYQ audit) -> • CAUTION Priority: Primary ownership is 12 of 112 parts and now spans Indian and Western proof-families over the full eight years.
- PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025) -> CAUTION Corpus signal: 12 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper II corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.



## ANSWER-WRITING SPINE

Model answer (≈350 words) -> Neither wave is a disproof. Undercutting objections show the evidence does not support the conclusion; they do not show the conclusion false. Adequacy objections \*grant\* an inference and deny only its reach. Hume's own Philo concedes a remote, undefined analogy between the cause of order in the universe and human intelligence. Darwin later supplies the mechanism Hume lacked, removing Paley's biological premise — Hick's ozone example inverts the intuition — but that too is an explanation, not a refutation. Modern fine-tuning arguments answer Hume's first wave by relocating the evidence to pre-biological constants, while remaining fully exposed to the second and facing multiverse rivals.

Top-answer checklist

Model answer (≈350 words) -> Coherence moves claim that the divine attributes are inconsistent with the act of creating. Buddhism argues that an eternal, immutable cause cannot produce successive effects, and that creation from desire implies lack. Jainism asks what God created from, why a perfect being would create at all, and why a compassionate creator's world contains suffering. Chatterjee and Datta record Max Müller's related point that a creator would be liable to charges of cruelty and partiality.

Top-answer checklist

High-score proof-answer protocol — [CORE ANSWER]

- Grade the verdict and name the criterion -> • "valid in form but question-begging in premise",

Last-minute memory spine -> VERDICT : classify → reconstruct → presuppose → object → reply → GRADE

- ANSWER ARCHITECTURE (10 / 15 / 20 MARKS)

- DIRECTIVE DECODER (what the verb obliges you to produce) -> | Directive | Examiner is buying | Structural consequence | Live example |

- GRADED VERDICT LADDER -> | Band | What the script contains | Typical fault |

Register 8 — Comparative synthesis and answer architecture -> | Item | Register entry |

Register 11 — Last-minute memory spine -> TAXONOMY : a priori (ontological) | a posteriori (cosmo, teleo, moral, Nyaya (school of logic and realism))



## D-R-O-R-V EXAM SEQUENCE

Define the exact issue.

Reconstruct the doctrine or argument step by step.

Present the strongest named objection.

State the best reply or qualification.

Deliver a graded verdict that directly answers the directive.

## ANSWER-GRABBING LINES — CORRESPONDING FLOWCHART STAGES

Each highlighted sentence is complete, exam-ready and linked to its major learner-v2 subtopic. Definition cards explicitly identify the recommended opening definition.

### BASIC STAGE

| BASIC   Roadmap                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —<br>WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM                              | High-value transition: The topic moves from classifying proof-families to reconstructing their premises, testing objections and grading what concept of God, if any, the inference establishes. |
| BASIC   VISUAL — The three questions every proof must survive                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —<br>WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM                              | Core argument: Every proof must be tested for validity, soundness and adequacy: whether the conclusion follows, the premises are true and the being reached is genuinely God.                   |
| BASIC   VISUAL — The ontological argument as a reductio                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —<br>WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM                              | Recommended opening definition: The ontological argument is an a priori attempt to derive God's necessary existence from the concept of the greatest conceivable being.                         |
| BASIC   VISUAL — Two kinds of causal series (the whole argument turns on this) |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —<br>WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM                              | Recommended opening definition: Aquinas targets an essentially ordered present dependence, not merely a temporal sequence extending indefinitely into the past.                                 |
| BASIC   VISUAL — Three teleologies that must not be confused                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —<br>WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM                              | Recommended opening definition: Teleological arguments infer intelligence from purposive order, but Aquinas, Paley and fine-tuning employ distinct forms of order and inference.                |
| BASIC   VISUAL — Kant's two-storey structure                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —<br>WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM                              | Core argument: Kant rejects speculative demonstrations of God while postulating God within practical reason as a condition of the highest good.                                                 |

### BASIC | VISUAL — Nyāya's cosmic division of labour

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Recommended opening definition: Nyāya (school of logic and realism) infers an omniscient efficient cause that orders eternal atoms and dispenses karmic fruits, not a material creator from nothing.

### BASIC | VISUAL — Two completely different senses of "God" in the Indian debate

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: Creator-denial must not be equated with denial of every religious ideal, because Jainism rejects a creator while affirming achieved godhead.

### BASIC | Part I — Jainism

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Recommended opening definition: Jainism rejects a creator God but affirms liberated, omniscient souls as achieved godhead attained through self-effort.

### BASIC | Part II — Buddhism

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Recommended opening definition: Buddhism rejects a permanent creator and explains suffering through conditioned arising rather than divine production.

### BASIC | Part III — Mīmāṃsā

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Recommended opening definition: Mīmāṃsā (school of inquiry into ritual duty) treats the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) as authorless and karma (morally consequential action) as self-fructifying, thereby displacing the need for God.

### BASIC | MASTER CONCEPT MAP — the whole syllabus item on one page

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Final verdict: No proof is demonstrative unless it survives validity, soundness and adequacy, and most arguments underdetermine the rich God of religion.

### ADVANCED STAGE

### ADVANCED | Advanced cards moved from the complete learner source — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: CAUTION Anselm's argument is better read as fides quaerens intellectum — faith seeking understanding — than as a neutral proof aimed at converting the atheist.



### ADVANCED | Canonical advanced doctrine dossiers — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: Doctrine statement. FACT Anselm argues a priori from the concept of God as that than which no greater can be conceived to existence not merely in understanding but in reality.

### ADVANCED | ADVANCED DOCTRINE DOSSIERS

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: Doctrine statement. FACT Anselm argues a priori from the concept of God as that than which no greater can be conceived to existence not merely in understanding but in reality.

### ADVANCED | INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: Comparison earns marks only when thinkers are tested through a constant axis such as starting point, causal model, divine attributes, objection and final explanatory reach.

### ADVANCED | CRITICISMS AND REPLIES

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Major criticism: A criticism should identify whether it attacks validity, a premise's truth or the adequacy of the conclusion, and the reply must answer that exact level.

### ADVANCED | COMMON UPSC TRAPS

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Major criticism: The central examination trap is to collapse distinct doctrines or to claim that a criticism proves more than its argument actually establishes.

### ADVANCED | KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: Ontological arguments reason a priori from the God-concept, whereas cosmological, teleological and Nyāya (school of logic and realism) arguments reason a posteriori from experienced reality.

### ADVANCED | PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025)

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: CAUTION Corpus signal: 12 primary-owned question-parts out of 112.

**ADVANCED | ANSWER ARCHITECTURE (10 / 15 / 20 MARKS)****ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: A high-scoring answer moves from exact definition to argument reconstruction, objection and reply, comparison and a criterion-based graded verdict.

**ADVANCED | DIRECTIVE DECODER (what the verb obliges you to produce)****ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: The directive fixes the answer's burden: exposition requires accurate reconstruction, comparison requires a constant axis, and critical examination requires objection, reply and verdict.

**ADVANCED | GRADED VERDICT LADDER****ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Final verdict: A graded verdict should state what the argument establishes, what it fails to establish and which disputed premise determines the remaining uncertainty.

**ADVANCED | FACTUAL AND QUOTATION DISCIPLINE****ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: Use quotations only with secure attribution, and prefer an accurate paraphrase to a decorative or uncertain formula.

**ADVANCED | LINK-OUTS****ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: Notions of God — what kind of God the proofs are supposed to reach.

**ADVANCED | Philosophy of Religion dossier: Topic 2 — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]****ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: ##### 2. Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique.

**ADVANCED | Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique****ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Recommended opening definition: A proof of God is an argument from concept, world or moral experience to divine existence, and its critique must separately test validity, soundness and adequacy.

**REGISTER STAGE**

## REGISTER | Register 1 — The architecture of theistic proof

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Recommended opening definition: Theistic proofs are best classified by starting point, inferential form and the concept of God reached, then tested separately for validity, soundness and adequacy.

## REGISTER | Register 2 — Ontological argument

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Recommended opening definition: The ontological argument seeks to infer necessary existence from the concept of the greatest conceivable or maximally perfect being.

## REGISTER | Register 3 — Cosmological arguments

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Core argument: FACT Ways 1–3 are cosmological; Way 4 is henological; Way 5 is teleological.

## REGISTER | Register 4 — Teleological argument

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Core argument: FACT Paley's evidence is cumulative: the eye as a self-adjusting optical instrument, the bird's wing, the fish's fin, planetary rotation, the seasons.

## REGISTER | Register 5 — Moral argument

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Core argument: FACT Kant's structure: moral law obligates → its complete object is the highest good (virtue + proportionate happiness) → ought implies can → holiness unattainable in finite time (immortality) and nature does not proportion happiness to virtue (God) → plus freedom, presupposed by obligation.

## REGISTER | Register 6 — Nyāya–Udayana theism

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Recommended opening definition: FACT Nature of Īśvara (Lord or personal God): first efficient cause, a demiurgus or builder — not the material cause; also preserver (the world is kept in existence by God's will) and destroyer (when the moral order requires).

## REGISTER | Register 7 — Jaina, Buddhist, Mīmāṃsā and Cārvāka critiques

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: FACT Denies God as creator; the world was never created; substances are eternal and change through modes; utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya.

**REGISTER | Register 8 — Comparative synthesis and answer architecture**
**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Final verdict: Comparison is strongest when each position is judged through the same axes of ultimate reality, world relation, human relation, causation and religious function.

**REGISTER | Register 9 — The eleven master traps**
**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

Major criticism: CAUTION Do not present Hume as proving that no designer exists; his target is the inference's strength and its conclusion's attributes.

**REGISTER | Register 10 — Keyword and statement bank**
**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: Ontological arguments reason a priori from the God-concept, whereas cosmological, teleological and Nyāya (school of logic and realism) arguments reason a posteriori from experienced reality.

**REGISTER | Register 11 — Last-minute memory spine**
**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE —  
WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

High-value transition: End of the complete learning session and consolidated register notes.

# REGISTER

Final source-complete rapid recall: distinctions, traps, routes and verdicts.

## REGISTER NODE 1 | Register 1 — The architecture of theistic proof — continued 1/2

- | Item | Register entry |
- | --- | --- |
- | Syllabus wording | FACT "Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique (Indian and Western)" |
- | Three senses of "proof" | FACT Demonstration · probable/explanatory inference · practical postulate |
- | The assessment grid | CAUTION Validity (does it follow?) → Soundness (are the premises true?) → Adequacy (is the being reached \*God\*?) |
- | A priori route | FACT Ontological only (Anselm, Descartes) |
- | A posteriori routes | FACT Cosmological, teleological, moral, Nyāya (school of logic and realism) \*Īśvara-anumāna (inference to God)\* |
- | A priori strength / weakness | FACT Yields necessity / CAUTION commits the existence-predicate fallacy |



## REGISTER NODE 2 | Register 1 — The architecture of theistic proof — continued 2/2

- | A posteriori strength / weakness | FACT Begins from conceded facts / CAUTION reaches only a probable, finite cause |
- | 2022 verdict formula | CAUTION Preference depends on the criterion: evidential contact → a posteriori; modal strength → a priori; religious adequacy → neither alone |
- | Mnemonic | KEY O-C-T-M + N, critiqued by J-B-M |



### REGISTER NODE 3 | Register 2 — Ontological argument — continued 1/3

- FACT Anselm's definition: "that than which nothing greater can be conceived"; "greater" = more perfect.

Not "the most perfect being that there is".

- FACT First form (Proslogion 2): existing in reality is greater than existing in the mind alone; hence God exists in reality.

Addressed to the Psalmist's "fool".

- FACT Second form (Proslogion 3): a being that cannot be thought not to exist is greater; hence God exists necessarily.

Core notion = aseity / self-existence.

- FACT Descartes (Meditations V): existence belongs to the essence of a supremely perfect being as three angles to a triangle, or a valley to a mountain.

- CAUTION Descartes' \*Meditations\* III causal proof is a different argument — do not merge.



### REGISTER NODE 4 | Register 2 — Ontological argument — continued 2/3

- FACT Gaunilo, In Behalf of the Fool: the perfect-island parody.

CAUTION He should have said "most perfect \*conceivable\* island".

- FACT Anselm's reply: only God is defined with necessary existence; an island is by definition a contingent piece of land surrounded by water.

- FACT Kant: "existence is not a real predicate"; a hundred real thalers contain no more concept than a hundred possible ones.

- FACT Chatterjee–Datta's Indian idiom: the thought of a hundred rupees in my pocket involves the \*idea\* of their existence, not their real physical existence.

- CAUTION Post-Fregean objection: existence is second-order (instantiation of a concept), so it cannot appear among perfections.

- CAUTION Modal repair (Malcolm, Hartshorne, Plantinga): if a maximally great being is possible, it exists necessarily — but the possibility premise bears the whole burden, and a parallel "possibly no such being" reverses the result.



### REGISTER NODE 5 | Register 2 — Ontological argument — continued 3/3

- CAUTION 2018 verdict: the concept entails existence \*conditionally\*; it does not entail instantiation.

- CAUTION India: no classical analogue;

Indian epistemology grounds existence-claims in world-involving \*pramāṇas (means of valid knowledge)\*.

- KEY A-D-G-K-M: Anselm defines · Descartes essentialises · Gaunilo parodies · Kant diagnoses · Modal logic repairs.



## REGISTER NODE 6 | Register 3 — Cosmological arguments — continued 1/3

- FACT Five Ways (ST I q.2 a.3): motion → prime mover; causation → first cause; contingency → necessary being; degrees → maximum; purposiveness → designer.

Each ends "and this everyone understands to be God".

- FACT Ways 1–3 are cosmological;

Way 4 is henological;

Way 5 is teleological.

- CAUTION Essentially ordered (per se) series: hand → stick → stone; derivative power throughout; removal stops the series \*now\*.

This is what Aquinas terminates.

- CAUTION Accidentally ordered (per accidens) series: grandfather → father → son;



## REGISTER NODE 7 | Register 3 — Cosmological arguments — continued 2/3

Aquinas need not stop it.

- FACT "First" = explanatory priority, not the earliest event in time.
- FACT Aquinas concedes the difficulty of excluding an endless regress of \*events\*; he holds the world's temporal beginning is known by faith, not demonstration.
- FACT Neo-Thomist reformulation: the excluded series is simultaneous dependence, not backward time.
- CAUTION Way 3's weak steps: possible quantifier shift at "at some time nothing would have existed"; and the \*necessary ab alio\* / \*necessary a se\* distinction at the end.
- CAUTION Way 4: degrees imply a maximum — defensible only through the metaphysics of participation.
- CAUTION Kalām: whatever begins to exist has a cause; the universe began; therefore it has a cause.

Argues for a temporal beginning — Aquinas does not.



## REGISTER NODE 8 | Register 3 — Cosmological arguments — continued 3/3

- CAUTION Leibniz/PSR: why is there something rather than nothing?

Every fact needs a sufficient reason; a contingent totality is not self-explanatory.

- FACT Hume: why not an infinite series? explaining each part may explain the whole; the cause need not be one, personal, infinite or good.
- FACT Kant: the passage from "a necessary being" to "the ens realissimum" is the ontological argument in disguise — an adequacy-tier objection.
- CAUTION Composition charge is met by framing dependence rather than property-transfer.
- KEY M-C-C-D-P: Motion, Causation, Contingency, Degrees, Purpose.



## REGISTER NODE 9 | Register 4 — Teleological argument — continued 1/3

- FACT Three distinct teleologies: Aquinas' Way 5 (regular directedness of non-cognitive nature; archer and arrow) · Paley's analogy from artefact to organism · modern fine-tuning (probabilistic, pre-biological).
- FACT The design argument runs from Plato's *\*Timaeus\** through Aquinas to Paley's *\*Natural Theology\** (1802).
- FACT Paley's watch on the heath: wheels, cogs, axles, springs and balances working together for regular timekeeping oblige us to postulate an intelligent maker; a stone does not.
- FACT Paley's three riders: the inference survives (i) never having seen a watch made, (ii) imperfect working, (iii) parts whose function we cannot discover.
- FACT Paley's evidence is cumulative: the eye as a self-adjusting optical instrument, the bird's wing, the fish's fin, planetary rotation, the seasons.
- FACT Hume's *Dialogues* (1779) precede Paley (1802);  
Paley took no apparent account of them.



## REGISTER NODE 10 | Register 4 — Teleological argument — continued 2/3

- FACT Hume front 1: any persisting universe must exhibit adaptation — there could not be birds with wings unable to live in air.  
Epicurean hypothesis: finite particles in random motion pass through every combination in unlimited time; one is a stable order.
- FACT Hume front 2: the universe is as like a vegetable or a crustacean as a machine; only strong analogy with a known artefact licenses the inference.
- FACT Hume front 3: proportion cause to effect — from a finite world one can never infer an infinite creator (the scales illustration).
- FACT Hume front 4: many designers, an inferior deity, an infant or senile one, or an abandoned first attempt fit the evidence equally.
- FACT Hume front 5: evil and disorder count against a good and powerful designer.
- FACT Hume does not disprove a designer; he attacks inference-strength and divine attributes.



## REGISTER NODE 11 | Register 4 — Teleological argument — continued 3/3

- FACT Darwin: random variation plus differential survival explains adaptation.  
Ozone illustration: life fitted itself to the filter, not the filter to life.
- CAUTION Darwin's exact scope: defeats Paley's biological premise; does not touch law-governedness or the fine-tuning of constants.
- CAUTION Fine-tuning: Bayesian/explanatory, not analogical; rivals are multiverse plus observation-selection, and brute necessity.
- FACT Indian analogue: *āyojanāt* (from combination or coordination), pot and potter;  
Chatterjee–Datta note the parallels in Janet, Lotze and Martineau, but stress that Western theists make God the source of *\*existence\** while Nyāya (school of logic and realism) makes God only the cause of *\*order\**.
- KEY Hume's five fronts, A-A-P-P-E: Any universe looks adapted · Analogy weak · Proportion cause to effect · Plurality/imperfection of designers · Evil.





## REGISTER NODE 12 | Register 5 — Moral argument — continued 1/2

- FACT Kant's two storeys: \*Critique of Pure Reason\* destroys the ontological, cosmological and physico-theological proofs; \*Critique of Practical Reason\* reinstates God as a postulate.
  - FACT First form (Newman, Grammar of Assent): conscience implies One before whom we are ashamed and responsible.
- FACT Hick's objection: it assumes moral values resist naturalistic explanation — which begs the question.
- FACT Kant's structure: moral law obligates → its complete object is the highest good (virtue + proportionate happiness) → ought implies can → holiness unattainable in finite time (immortality) and nature does not proportion happiness to virtue (God) → plus freedom, presupposed by obligation.
  - FACT Three postulates: freedom, immortality, God.
  - CAUTION A postulate is practically necessary, theoretically undemonstrable — \*Vernunftglaube\*, rational faith; subjectively sufficient, objectively insufficient assent.



## REGISTER NODE 13 | Register 5 — Moral argument — continued 2/2

- FACT Hick's verdict: moral seriousness is "at least a move in the direction of belief in God", but moral values cannot be said to point all the way to the infinite, omnipotent, self-existent personal creator.
  - CAUTION Objections: projection/wish-fulfilment; autonomy tension; adequacy.
- Euthyphro strikes divine-command theories, not Kant — for Kant the moral law is autonomous and God guarantees proportion, not obligation.
- FACT Indian counterpart: Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits).
- Chatterjee–Datta write: "Or, as Kant would say, it is God who combines happiness with virtue and misery with vice."
- CAUTION Key contrast: Kant postulates a God who \*could\* proportion;
- Nyāya infers a God who \*does\* — epistemically bolder, correspondingly more exposed.
- KEY F-I-G: Freedom · Immortality · God.



## REGISTER NODE 14 | Register 6 — Nyāya (school of logic and realism)—Udayana theism — continued 1/5

- FACT Nature of Īśvara (Lord or personal God): first efficient cause, a demiurgus or builder — not the material cause; also preserver (the world is kept in existence by God's will) and destroyer (when the moral order requires).
- FACT One, infinite, eternal; the world is related to God as a body to the self residing in it; omnipotent yet guided by the merit and demerit of human actions; omniscient.
- FACT Eternal intelligence is an inseparable attribute of God, not His essence — the explicit contrast with Advaita (non-dual school).
- FACT Possesses the six perfections (\*ṣaḍ-aiśvarya (six divine excellences)\*).
- FACT God is prayojaka kartā (directing efficient agent) — efficient \*directive\* cause of human action; man is the efficient \*instrumental\* cause and is only relatively free, directed as a wise father directs a son.
- FACT God is karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits) — impartial dispenser of the fruits of action, moral governor, supreme arbiter of joys and sorrows.



## REGISTER NODE 15 | Register 6 — Nyāya (school of logic and realism)—Udayana theism — continued 2/5

- FACT Theism, not deism: the deist's God withdraws like a clock-maker;

Nyāya's God maintains a continuous relation as creator, maintainer and destroyer.

- FACT Ten proofs are claimed; the more important are usually four or five.

QUESTION Enumerations vary — say so.

- FACT Kāryāt (from the world's being an effect): composite objects are effects because they are made of parts (sāvayava (composite or possessing parts)) and possess intermediate magnitude (avāntara-mahattva (intermediate magnitude)); space, time, ether and self are excluded as partless infinities, and atoms and manas as simple infinitesimals; material causes alone cannot achieve the required order, direction and co-ordination; the intelligent cause must know the atoms, desire an end and will its realisation; and must be omniscient, since only an omniscient being can directly know atoms.

- FACT Āyojanāt (from combination or coordination): inert atoms require purposive combination.

- FACT Dhr̥tyādeḥ (from support and maintenance): support, maintenance and destruction require governance.



## REGISTER NODE 16 | Register 6 — Nyāya (school of logic and realism)—Udayana theism — continued 3/5

- FACT Padāt (from meaningful words) / āptaprāmānya (authority of a trustworthy speaker): the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge)'s authority derives from an omniscient author, as a science's authority derives from its founder; the \*jīva (individual living self)\* cannot be that author because supramundane realities exceed ordinary knowledge.

- FACT Śruteḥ (from revealed scripture): \*Bṛhadāraṇyaka (Great Forest sacred dialogue)\*, \*Śvetāśvatara (sacred dialogue of the Svetasvatara tradition)\*, \*Kauṣītaki (sacred dialogue of the Kausitaki tradition)\* and the \*Bhagavadgītā (Song of the Lord)\* testify to God.

- FACT Argument from adr̥ṣṭa (unseen karmic potency): differences of lot require a cause → karma (morally consequential action) → the time-gap requires a persisting stock of puṇya (karmic merit) and pāpa (karmic demerit) = adr̥ṣṭa → \*adr̥ṣṭa\* is unintelligent and cannot allot the right kind and degree of joy and sorrow; individual selves neither know nor control it → therefore an eternal, omnipotent, omniscient dispenser.

- FACT Circularity objection answered: in the order of existence God creates the Veda; in the order of knowledge the Veda leads to God.

Reciprocal dependence across different orders is not a vicious circle.



## REGISTER NODE 17 | Register 6 — Nyāya (school of logic and realism)—Udayana theism — continued 4/5

- FACT Bodiless-agent objection answered by a dilemma: if God's existence is already proved by śruti (revealed scripture) the objection is idle; if not, it presupposes what it disputes.

- FACT Western parallels: Janet, Lotze, Martineau;

FACT decisive divergence — they make God the creative energy giving existence to things, Nyāya makes God the cause of order only.

- CAUTION Śaṅkara's atomism dilemma: atoms active → permanent creation; inactive → no creation; both → contradiction; neither → an outside agency, itself problematic.

- CAUTION Sharma's redundancy objection: Nyāya's God is "reduced to the status of a supervisor" with "hands and feet chained by the shackles of the Law of Karma (morally consequential action) unfolding itself as the Adr̥ṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)"; the system "could have easily done away with a God".



## REGISTER NODE 18 | Register 6 — Nyāya (school of logic and realism)—Udayana theism — continued 5/5

- FACT Chatterjee–Datta's own conclusion: none of the proofs can prove God, because God, as ultimate reality, is the highest of all premises and cannot be deduced from an anterior one;

God must be known through direct experience.

Lotze: "all proofs that God exists are pleas put forward in justification of our faith."

- KEY K-A-D-P-Ś + adrṣṭa (unseen karmic potency) · KEY E-A-K-V: Efficient cause · Atoms · Karma (morally consequential action) · Veda (sacred revealed knowledge).



## REGISTER NODE 19 | Register 7 — Jaina, Buddhist, Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) and Cārvāka (materialist school) critiques — continued 1/5

Jainism

- FACT Denies God as creator; the world was never created; substances are eternal and change through modes; \*utpāda–vyaya–dhrauvya (origination, decay and persistence)\*.
- FACT "Jainism denies God, but does not deny godhead.

Every liberated soul is a god." Tīrthaṅkaras (ford-makers who teach the path to liberation) were mortals who won liberation by personal effort — "we are all potential Jinas (spiritual conquerors)".

A religion of self-help.

- CAUTION Proof 1 (svabhāva (intrinsic nature)): the \*jīva (individual living self)\* intrinsically possesses \*ananta-catuṣṭaya (four infinitudes of the liberated soul)\* — infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power — obscured, not absent.
- CAUTION Proof 2 (sarvajña-siddhi (establishment of omniscience)): mati (sensory and mental knowledge), śruta (knowledge received through testimony or scripture), avadhi (clairvoyant knowledge) and manahparyāya (direct knowledge of others' thoughts) map degrees of karmic obstruction; complete removal is the limiting case = kevala-jñāna (perfect omniscience).
- CAUTION Proof 3 (āpta-vacana (statement of a trustworthy person)): the testimony of the omniscient Tīrthaṅkaras, one leg of the tri-ratna (three jewels of liberation).



## REGISTER NODE 20 | Register 7 — Jaina, Buddhist, Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) and Cārvāka (materialist school) critiques — continued 2/5

- FACT Jaina God: plural, achieved, non-creative, non-interventionist, exemplary.
- CAUTION Anti-creator arguments: from what material? why create at all (a perfect being lacks nothing)? if from compassion, why suffering? if in sport, God is childish and cruel; who made God — and if God is self-existent, so may the world be; karma (morally consequential action) suffices.
- CAUTION Sharma's internal objection: if ignorance and karma are inseparable from the soul, liberation is impossible; if external, bondage is impossible.
- CAUTION Nāstika (school that rejects Vedic authority) means denier of Vedic authority, not denier of spirit.

Buddhism

- FACT An eternal unchanging God cannot create, since willing or producing involves change.
- FACT Creation from desire or purpose implies lack or incompleteness.
- FACT Suffering and evil sit uneasily with an omnipotent benevolent creator.



## REGISTER NODE 21 | Register 7 — Jaina, Buddhist, Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) and Cārvāka (materialist school) critiques — continued 3/5

- FACT Dependent origination already explains arising through conditions, making a creator unnecessary.
- CAUTION The \*avyākṛta (undeclared or deliberately unanswered)\* questions and the arrow parable: first-beginning questions are soteriologically idle.
- CAUTION Freedom/karma (morally consequential action) dilemma: if God determines all, moral effort is empty; if not, God is not the sufficient cause.
- CAUTION Dharmakīrti-type argument: a permanent, immutable cause cannot produce \*successive\* effects.
- FACT The critique is a systematic refusal of explanatory surplus, not bare atheism.
- CAUTION Replies to note: Nyāya (school of logic and realism) on determinate allocation; the eternal-act/temporal-effect answer to the change objection; diffusive goodness against the desire objection; economy is a methodological preference, not a disproof.

Mīmāṃsā

- FACT The Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) is apauruṣeya (not of human authorship) — eternal, authorless, self-valid; no human and no divine author is needed.



## REGISTER NODE 22 | Register 7 — Jaina, Buddhist, Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) and Cārvāka (materialist school) critiques — continued 4/5

- FACT Authorlessness protects it from an author's deceit or ignorance.
  - FACT Against Nyāya (school of logic and realism): proving God, then His omniscience, then His truthfulness, is a cumbersome three-stage dependence that authorlessness avoids.
  - FACT Apūrva (unseen potency generated by ritual duty) — the unseen potency of correctly performed ritual — matures into future fruit without a divine dispenser;
- Prābhākara's niyoga (binding Vedic injunction) grounds obligation in the injunction itself.
- FACT Chatterjee–Datta record Max Müller's point that a creator God would face charges of cruelty and partiality, and his further point that denying a \*creator\* is not denying God.
  - CAUTION Their own criticism: Mīmāṃsā deities are not objects of worship and exist only in the \*mantras (sacred utterances)\* describing them — "eternal and self-manifesting concepts";

God is relegated to an ambiguous position.

Cārvāka



## REGISTER NODE 23 | Register 7 — Jaina, Buddhist, Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) and Cārvāka (materialist school) critiques — continued 5/5

- FACT God cannot be perceived; the world is made by the automatic combination of the material elements; the Vedas (sacred bodies of revealed knowledge) and priests are rejected.
- CAUTION Perception alone is a \*pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge)\*, so every inferential proof is undercut at the outset.

Classification key

- KEY E-C-E: every Indian anti-creator argument is an Economy move, a Coherence move, or an Epistemic-restriction move.



REGISTER NODE 24 | Register 8 — Comparative synthesis and answer architecture — continued 1/3

| Item | Register entry |

| --- | --- |

| Convergence | FACT India and the West both build a posteriori inferences from order to intelligence |

| Divergence 1 | FACT Aquinas' God causes being;

Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s Īśvara (Lord or personal God) causes only order |

| Divergence 2 | FACT Creation \*ex nihilo\* vs eternal atoms as material cause |

| Divergence 3 | FACT Nyāya makes God the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge)'s author;

Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty) makes the Veda authorless — no Western analogue |



REGISTER NODE 25 | Register 8 — Comparative synthesis and answer architecture — continued 2/3

| Divergence 4 | CAUTION India's sharpest anti-theistic critiques come from \*within\* orthodoxy (Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty), Sāṃkhya (dualist school based on enumerated principles)) |

| Four defensible verdicts | CAUTION V1 minimal (no proof is demonstrative) · V2 cumulative · V3 divergent (different proofs establish different things) · V4 experiential (Lotze/Chatterjee–Datta) |

| 10-mark spine | Classify → premises → one presupposition → canonical objection → one-line verdict (≈150 words) |

| 15-mark spine | Frame → reconstruct → canonical example → strongest objection → best reply → assess validity and adequacy separately (≈220–260 words) |

| 20-mark spine | Classify family → full steps → Indian/Western contrast → two objections with replies → underdetermination of attributes → criterion-named graded conclusion (≈320–360 words) |

| 2022 "most interesting Way" | CAUTION Defend Way 3 (why anything at all;



REGISTER NODE 26 | Register 8 — Comparative synthesis and answer architecture — continued 3/3

PSR debate) or Way 5 (richest downstream tradition); never describe Way 2 as "who started the universe" |



## REGISTER NODE 27 | Register 9 — The eleven master traps — continued 1/2

- CAUTION Do not merge Aquinas' five Ways into one temporal "first cause" argument.
- CAUTION Do not attribute the watch analogy to Aquinas; it belongs to Paley.
- CAUTION Do not say Kant proves God through morality; he postulates God for practical reason.
- CAUTION Do not call Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s God the material cause; atoms are the eternal material causes.
- CAUTION Do not present Hume as proving that no designer exists; his target is the inference's strength and its conclusion's attributes.
- CAUTION Distinguish a proof's validity from the adequacy of the God it establishes.
- CAUTION Do not omit Anselm's second form; the reply to Gaunilo depends on it.
- CAUTION Modal ontological versions carry a possibility-premise burden; they do not defeat Kant cleanly.



## REGISTER NODE 28 | Register 9 — The eleven master traps — continued 2/2

- CAUTION Mīmāṃsā (inquiry into Vedic duty)'s Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) is \*apauruṣeya (not of human authorship)\* and karma (morally consequential action) can be self-operating — the exact contradictory of Nyāya (school of logic and realism)'s third and \*adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\* proofs.
- CAUTION "Jainism is atheistic" misreads the 2019 question: Jainism denies God, not godhead.
- CAUTION Do not conflate the Kalām (temporal beginning) with Aquinas' Ways (explanatory priority).



## REGISTER NODE 29 | Register 10 — Keyword and statement bank — continued 1/2

Keywords: FACT \*a priori\* · \*a posteriori\* · ontological · necessary existence · aseity · real predicate · reductio · maximal greatness · possibility premise · cosmological · essentially ordered series (\*per se\*) · accidentally ordered series (\*per accidens\*) · contingency · principle of sufficient reason · Kalām · teleological · analogy · means–end adjustment · Epicurean hypothesis · natural selection · fine-tuning · multiverse · \*summum bonum\* · practical postulate · \*Vernunftglaube\* · autonomy · Euthyphro · \*kāryāt (from the world's being an effect)\* · \*āyojanāt (from combination or coordination)\* · \*dhr̥tyādeḥ (from support and maintenance)\* · \*padāt (from meaningful words)\* · \*śruteḥ (from revealed scripture)\* · \*sāvayava (composite or possessing parts)\* · \*avāntara-mahattva (intermediate magnitude)\* · \*nimitta-kāraṇa (efficient cause)\* vs \*upādāna-kāraṇa (material cause)\* · \*adṛṣṭa (unseen karmic potency)\* · \*puṇya (karmic merit)\* / \*pāpa (karmic demerit)\* · \*karmaphaladātā (dispenser of karmic fruits)\* · \*prayojaka kartā (directing efficient agent)\* · \*ṣaḍ-aiśvarya (six divine excellences)\* · \*ananta-catuṣṭaya (four infinitudes of the liberated soul)\* · \*kevala-jñāna (perfect omniscience)\* · \*siddha (liberated disembodied soul)\* · \*tri-ratna (three jewels of liberation)\* · \*utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya (origination, decay and persistence)\* · \*pratītyasamutpāda (dependent origination)\* · \*avyākṛta (undeclared or deliberately unanswered)\* · \*apauruṣeya (not of human authorship)\* · \*svataḥ-prāmāṇya (intrinsic validity of cognition)\* · \*apūrva (unseen potency generated by ritual duty)\* · \*niyoga (binding Vedic injunction)\* · \*āpta-prāmāṇya (authority of a trustworthy speaker)\*.



## REGISTER NODE 30 | Register 10 — Keyword and statement bank — continued 2/2

Safe formulations:

- CAUTION "Most proofs underdetermine the rich God of religion."
- CAUTION "Nyāya (school of logic and realism) and Western natural theology converge in inference from order, but diverge over material causation and karma (morally consequential action)."
- CAUTION "Hume did not disprove design; he dismantled the strength of the inference and the identity of the designer."
- CAUTION "Kant does not prove God; he shows what a serious moral agent must rationally hope."
- CAUTION "Jainism denies God but not godhead: godhood is achieved, plural and non-creative."
- CAUTION "Where the West's sharpest critics of theism stood outside religion, India's stood inside it."



## REGISTER NODE 31 | Register 11 — Last-minute memory spine — continued 1/2

TAXONOMY : a priori (ontological) | a posteriori (cosmo, teleo, moral, Nyaya (school of logic and realism))

GRID : validity → soundness → adequacy of the God established

ANSELM : P2 existence · P3 NECESSARY existence · Gaunilo · Kant · modal burden

AQUINAS : motion · causation · contingency · degrees · purpose

per se series (hand-stick-stone) · "first" = explanatory

DESIGN : Way 5 (archer) ≠ Paley (watch) ≠ fine-tuning (constants)

HUME : A-A-P-P-E (adapted · analogy · proportion · plurality · evil)

KANT : CPR destroys · CPrR postulates · F-I-G · summum bonum



## REGISTER NODE 32 | Register 11 — Last-minute memory spine — continued 2/2

NYAYA (school of logic and realism) : K-A-D-P-S + adrsta (unseen karmic potency) · EFFICIENT cause only · karmaphaladata (dispenser of karmic fruits)

CRITICS : Jaina (godhead, not God) · Bauddha (conditions suffice) ·

Mimamsa (apauruseya (not of human authorship) + apurva (unseen potency generated by ritual duty)) · Carvaka (no perception) ·

Advaita (only saguna (with qualities)) · Sharma (redundancy)

VERDICT : classify → reconstruct → presuppose → object → reply → GRADE

End of the complete learning session and consolidated register notes.